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S.I.R. OF ELECTORAL ROLLS LEGAL, ITS PROCESS JUSTIFIED: POLL PANEL

EC papers over objections within, presents united front in SC affidavit

Says no change in Form 6; observations and questions by ECs not decisions of Commission, ECINet team obligated to ensure EROs function smoothly


EXPRESS INVESTIGATION PART I

14 times in 10 months, two Election Commissioners objected on record to steps taken by Commission — from keeping them in the dark to adding new voters and deleting names

Illegal, unauthorised...(it's) harassment of young; ECs object to change in Form 6

Integrity of voter database: They even

The Indian Express report published on September 23

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, October 26

IN AN affidavit filed before the Supreme Court, the Election Commission of India (ECI) sought to clarify that observations, suggestions and questions by individual commissioners were just that, and not the ECI's decisions. It said the Special Intensive Revision of the electoral rolls is legal, its process justified, and that the petitioners' allegations relating to changes in voter registration procedures and decision-making process are misconceived.

The EC's affidavit, filed in response to a petition by social activist Rakesh Kumar Singh, said it "has been approved for filing... by a unanimous decision of the three members of the Election Commission, i.e., two Election Commissioners and the Chief Election Commissioner."

Singh's petition and the ECI affidavit come in the wake of the September 23 report in *The Indian Express* which pointed to several file noting by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi raising questions on the ECI's Special Intensive Revision process, observations that access to the electoral roll was getting restricted for officers statutorily responsible for the voter list, and that changes to Form 6 (form for registration of first-time voters) were "unauthorised/ illegal".

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EC says decisions unanimous, silent on why 2 members were not informed

Ritika Chopra
Mumbai, October 26

THE ELECTION Commission of India's affidavit in the Supreme Court is, in one sense, a defence of unanimity. Approved for filing by a unanimous decision of all three members, it insists that the Commission's major decisions on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls were taken collectively. Notes recording suggestions, observations or queries by individual Commissioners, it argues, do not themselves constitute decisions of the Commission and are part of the consultative process.

That distinction would answer an objection raised before a decision. Most of the 14 notes recorded over 10 months by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, objecting to decisions taken in the Commission's name without their knowledge, were written after the fact — about decisions already taken, systems already built, orders already issued and cases already filed, and what they recorded was that the two had not been told. The issue the investigation by *The Indian Express* raised was not whether the Commission eventually approved the decisions. It was whether two of its members were being consulted and informed about actions carried out in the Commission's name.

A petition filed on the strength of that report asked the court to examine how the

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HEARING TODAY

Censorship, gag on investigations: Publishers move SC against privacy law

Digital News Publishers Association includes *The Indian Express*, Network18, NDTV

Aditya Kalra
New Delhi, October 26

A GROUP of 21 news publishers has challenged India's privacy law in court, arguing it would trample investigative work and let New Delhi identify journalists' sources, documents show.

The government last year announced implementation of a privacy law to protect digital personal data of users, raising compliance requirements for platforms like Meta and Google. The publishers have said that since media outlets were not exempt, the law was an invasion of press freedom.

Media companies received assurances in an August meeting with the government that the law would protect press freedom, but not having a written carve-out for journalists like in the European Union, Singapore and Britain was alarming, India's Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA) said in a confidential filing at the Supreme Court, reviewed by *Reuters*.

The October 6 lawsuit,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

• **ISRAELIS WILL VOTE** to elect the Knesset. The first poll since the Hamas attack in Oct 2023, and the subsequent Gaza war, it will decide whether Benjamin Netanyahu, the country's longest-serving PM, stays in power.

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Calcutta HC orders removal of PM-Adani video across social media

Press Trust of India
Kolkata, October 26

THE CALCUTTA High Court on Monday barred the publication, uploading and sharing of a documentary on Prime Minister Narendra Modi and industrialist Gautam Adani until January 31 next year.

The injunction followed a plea by Adani Enterprises Limited before the High Court's vacation bench against tech entrepreneur Sabeer Bhatia, who is alleged to have made the video, and others, seeking a ban on its circulation and damages for defamation.

Justice Aryak Dutt restrained the respondents, including the owners and operators of X, YouTube and Instagram, their agents and all acting under their authority, from publishing, republishing, uploading and sharing the video or any clip, excerpt, or materially identical reproduction of it, through any medium or platform.

The court directed that the interim injunction will remain in force until January 31, 2027, or until further orders, whichever is earlier. It said the matter will come up for hearing before the regular bench in the monthly list of January next year.

Justice Dutt directed the respondents to "forthwith remove or cause the removal of the concerned video, and any clip, excerpt or reproduction thereof containing any such defamatory statements, from every account, channel and page owned or controlled by them".

The court directed social media platforms to remove or disable access to the video at each URL listed in the petition and to also disable the engagements — reposts, quote posts, shares and the like — through which the said video is accessible at those URLs.

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FOR UPLOADING ORDERS ON S.I.R APPEALS

Judges of Bengal tribunals ask EC to fix portal, drop Aadhaar authentication

Damini Nath
New Delhi, October 26

JUDGES OF Tribunals appointed by the orders of the Supreme Court to decide appeals of those affected by the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls in West Bengal have flagged at least twice in the last four weeks that the Election Commission requirement for Aadhaar authentication in its portal is holding them back from issuing final orders.

Official records accessed by *The Indian Express* show that the judges had taken exception to the introduction of the Aadhaar authentication required for them to issue orders on the appeals in September, and again less than two weeks ago. Just three days after the Aadhaar-authentication screen was introduced on September 21, the judges sought its removal, in writing, on September 24. As recently as October 13, the in-charge of the tribunals once again asked the EC to "fix the issue" to ensure proper functioning of the tribunals such that final orders can be uploaded, the records show.

The judges also separately raised concerns with the Election Commission and the

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Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



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NATIONWIDE PROTESTS BY BJP OVER KHARGE REMARK ON PM

KERALAM PASSES BILL ON SENIOR CITIZENS' RIGHTS

Microsoft offers buyouts to 60,000 workers in India, US, UK, Canada

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, October 26

MICROSOFT ON Monday announced a voluntary exit programme for eligible employees in India, the US, the UK and Canada, offering financial support and career planning resources to those opting to leave the company, according to a blog post by the tech giant.

Microsoft has about 23,000 employees in India, although there is no immediate clarity on how many of them would be eligible for the voluntary exit programme. Globally, around 60,000 employees are eligible.

It is learnt that eligible employees in India will have until December 1 to decide on the voluntary exit offer.

The package is understood to be similar to a standard severance arrangement, including one month's base salary for every completed year of service, along with health insurance and career transition services.

Microsoft's Executive Vice President and Chief People Officer Amy Coleman informed in her blog post that the voluntary exit offer (VEO), which will be available to employees at level 70 and below (internal job

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Court acquits Rahul in defamation case linked to 2018 remarks on Shah

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, October 26

A COURT in Uttar Pradesh's Sultanpur on Monday acquitted Congress leader Rahul Gandhi in a defamation case filed in connection with his remarks about Union Home Minister Amit Shah in 2018, ruling that the BJP leader who filed the complaint was not an aggrieved person and that the comments were not defamatory.

Gandhi appeared before the court amid tight security, accompanied by party workers and supporters. "The court has acquitted Rahul Gandhi in the case," his lawyer, Kashi Prasad Shukla, confirmed.

After the court pronounced the judgment, the Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha left the premises.

The complainant, Vijay Mishra, is a former vice-president of the BJP's Sultanpur unit.

"The court considered three

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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LULA DA SILVA WINS RECORD FOURTH TERM AS BRAZIL PRESIDENT



• IN 10-ODD SECTORS AND MANY PARTY ROLES, THERE ARE FAMILIAR NAMES FROM DELHI

From backrooms to seats at the table: The Delhi imprint in AAP's Punjab govt

Kanchan Vasdev
Chandigarh, October 26

AS THE Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government nears the completion of its first term in Punjab, it bears a striking resemblance to a past government run by it: that in Delhi.

A fresh reminder came when the Enforcement Directorate (ED) raided a bungalow in Sector 39, Chandigarh, occupied by senior AAP leader and former Delhi minister Satyendar Jain. The ED carried out a 50-hour search, from September 22 to 24, of the premises as part of its investigation into alleged irregularities in the affairs of the Greater Mohali Area Development Authority (GMADA).



Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann with Delhi's former Deputy CM Manish Sisodia and party leader Aman Arora in Ludhiana on September 18. GURMEET SINGH

Jain was not present at the bungalow, which is officially allotted to AAP leader Sunny Singh Ahluwalia, Chairman of the Punjab Water Supply and Sewerage Board.

Apart from Jain, the ED has named in the case Jain's OSD Amarender Jha and Manish Sisodia. The AAP Punjab incharge, Sisodia, was the party's Deputy Chief Minister, Delhi.

The AAP has rejected the allegations against Sisodia and Jain as "completely false, baseless and politically motivated", adding that they had no role in the GMADA, and that their role in Punjab was purely political.

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[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

EC papers over objections within, presents united front in SC affidavit

In the affidavit filed on Monday, the ECI told the Supreme Court that the two ECs and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar "unanimously" issued orders for scheduling the SIR of electoral rolls in states and Union Territories. "The three SIR Orders starting with the Order dated 24.06.2025 as well as later Orders to schedule SIR in other States and Union Territories issued on 27.10.2025 and 14.05.2026 were issued in accordance with decisions of the Election Commission of India arrived at unanimously...," it said.

The affidavit confirmed The Indian Express report on the two ECs Sandhu and Joshi writing separately to Cabinet Secretary T.V. Somanathan regarding an internal work allocation order issued by senior Deputy Election Commissioner Maneesh Garg and on his conduct. It, however, said the order was "never implemented" in view of a "joint direction...by the two Election Commissioners..."

On restricted access to the IT system where electoral rolls rest for the statutorily-backed Electoral Registration Officers, the affidavit said, "ECINet is the tool through which those authorities act and no entry is added or deleted or modified except by the order off the ERO". It said the ECINet team remains obligated to ensure that EROs are able to perform all their statutory functions, including exercise of discretion, smoothly and without any hitch on the portal, as per law.

The ECI also termed as "misleading" the contention that Form 6 was amended, and said that only the Additional Declaration annexed to Form 6 was amended "to introduce the concept "mapping"."

"On a review of the manner in which Form 6 and the declaration were displayed on the IT platform, some concerns arose for the reason that the manner in which the declaration was presented in the online system was such that it could be construed as though an amendment of Form 6 had been made. As stated earlier, Form 6 can only be amended by the Central Government. The amended declaration was a measure that would enable the person seeking registration as a voter to dispense with the need for filing documents during the claims and objections period...," it said.

The Declaration Form is one of the documents required to be submitted by a voter along with Form 6 for his/ her inclusion in the electoral roll, during the SIR exercise. "The declaration is a document provided by the SIR orders and is NOT a part of Form 6 which is the statutory form for inclusion in the Electoral Roll," it said.

The declaration was amended to introduce the concept "mapping" i.e., to connect the details of the applicant with the earlier SIR of 2002/ 2003 data, by requesting him/ her to provide the details of the electoral roll/ entry in the earlier electoral roll of self/ parents/ grandparents. The applicants upon being able to provide this data, it would obviate the need for submitting further documents for verification and thus, it was a measure for the assistance of voters," it said.

The affidavit said this exercise is applicable only for the SIR processes. "In any other exercise of any preparation/ updation of any electoral roll, it is only the Form 6 which is to be submitted for inclusion in the electoral roll," it said.

On alleged internal differences in the Commission, the affidavit said, "In any decision-making process, suggestions, observations, varying views or queries by any official in the chain of command are taken into consideration for arriving at the decision by the competent authority. This remains a common process, both where there is a hierarchy in the command and/ or in the case of any multi-member entity such as the Election Commission of India. The views by ECs/ CEC of the Commission during the decision-making process on the subjects before them - are considered for arriving at the decision. It is upon consideration of all the views placed before the Commission that the decision is taken and the orders are issued...," the affidavit said.

The Commission said deliberations and discussions take place on the issues put up before it. "The files put up by the respective divisions are sent first to one EC and thereafter to the other EC and then finally to the CEC. Such approved decisions of the Commission are duly noted in the concerned files of the Election Commission and bear the signature of the ECs and CEC. Thereafter, the decision is notified and implemented by the ECI Secretariat," it said.

The affidavit said that though "the statute recognises that institutional decision-making should preferably be unanimous, but there may be occasions where the decision may have to be by majority."

Privacy law

being reported for the first time and due to be heard on Tuesday, is the most high-profile challenge to the privacy law. Until now, only free speech activists and a group of smaller news outlets had challenged it.

DNPA and the media groups did not respond to requests for comment from Reuters, and neither did India's information technology ministry.

The publishers are demanding that most of the law's contentious provisions, which kick in from May 2027, should be quashed. They are arguing the law could force a journalist to get prior consent from a person they want to investigate and force publishers to erase stories. They also say powers granted by the law to demand information could expose reporters' sources.

The law would "render investigative journalism a benign and neutered recorder of events," the 698-page filing said. The provisions "constitute pre-censorship which is anathema to any democracy worth its name".

Concerns over consent

DNPA's members include Mukesh Ambani's Network18, Gautam Adani's NDTV, and other media groups including *The Indian Express* and Times Internet, which is part of the Times of India group.

A key concern in the law is the requirement of consent, the group's filing says.

A social media platform or online retailer can seek consent from users when they sign up, but the DNPA has argued that requiring a journalist to notify the subject of an investigation and seek consent "would allow that subject to destroy evidence, intimidate witnesses".

The law also lets people withdraw consent at any time and demand that their data be erased, without any public-interest safeguard, which DNPA says could force its members to unpublish or heavily redact a factual news report.

Fear of sources at risk

News publishers are concerned that a federal authority created under the law can impose fines for non-compliance, and grants powers to New Delhi to block access to any information in the "interests of the general public", which would curtail press freedom, DNPA said.

In an August letter to the government attached to the lawsuit, the group said India "has chosen to grant broad exemptions to the state, while failing to extend any corresponding protection to the press". No response was cited.

From next year, the law will also let New Delhi order any organization handling personal data "to furnish such information as it may call for", putting newsrooms at risk of having to divulge sources, the filing said.

It can also deter whistleblowers from sharing information on corruption, corporate wrongdoing or electoral malpractice with reporters, the DNPA argued.

The "nakedly unguided" provision must be quashed, the DNPA said, adding that the power "can extend to privileged communications in possession of a reporter or the informant."

— REUTERS

Rahul acquitted in defamation case

questions: first, whether the CD containing the voice recording filed by the complainant was genuine; second, whether the complainant was an aggrieved person; and third, whether the impugned statement was defamatory," Mishra's lawyer, Santosh Pandey, said.

"The MP/MLA court which was hearing the case found the CD to be genuine, but did not find the complainant to be an aggrieved person, nor the statement made against Amit Shah to be defamatory. I have yet to study the full judgment," Pandey said.

He added that the court examined three witnesses for the complainant, and no witness appeared from the opposite side. "I will study the judgment and consult our counsel before deciding whether to file a revision in the case," said Mishra.

According to Mishra, Gandhi made the statement against Shah in Bengaluru during the Assembly election campaign in May 2018, when the Union Home Minister was the BJP's national president.

Gandhi faces several defamation cases across the country, many filed by members of the BJP and the RSS. Earlier this month, during a protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, he said, "Forty-five FIRs have been registered against me. I want 100 FIRs to be registered against me. Every FIR is like a medal for me." This was after a case was registered against him over a protest march to the Election Commission office in Delhi.

EC silent

Commission is functioning. The affidavit is the Commission's reply. It sets out the Commission's position on how decisions are formally taken. It does not, by itself, resolve the concerns the two Commissioners recorded about how the process worked in practice.

Take Form 6, the statutory form through which citizens apply to be included in the electoral roll. In May, before any change, Joshi recorded that the form could not be altered without an amendment to the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, and Sandhu concurred. The change was made anyway in the online version of Form 6, in July. Sandhu learnt of it from a newspaper report, and, in August, described the declaration inserted into the online form as "unauthorised/ illegal".

The affidavit now argues that the declaration introduced for the SIR was a separate document, not an amendment to the statutory form. It acknowledges, however, that the way the declaration appeared online "could be construed as though an amendment of Form 6 had been made," and that "certain steps taken by the officers" needed "to be corrected." The Commission's ER Division has since decided, on October 21, to separate the statutory Form 6 from the SIR declaration in the online application process.

That is an explanation of the Commission's legal position. It does not say who approved the online implementation in July, or how it went ahead two months after two of three members had recorded, in writing, that it should not. The affidavit says the declaration "was entered into the online page of Form 6". It does not say by whom.

The same distinction runs through the dispute over ECINet, the platform through which electoral roll functions are carried out. The affidavit says the Electoral Registration Officer remains the statutory authority responsible for the roll, that "no entry is added or deleted or modified except by order of the Electoral Registration Officer," and that the software is meant to enable the officer to exercise those powers. It also sets out new arrangements for reviewing the platform's compliance with the law, through a committee that includes experts from IIT Mumbai and IISc Bengaluru, and for scrutinising new IT modules before they are approved.

These are significant steps. They are also, almost to the word, what Joshi proposed on May 29, when he wrote of "the gradual centralisation of the electoral roll database" and asked for a committee with an outside expert from the IITs to certify that "no one, except the concerned statutory authorities, has credentials to make any change in the database." Sandhu endorsed it in July. On August 14, Sandhu recorded that what became of the two notes "is not known to the undersigned." The affidavit presents the committee as the Commission's decision of September 26 and 30. It does not mention the May proposal.

Nor does it mention the two Commissioners' notes on the software about what the law says. They were about what had already been built. Sandhu recorded in April this year that the IT division had developed "many new modules and portals" without any being brought to the Commission, and that he had learnt of them "from media only." In August, he recorded that field officers were reporting they could not use the system to do what the law required of them. A declaration that the ERO remains the legal authority does not, on its own, establish that the officer could implement every decision through the system at the time those notes were written.

Goa is the case in point. The affidavit refers to the 97 voters left off the final roll, 88 of whom, it says, have since applied through Form 6. That records a subsequent development. It does not explain why, in February, the software did not allow Goa Electoral Registration Officers' decisions to be implemented, despite eight requests in seven days from the state's election office for the software to let them reverse the deletions, and a note from the Commission's own Deputy Election Commissioner that the "IT system cannot block necessary action."

The affidavit's account of West Bengal is equally consequential. It says the appeals against orders restoring voters to the electoral roll were filed by officers in the office of the state's Chief Electoral Officer, and that "these matters were not brought to the Commission." It also argues that the officers had authority to file the appeals under the Supreme Court's orders.

Joshi had asked first. On August 7, after a newspaper report on the appeals, his office sought "the factual position" from the officer in charge of the state. Five days later, Sandhu put five questions to the same officer, recording that Joshi "told me that he doesn't have the details." The affidavit answers two of them: whether the Commission had filed appeals, and who filed them. To the fourth, who authorised them, its answer is that the officers had authority under the Supreme Court's orders. But the answer raises a question of its own. Sandhu's note records that West Bengal's Chief Electoral Officer "told me today that she also doesn't have any information about the details of this matter." The affidavit now says the appeals were filed by officers of her office, citing a letter from that office dated October 22. It does not reconcile the two. Nor does it say how lakhs of appeals came to be filed on near-identical grounds, whether any case was examined individually, or how an exercise of this scale proceeded, in the Commission's name, without the Commission, or, by her own account, the state's chief electoral officer, knowing.

The July order is the one episode where the two Commissioners acted rather than asked. A senior officer, within hours of being given temporary charge of the Commission's administration, had issued an order redistributing work among its officers. Joshi's letter to the Cabinet Secretary records that when he asked the Administration Division for the file, "it was not provided." The affidavit says the order was never implemented after the two Commissioners' joint direction, and that the letters they wrote were in relation to it. It does not say why an order of that kind was issued without the Commission in the first place, why the file was withheld from a member of the Commission, or what has happened to the officer, who is not named.

On the documents the petition rests on, it says the Commission "has neither released nor authorised the release of any internal note/ file to any news agency," which contests how they reached the public, not what they say.

The affidavit is now the Commission's collective position before the Supreme Court. The test will be whether the explanations and corrective measures it describes resolve the specific questions raised by the record. The concerns documented by two Commissioners were about learning of things after they had been done. That is what the Commission still needs to answer.

Bengal tribunals

Calcutta High Court about the poor conditions of the Tribunals. From having "to work in a melee within a room of about 12x10 sq ft along with 7/8 members of staff" to lack of stationery and access to washrooms, 10 of the judges wrote on October 1 and pushed for moving the Tribunals from Joka in the outskirts of Kolkata to a more central place in the city, and a doubling of the honorarium since Rs 25,000 now "does not appear either to be hon'ble or befitting to the dignity of the judges". Some of these concerns were raised by the judges in the second week of August too.

The Election Commission of India did not respond to queries mailed by The Indian Express on October 21 to its spokesperson.

The Election Commission's IT division has designed a separate digital portal for the Tribunals. As reported first by *The Indian Express* on October 7, judges of more than a dozen Tribunals had highlighted glaring gaps in the portal. It did not allow them to serve notices to parties, upload additional documents from voters who filed appeals, or hold virtual hearings, or restore a deleted voter. It didn't even let the appellants download Tribunal orders, the judges had noted in the minutes of a meeting held on August 11, and sent separately to the Election Commission and the Chief Justice of Calcutta High Court.

The EC subsequently updated the portal and sources aware of the developments said a virtual meeting was conducted by Director General of IT of ECI Seema Khanna on September 21 to familiarise the judges with this updated version. The judges were, however, not informed that a new feature requires them to authenticate with their private Aadhaar numbers before they could finally upload an order in the portal. The portal also limited the kinds of documents the judges could accept from appellants to the 13 documents mentioned by the EC during the SIR process.

Writing to the Additional Chief Electoral Officer and nodal officer for tribunals on September 24, the tribunals' venue-in-charge said: "The Honourable Judges at the Appellate Tribunal require the Aadhaar authentication screen removed from the AT portal for the purpose of disposal of appeals." So, while orders are being disposed of physically, they are not being uploaded in the portal.

In fact, the matter came up once again on October 12 when the office of the CEO wrote to the tribunals' in-charge forwarding the request of an appellant for disposal of his appeal. In response, the tribunal informed the CEO office on October 13 that: "Since the system at present does not allow the tribunals to upload the final order and in this regard, CEO has already been apprised of vide letter dt. 24.09.2026. CEO, WB be once again requested to fix the issue to ensure proper functioning of the Tribunals."

While the Election Commission's SIR was on in nine states and three Union Territories from October last year, in one of the states, West Bengal, the process adopted by the EC and later ordered by the Supreme Court was unique and unprecedented. Finding that there was a trust deficit between the then Trinamool Congress-ruled state government and the EC, the court had on February 20 ordered adjudication of electors' eligibility by judicial officers, after invoking its extraordinary powers under Article 142.

Hundreds of judicial officers then went through 60.06 lakh electors' cases, who were flagged by the EC's centralised software for "logical discrepancies". Eventually, the judicial officers ordered the deletion of 27.16 lakh of those electors, striking them off the rolls just weeks before polling the Assembly poll in April.

The Supreme Court on March 20 ordered the setting up of appellate tribunals, of retired High Court judges, to give those deleted a chance to appeal. The EC had appointed 19 former judges to act as appellate tribunals for the West Bengal SIR.

As of September 18, the EC told the Supreme Court that 38.31 lakh appeals had been filed, of which 22.21 lakh were filed by the deleted voters and 16.10 lakh appeals were against inclusions. Only 1.26 lakh appeals had been disposed of till September 10, EC told the court.

On October 1, the 10 judges wrote that the tribunals were set up in a hurry after 27 lakh voters were cut from the rolls after adjudication. "...in order to assuage the public discontents, venue and court rooms were selected and constructed in a jiffy. In such emergent situation, taking it as a stop gap measure for a short period and in fact, it was given to understand as such that is was a matter of few months, 19 Appellate Tribunals, along with court rooms, were given shape in a vacant building of the Central government in Joka purely as a make-shift arrangement," they wrote.

They pointed out that the tribunals' office in Joka is about 30km from Kolkata/New Town, with the roads being in "horrible condition", leading to a commute of two to three hours. "Judges are to work in a melee within a room of about 12x10 sq. ft. along with 7/8 members of staff working on computers whole day long in inconceivable conditions having no scope for recess. Judges have no separate chambers or washroom," they wrote. "Last, not the least, the honorarium provided to the Retired Judges does not appear either to be hon'ble or befitting to the dignity of the judges..." they said, adding that a representation for increasing it to Rs.50,000 per week from Rs.25,000 was already pending with the Chief Justice since June.

They recommended that the tribunals' office be relocated to a more central place, the judges be given better working conditions, the staff be given extra compensation for their work and the honorarium for the judges be "befitting" for them.

This isn't the first time the judges have flagged the problems with the EC portal. At a meeting on August 11, at least a dozen judges flagged the inability to issue notices, upload additional documents and hold virtual hearings through the portal.

Microsoft workers

grades that span various levels of seniority at Microsoft) in participating teams across the four countries, is a time-limited initiative aimed at providing greater flexibility to employees considering opportunities outside the company.

The offer will be available to eligible employees in participating teams in Canada, India, the United Kingdom and the United States, she wrote in the post.

(***Reuters adds***: Microsoft had 223,000 full-time employees globally as of June 30, 2026, according to its annual filing. Staffers across the Windows maker would be eligible for the offers, including those working in AI experiences, Copilot, finance, human resources, Xbox and Windows + Devices, a source familiar with the matter told Reuters. Units such as marketing, commercial business and security will be excluded, the source added.

The company earlier this year offered voluntary buyouts to about 7% of its US workforce, or about 9,000 employees.

In July, Microsoft announced it would cut 4,800 jobs, or about 2.1% of its global workforce, overhauling its Xbox gaming business and divesting up to five studios as it looks to boost returns after years of heavy investment in the division.)

Meanwhile, a Microsoft spokesperson said the company continues to invest in India's talent and technology ecosystem and is backing the country's AI ambitions with US$ 20.5 billion in committed investment between 2025 and 2029 across cloud and AI infrastructure, skilling and operations.

"We are also on track to fulfil our commitment of equipping 20 million people across India with AI skills by 2030," the Microsoft spokesperson said.

Coleman -- in her blog post -- said the programme would provide employees with an option to make the transition with support, while allowing participating businesses to adjust their workforce according to evolving requirements.

"This offer gives eligible employees who may be considering a future outside the company a new choice to make that transition now with support. It also gives participating organisations another way to adapt their workforce to changing needs," Coleman said.

The company clarified that the programme would not be implemented uniformly across its operations, with participation depending on individual business priorities, customer commitments and workforce requirements.

Eligible employees will receive emails detailing the terms of their voluntary exit offers, the blog post said.

"The Voluntary Exit Offer is new for us. We'll learn from it," Coleman said.

She added that Microsoft would continue helping employees develop new skills and explore internal career opportunities, where appropriate.

"There is no one-size-fits-all approach for every team or every employee," Coleman said, emphasising that the company would seek to balance changing business requirements with opportunities for employees to grow and contribute.

PM-Adani

YouTube, X and Instagram were also directed by the court to preserve the subscriber information, registration details, IP logs at the time of upload and access logs relating to the accounts and URLs listed in the petition. They were also directed by the court to disclose the basic subscriber information of the accounts whose holders are not identifiable in the list, in a sealed cover, by an affidavit filed within two weeks of communication of this order.

"It is made clear that this order does not restrain constructive criticism or fair reporting on the petitioner, the Adani Group or any government policy, otherwise than by means of the impugned video, its reproductions or the defamatory statements referred to," the court observed.

The petitioner stated that access to the original upload on YouTube has been disabled within India, apparently on a complaint of the government under provisions of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021.

It claimed that despite this, the video concerned continues to be re-uploaded, reposted and circulated on other YouTube channels, X accounts and Instagram reels.

Justice Dutt directed the respondents to file their affidavits-in-opposition within four weeks from the date of service. The petitioner was directed to file its affidavit-in-reply within two weeks thereafter.

The petitioner's counsel stated before the court that the video contains various allegations against the petitioner, maintaining that these statements are false. The counsel for the Adani Group stated before the court that the right to reputation is an integral part of Article 21 of the Constitution.

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Date : 27th October 2026 SRFDCL

HARSH VIHAR HOUSE COLLAPSE

Man, son who took contract for 'illegal' floor killed, owner held



At the site of the incident on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 26

A FATHER-SON duo, who was awarded the contract to allegedly construct an additional floor on a single-storey house "illegally", died after the building collapsed in North East Delhi's Harsh Vihar on Sunday evening, said police. The owner of the house has been arrested, they added.

The deceased were identified as Chanderpal, 60, and his son Vijay Kumar, 33, both of whom were inside the building when it came down. Police said that the additional floor was being built without permission.

"Preliminary inspection revealed that the ground floor of an old building, which reportedly also housed a godown, collapsed along with a structure on its first floor. The property is reportedly owned by one Manoj Kumar," police officers said.

On Monday, Vijay's wife Anita recalled the last time she talked to him. Anita said she had told him around an hour before the incident that dinner was ready and that she was waiting for him.

"When I called him around 6:30-7 pm, his number was not reachable. I called his brother and asked him to check on him," said Anita, a mother of two.

A resident of Gali number 14, situated merely blocks away from the building that collapsed, Anita said that when her brother-in-law reached the spot, the building had already collapsed. Chanderpal's bike was still parked nearby.

Vijay had started the construction only on Sunday morning. The house was built on an area of about 200 sq yards, inside a narrow lane swarmed with buildings, most of which house shops.

The ground floor of the building had a concrete slab, while the structure above it had a lighter slab with iron rods. It has been learnt that workers were trying to replace the iron slab with a concrete one, but the base of the building wasn't able to bear the load of the same.

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), in a statement, said: "As per the local enquiry and the circumstances of the incident, it appears that during the execution of the work, while replacing the T-iron and stone slab roofing with an RCC slab, the rear portion of the first-floor structure reportedly collapsed and fell onto the roof of the ground floor. Consequently, the roof of the ground floor also collapsed, resulting in the collapse of the affected portion of the building."

"The front portion remains in its previous condition, with the ground floor having an RCC slab and the first floor having a T-iron and stone slab, at the same level," it also read.

According to Delhi Fire Services (DFS) officials, a call regarding the collapse in Harsh Vihar's Milan Garden was received around 6:46 pm.

Officials of the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) and the Delhi Disaster Management Authority (DDMA) were among personnel deployed at the site for rescue operations, which ended by Monday morning, police said.

Earlier, on October 7, a pregnant woman and two children were killed after a four-storey building collapsed in Northeast Delhi's New Seemapuri.

On September 6, a five-storey building in South West Delhi's Satya Niketan that was being operated as a paying guest accommodation collapsed, killing seven people.

• Skywatch

Forecast: October 27, 2026

Mainly clear sky. No rain.

MAX: 30-32
0.2°C above normal

MIN: 15-17
0.2°C below normal

- *Sunrise: 6:30 AM (October 28)*
- *Sunset: 5:41 PM (October 27)*
- *Moonrise: 6:19 PM (October 27)*
- *Moonset: 8:47 AM (October 28)*

• AQI Tracker

Narela	Najafgarh
Poor	Moderate
AQI: 208	AQI: 178
Vivek Vihar	Badarpur
Poor	Moderate
AQI: 208	AQI: 131

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

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EXPRESS special

Delhi plans bottle-return scheme, taking a cue from Uttarakhand and Goa

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 26

DELHI IS considering a scheme to encourage people to return used plastic bottles for recycling, taking a cue from Uttarakhand and Goa where similar initiatives are already in place. Under the proposed scheme, consumers may have to pay an additional Re 1 or Rs 2 when buying a bottle and get the amount back when they return it at a designated collection point, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The proposed Deposit Refund Scheme (DRS) aims to create a more organised system for collecting plastic waste and encourage people to move away from the "use and throw" culture towards "use, return and recover", officials said.

The government is considering starting the initiative as a pilot project at tourist destinations before expanding it to other parts of the capital, officials said. The mechanism is expected to involve QR codes on bottles, which would help consumers claim their refunds after returning them.

According to a Delhi government report, the national capital generates around 1,500 tonnes of plastic waste daily, of which 19% remains unprocessed. Single-use plastic items, including bottles and bags, were banned across India in 2022.

A meeting to discuss the approval and implementation of the scheme was held on October 6 under Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa. Suggestions were sought from Dr Anthony De Sa, former chairman of the Goa Deposit Refund Scheme Authority, and Dr Ankur Kansal, chief environment officer of the Uttarakhand government.



The move aims to create a more organised system for collecting plastic waste. AMIT MEHRA

Uttarakhand, Goa offer models

Uttarakhand's experience with the scheme is among the models being examined by the Delhi government.

Kansal told The Indian Express that the state introduced the initiative in Kedarnath in 2022 as a pilot project as a large number of tourists and pilgrims visit the area.

"The scheme received a very good response. Its success also helped us receive a Digital India Award from the Centre. It was subsequently expanded to other locations in the state," he said.

Kansal said the bottle-return rate in Uttarakhand increased significantly since the scheme's introduction. "Initially, the collection rate was around 20-22%. It has now reached nearly 90%. We have fixed the deposit at Rs 10 per bottle, though the amount can vary depending on the size of the bottle or can," he said.

Goa has also implemented a similar scheme, with a deposit of Rs 5 on plastic bottles. The initiative was introduced on April 1 under De Sa's supervision.

The Deposit Refund Scheme is also in place in several countries, including Singapore, Hong Kong and the United Kingdom, where financial incentives are used to encourage the return of beverage containers.

Next steps

Officials said a formal draft of Delhi's scheme was being prepared following consultations with stakeholders. It will be taken through the necessary approval process before implementation.

The final framework, including the deposit amount, collection network and refund mechanism, is yet to be finalised, officials said.

The government is also expected to seek the participation of schools, colleges and Residents' Welfare Associations (RWAs) to spread awareness and encourage public participation once the framework is finalised. "The aim is to bring about behavioural change among people and make them understand their responsibility towards the environment," an official source said.

Cruise ride along the Yamuna likely before Chhath festival

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 26



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta with Delhi Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh during an inspection on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

A CRUISE ride on the Yamuna is on the cards for Delhi. The proposed 'Namo Yamuna Cruise Safari' service is expected to begin next month before the Chhath festival, said Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday. The project was announced by the BJP government last year.

The CM on Monday reviewed the Sonia Vihar-Jagatpur stretch of the Yamuna, where trial runs for the ferry service have begun. Cabinet Minister Kapil Mishra and senior officials were present during the inspection. Gupta directed the officials concerned to pay special attention to cleanliness, passenger safety and the facilities available to visitors.

"We are trying to launch the service before the Chhath festival. People in Delhi will be able to visit Maa Yamuna with their families, enjoy a cruise ride and have a new destination within the Capital where they can spend time together and enjoy a picnic," Gupta said. The initiative, she underlined, was expected to give a boost to tourism in the Capital, benefit local businesses, and create new employment opportunities.

Chhath, a four-day ancient festival dedicated to the Sun God, is set to be celebrated between November 13 and 16.

The proposed cruise service is being developed along a four-to six-km stretch between Sonia Vihar and Jagatpur by the Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI) in collaboration with various departments. The project aims to promote river-based tourism and recreational activities on the Yamuna, an official said.

Last year, in March, the IWAI signed an MoU with the Delhi government's Irrigation and Flood Control Department (I&FCD), Delhi Development Authority (DDA), Delhi Jal Board (DJB) and Delhi Tourism and Transport Development (DTTDC) to develop the river stretch for cruise tourism. "It was expected to be launched within the six months of the MOU. However, the project got delayed," the official added.

The initiative envisages eco-friendly cruise operations using electric-solar hybrid boats, each capable of carrying around 20 to 30 passengers.

The boats will be equipped with bio-toilets, public announcement systems and life jackets. Floating jetties and other supporting infrastructure are also part of the project. The project is part of efforts to develop the Yamuna stretch for short-distance navigation and tourism while ensuring passenger safety and improving facilities along the river, the official added.

What is covered under the MoU

- IWAI spearheads the infrastructure development, including floating jetties, charging stations for hybrid boats, and navigational aids, while ensuring passenger safety.
- DDA provides land for shore-side facilities, last-mile connectivity, and public services such as electricity, restrooms.
- DJB monitors water quality, manages the barrage for navigability, and facilitates drinking water supply and waste disposal.
- I&FCD will maintain embankments, grant access to approach roads, and ensure adherence to safety protocols.
- The Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation oversees operations, engage operators, and ensure compliance with regulations to promote tourism.

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Time Schedule of Third Round of Online Counseling for UP NEET UG-2026

In continuation of the time-table issued by Medical Counseling Committee (MCC), New Delhi for counseling of NEET UG course, the time-table of third round of online counseling for admission of state quota seats of UG course (MBBS/BDS) in Government/ Private Medical/ Dental Colleges/ Universities of the State is as follows :-

S.No.	Description	Dates
1	Date of online registration	26 October, 2026 (From 05:00 PM) to 28 October, 2026 (Till 02:00 PM)
2	Date of depositing registration fee and security Fee	26 October, 2026 (From 05:00 PM) to 28 October, 2026 (Till 03:00 PM)
3	Date of declaration of merit list	28 October, 2026
4	Date of online choice filling	28 October, 2026 (From 05:00 PM) to 31 October, 2026 (Till 05:00 PM)
5	Date of declaration of result of seat allotment	02 November, 2026
6	Date for downloading allotment letters and admission process	03 November, 2026 to 07 November, 2026

All information related to UP NEET UG-2026 counseling will be uploaded on Departmental website https://upneet.gov.in and www.dgme.up.gov.in. DIRECTOR GENERAL

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In conversation with



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SCUFFLES, DETENTIONS CONTINUE AS STRIKE ENTERS THIRD WEEK

'All demands not met': Jamia agrees to hold union polls after 20 yrs but protest continues

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, October 26





Security personnel deployed outside the university on Monday; (left) protesters outside the varsity. ABHINAV SAHA/ TABSHIR SHAMS

THE JAMIA Millia Islamia (JMI) university in Delhi on Monday agreed to hold student union elections, once the union's constitution receives official approval, in a bid to end a two-week-long hunger strike by five students. Hours after the announcement, however, a section of protesting students wrote to Vice-Chancellor Mazhar Asif seeking a revision of the university's order, arguing that their demands have not been fully addressed. Three of the five students, who have been fasting since October 12, have vowed to continue their strike.

"The Jamia Millia Islamia Student's Union (JMISU) election will be held after 15 days, from the date of approval of the constitution of the student's union...," the order issued by the Registrar's office stated. But the order does not set a fixed timeline, which has been a key demand of the protesters.

The varsity's latest order, meanwhile, also gives students two other assurances, including revocation of suspension and show-cause notices issued to them during the protest. It also says that a committee will be constituted to inquire into the actions of security staff during the protest.

The university's response on Monday follows a letter submitted by the hunger strikers and their delegates, titled 'Demand of Hunger Strike Students'. In their submission on Sunday, the students made it clear that they needed a written commitment to end their demonstration.

"We will call off the hunger strike and sit-in protest only upon receiving a written agreement from the university administration accepting them," the letter stated.

Protesters' contention

The primary demand of protesters has been setting a fixed timeline for restoring the JMISU, which has remained dissolved since 2006.

The protesters also demanded the revocation of disciplinary actions initiated against participating students and an official inquiry into the conduct of university security personnel.

In this regard, the administration's order includes conditional requirements for the protesting students.

First, it refers to submission of an undertaking by the students to issue a public apology at a press conference for any "defamatory statements/actions/posts" made against the administration during the protest.

Secondly, it directs that all such social media posts be taken down immediately, noting that compliance will be actively monitored.

It concludes by directing that the protest be called off immediately after the order is issued.

Apart from the lack of a fixed timeline for approving the union constitution, protesters have pointed to other problems. The varsity order does not cover students who have been rusticated and barred from campus, including the hunger strikers, they said.

They have also refused to give an apology for "defamatory statements/actions/posts".

Students have sought a formal commitment that the union constitution will be drafted and approved by December 20, followed by an election notification within 15 days.

They have also demanded the withdrawal of all disciplinary action linked to the protest, including show-cause notices, suspensions, campus bans and rustication, and the resignation of the Chief Security Advisor.

Vacate protest site: Jamia sends legal notice as students stay put

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, October 26

EVEN AS more than 700 security personnel were on duty, nearly double as compared to a day before, and the university agreed to hold union polls after nearly 20 years, Jamia Millia Islamia continued to see tense scenes on Monday with the students' strike entering the third week over a slew of demands. More than 40 students were briefly detained, according to police officers, through the day as the varsity saw scuffles between protesters and security personnel. In the night, a fresh legal notice, warning of discplinary action, was issued by the varsity to vacate the protest site near Gulistan-e-Ghalib while restrictions on entry of students continued.

While five students began a hunger strike on October 12 over union polls, among other demands, three of them — Ebin, Rehan and Rida — continue to fast till all demands are met.

In another order on Monday, the university said that online classes would continue through the Diwali holidays, until November 8, after which the situation would be reviewed.

It also said the second mid-semester examinations "shall be held through online mode", with detailed guidelines and modalities to be decided by the respective departments in consultation with the Controller of Examinations. The order further directed PhD research scholars to consult their supervisors online.

How the day unfolded

As the protest entered the 15th day on Monday, the morning started with sporadic marches and sloganeering and students continued to scale walls to enter the campus. By 2.30 pm, while most gates were sealed, women students led protest marches of around 200 students, raising slogans and demanding a fixed timeline for the approval of the students' union constitution.

The banners they held read slogans such as "Sarfaroshi ki tamanna...(The desire for sacrifice is now in our hearts)", and "No barricades, no detention... we want student representation." A minor scuffle broke out as police removed several protesters from both sides of Gate 7, where more than 50 personnel were deployed, and told the rest to disperse. They didn't. The protest moved a few metres away, opposite the Ibn Sina Library. Some students broke the locks on the gates and walked in, as the policemen watched.

Two marches by women students wound through the campus. Outside, students, who could not enter, pressed against the gates and watched.

With classes shifted online, the canteen and library continued to remain shut. For the protesters, food, water, and fruits in baskets were sent over the boundary wall by supporters standing outside.

Nausheen Farooq, one of the organisers, said, "We are still protesting because there is no timeline given to us. We want the approval of the constitution by December 20, and the election announcement within 15 days."

Inside the campus, a group sat beneath the Ghalib statue inside a yellow and blue tent. Multiple groups of students scattered around the campus, seldom sloganeering, a poetry session, then slogans again.

In a notice issued on Monday night, Jamia Millia Islamia's Chief Proctor gave Rehan Khan, a first-semester Geography student, a "final opportunity" to vacate the Gulistan-e-Ghalib building and the sit-in site at Ghalib Lawn in the North Campus.

The notice said most protesters had subsequently ended their hunger strike, called off the protest and vacated the buildings housing the departments of political science and economics, as well as the sit-in site in the north campus.

However, Khan allegedly continued the sit-in and hunger strike despite a notice issued by the registrar at 4.15 am, the chief proctor said. The notice stated that the presence of protesters in the building, which houses the Departments of Political Science and Economics, was "unlawful" and was "causing suffering to the smooth functioning of these departments". It warned that if the student failed to vacate the premises immediately, "disciplinary and legal action shall be initiated against you".

HC to hear plea today seeking protection of Race Course Masjid from demolition

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 26

THE DELHI High Court will on Tuesday hear a fresh petition seeking protection of the Race Course Masjid as the petitioner has claimed that he apprehends its demolition.

This comes after the court on October 15 dismissed a plea by the Imam of the mosque, in which he was seeking restoration of electricity and water connections, cut off on October 7.

The latest plea by Syed Ahmed Saud, a worshipper, is seeking protection of the mosque against demolition, removal of obstructions to ingress and egress, and redressal of alleged inaction of the Delhi Waqf Board. It is expected to be heard by Justice Anish Dayal.

The utilities at the masjid, a Waqf-notified Grade-II heritage structure situated beside the Delhi Race Club and adjoining Delhi Golf Club, were disconnected on October 7.

While there has been no notice of eviction yet by the Land and Development Officer to the mosque, the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on October 15 refused to restore the utilities, saying "demolition work is still going on" in the area, which involves demolition of the jhuggi structures, and that "there is an element of public harm involved".

While the mosque was not a party to the litigation concerning the eviction of around 700 slum dwellers and the Race Course Club, the NDMC's counsel orally told the court that the masjid's premises were "covered" by an HC judgment dated August 25.

Old RTR flyover near IGI airport misses reopening deadline

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 26



Old RTR flyover on Monday

THE OLD Rao Tula Ram (RTR) flyover in South Delhi, which was closed since last week, did not reopen till late night on Monday. The flyover was closed for repairs on October 21 after cracks were detected at two locations. Officials had expected the repairs to get over by Monday. The temporary closure of the carriageway has forced motorists to take the adjoining service road, leading to congestion in peak hours.

The approximately 900-920-metre-long flyover is a key link for motorists travelling to and from the Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGIA). It also serves commuters coming from Gurugram, many of whom continue towards South Delhi, Noida and other parts of the National Capital Region (NCR). Despite its relatively short length, the flyover carries nearly two lakh vehicles daily, according to Delhi Traffic Police officers. It was opened in 2009.

Delhi Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh visited the flyover on Monday morning to inspect its condition and review the repair work. "The necessary repair work has been completed, and the flyover is set to reopen for light vehicles. A comprehensive structural audit is also underway to ensure the strength and long-term safety of this flyover, which was constructed in 2009," the Minister said.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (New Delhi Traffic) Vikas Kumar said additional personnel would be deployed to manage traffic and enforce the restrictions. To prevent heavy vehicles from entering the flyover, the Public Works Department (PWD) will install a height barrier at its entrance, traffic officials said. Rumble strips and pickets have been set up at the flyover as a precautionary measure.

MCD official suspended over animal shelter 'demolition', CM assures Rs 5L aid to activist

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 26



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta met activist Jagriti Mishra on Sunday. X/@GUPTA_REKHA

A DAY after Chief Minister Rekha Gupta ordered an inquiry into the alleged demolition of an animal shelter being constructed in Outer-North Delhi's Nizampur village, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Monday suspended a junior engineer.

CM Gupta on Sunday met animal welfare activist Jagriti Mishra after a video posted by Mishra on social media, alleging demolition by the MCD, had gone viral. Mishra also alleged that the action was taken at the behest of an Aam Aadmi Party councillor, without any prior notice. Mishra runs Street World Trust, an NGO which serves injured and sick animals and was involved in the building of the shelter.

CM Gupta also assured Mishra of financial assistance worth Rs 5 lakh from the Chief Minister's Relief Fund. She directed the district magistrate to assist the activist in setting up the animal shelter.

AAP's Tilak Nagar MLA Jarnail Singh, meanwhile, claimed that Mishra unnecessarily linked the AAP councillor to this matter.

"Today, I visited the site and met Jagriti ji, clarifying to her that the Aam Aadmi Party had no connection with the matter," Singh said on social media.

"Following our conversation, Jagriti ji expressed regret over her statement, and the confusion surrounding the issue was resolved. What matters most is that the truth comes out and misunderstandings are cleared."

According to the suspension order issued by the Deputy Commissioner of the MCD's Outer North Zone, Vikas Kumar Gupta, a junior engineer in the Building Department, was suspended with immediate effect as disciplinary proceedings against him were contemplated. The order stated that he would be entitled to a subsistence allowance as per rules and would not be permitted to leave the station without prior permission during the suspension period. However, it did not specify the allegations against him or the grounds on which the structure was demolished.

Mishra has claimed that she invested around Rs 70 lakh from her personal funds and public donations in the facility. She alleged that people linked to local political circles had demanded money from her and that the demolition took place after she refused to pay.

CM Gupta on Monday said that public office carried a responsibility to serve citizens with sensitivity and integrity, adding that complaints would be examined fairly and due process followed. "Any misconduct established through the proceedings will invite strict action, in accordance with the law." In a post on X, CM Gupta had on Sunday said the government would not tolerate harassment of citizens or misuse of authority. "Those found guilty will face strict action under the law," she had said.

Justice P Sam Koshy recommended as Delhi HC Chief Justice by SC Collegium

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 26



Telangana High Court Acting Chief Justice P Sam Koshy

THE SUPREME Court on Monday, during its collegium meeting, recommended the elevation of Telangana High Court Acting Chief Justice P Sam Koshy as the Chief Justice of Delhi High Court.

The Delhi High Court is currently operating under Acting Chief Justice Nitin Sambre after its incumbent Chief Justice DK Upadhyaya was elevated to the Supreme Court on October 6.

Justice Koshy is currently serving as Acting Chief Justice of Telangana High Court after its Chief Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh was elevated to the top court on October 6. Justice Koshy, who is at the 13th place in the all-India seniority list of the high court judges, is set to retire in April 2029.

While Justice Koshy started his legal career in Madhya Pradesh High Court at Jabalpur, his practice broadly involved civil, constitutional, service and labour matters. He subsequently practiced at the Chhattisgarh High Court at Bilaspur from 2001 until 2013, where he was also the government advocate between 2002-2004.

He was also the Deputy Advocate General in 2005-06, and was also a counsel for various public sectors undertakings, banks as well as many private institutions like South East Central Railway, Coal India Limited, South Eastern Coalfields Limited, National Mineral Development Corporation, State Bank of India, Indian Oil Corporation Limited, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited, and Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited. He was appointed as an additional judge of the Chhattisgarh High court, his parent high court, in September 2013, and was made a permanent judge in 2016. He was transferred to the Telangana High Court in July 2023.

RAID IN GREATER NOIDA LED TO ARREST OF SIX MEN

DU student 'duped' of Rs 6,500, probe leads police to Rs 30-crore cyber fraud

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 26



The six accused in police custody. EXPRESS

IN JUNE, Fatima, a second-year student at Delhi University's Ramjas College, was allegedly scrolling on Instagram when she came across an advertisement of Kavya Kurti, an apparel firm selling kurtas for women. She clicked on it and took her pick.

"When she was ready to order, she was redirected to WhatsApp. She placed an order worth ₹799 and paid ₹400 in advance through a QR code," said a police officer.

What Fatima was allegedly unaware of was that the firm was fake, and the linked account was part of a Rs 30 crore cyber fraud, according to police.

After placing the order, as per the investigators, Fatima got a call with demands for more payment — a trap usually followed by cyber fraudsters. "On contacting the seller, she was asked to pay ₹1,150 as a refundable charge for generating the code, followed by further payments of ₹2,000, ₹2,650 and ₹650 on similar pretexts. Despite receiving the payments, the alleged seller neither delivered the parcel nor refunded the amount," said DCP (North) Niharika Bhatt.

After Fatima realised that she was duped of Rs 6,500, she lodged a complaint with the Cyber Police, said officers. An investigation was taken up, led by ACP Vishesh Dhatterwal and Additional (DCP) Ram Dulesh Meena.

Police tracked the payment trail, which led them to an alleged shell corporation.

"The cheated amount was traced through Pine Labs Merchant to a Canara Bank account of Kizentech Solutions Pvt. Ltd., Greater Noida linked to Aditya Mishra and Udit Pratap Singh Bhadauriya," said a police officer.

Investigators also tracked the online orders made through the suspected Whatsapp number on various apps, and found links to an address in Greater Noida. This premises was raided, and six men — Aditya Mishra, Ayush Verma, Abhishek Pal, Himanshu Rana, Rahul Kumar and Gaurav Pandey — were nabbed.

"Raids at rented premises in Greater Noida uncovered three suspected firms—Kizentech Solutions Pvt. Ltd., Executive Edge and Nexcore. Several mobile phones, SIM cards, banking documents and electronic devices were recovered," said DCP Bhatt.

All six accused, police said, were well-educated tech-savvy individuals. With a BBA degree, Pandey was allegedly the mastermind.

He paid others in the syndicate Rs. 25,000 each, and told them the know-how of setting up companies and opening accounts.

"Aditya Mishra disclosed that he, along with Udit Pratap Singh Bhadauriya, Ayush Verma and Abhishek Pal, had established fake firms and opened current bank accounts. They handed the details of the accounts to Himanshu Rana and Rahul Kumar against a monthly payment of ₹25,000," said DCP Bhatt.

Further leads resulted in the arrest of Udit Pratap Singh Bhadauriya from Kanpur on October 10, taking the total to seven arrests.

Rana and Rahul would give the account documents, and kits to Pandey, who would then give it to Maxwell and Solitaire for a commission. These accounts were allegedly used to receive and route money obtained through cyber frauds.

Police then got to know that it wasn't just one, but three shell companies operated by the group, already siphoned Rs. 30 crore worth of cyber proceeds.

ADVERTORIAL



Navigating the Future

Transforming India's Inland Waterways and Maritime Logistics



"Inland waterways are emerging as the watershed moment in India's logistics and transport ecosystem. Under the visionary leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi ji, we are witnessing a transformational shift with policy interventions like the National Waterways Act, 2016, the Inland Vessels Act, 2021 and supplemented by multiple initiatives like Jalvahak scheme, Jal Samriddhi scheme, Jalyan and Navic among others."

SARBANANDA SONOWAL
Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways



"IWAI has been making several infrastructural interventions to develop waterways as a robust engine of growth. With its concerted efforts, IWAI is expanding its footprint throughout the country – from Arunachal Pradesh in the East to Gujarat in the West and Jammu and Kashmir in the North to Kerala in the South."

VIJAY KUMAR
Secretary, Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways

ESTABLISHED on October 27, 1986, under an Act of Parliament, the Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI), under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, has played a pivotal role in developing and regulating India's inland waterways for shipping and navigation. As the Authority marks its 40th Raising Day, it celebrates four decades of progress while looking ahead to a future in which inland water transport becomes an integral part of India's sustainable logistics network.

India has an extensive network of more than 20,000 km of national waterways. The National Waterways Act, 2016, designated 111 National Waterways (NWs), comprising five existing and 106 newly declared waterways. Of these, 32 National Waterways, covering a navigable length of 5,155 km, are currently operational, creating new opportunities for cargo movement, regional connectivity and river-based tourism.

Initiatives and Key Achievements

Inland water transport offers a compelling alternative to road and rail, which often require extensive land acquisition. By leveraging existing river systems, it can deliver fuel efficiency, lower emissions and cost-effective transportation, particularly for bulk commodities such as coal, cement, fertilisers, foodgrains and automobiles.



Over the past decades, India's inland water transport sector has undergone a significant transformation. The number of National Waterways has increased from 5 in 2013-14 to 111 in 2025-26, while the annual budget for their development has grown from ₹183 crore in 2013-14 to ₹1,425 crore in 2025-26. The number of multimodal terminals has risen from one to four, and 143 jetties have been established to strengthen last-mile connectivity and improve access to river transport.

Several flagship initiatives have further accelerated this transformation

The Jal Marg Vikas Project (JMVP) has been instrumental in developing a 1,390-km stretch of NW-1 along the Ganga, connecting Varanasi in Uttar Pradesh with Haldia in West Bengal. The project was implemented with financial and technical assistance from the World Bank. Key infrastructure includes navigable fairways, multimodal terminals at Varanasi, Sahibganj and Haldia, an intermodal terminal at Kalughat, and a navigational lock at Farakka. More than 70 community jetties have also been developed to improve local accessibility, strengthen connectivity and support riverine livelihoods.

Roll-on/Roll-off (Ro-Ro) and Roll-on/Roll-off Passenger (Ro-Pax) services in Assam, Kerala, Bihar and West Bengal are helping improve regional connectivity and ease road congestion by facilitating the movement of passengers and vehicles across rivers. These services demonstrate how waterways can complement existing transport networks while offering practical alternatives for local mobility.

The government is encouraging private investment in terminals, cargo handling and vessel development to accelerate infrastructure creation and foster innovation. IWAI's Jal Samriddhi portal simplifies approvals for setting up jetties and terminals on National Waterways, facilitating private-sector participation, improving logistics efficiency and strengthening multimodal connectivity.

Technology is also reshaping inland navigation. Naudarshika, the National River Traffic and Navigation System, provides real-time river information to enhance navigational safety, streamline vessel operations and improve the overall efficiency of inland water transport.

Unprecedented Cargo Growth and Emerging Trends

Cargo movement on National Waterways has recorded remarkable growth, increasing from 18 million metric tonnes (MMT) in 2013-14 to a record 218 MMT in 2025-26. This expansion reflects the growing commercial viability of inland water transport and its increasing acceptance as a reliable logistics option. Building on this momentum, India aims to raise cargo traffic on inland waterways to 270 MMT by 2030 and 500 MMT by 2047.



The Jalvahak Scheme is helping accelerate this shift by encouraging cargo movement from road and rail to inland waterways. Under the scheme, eligible long-distance voyages qualify for reimbursement of 35% of actual operating expenditure. Its scope has been expanded this year to also include vessel operators alongside cargo owners, as well as Indian-flagged vessels registered under the Indian Vessels Act, 2021. Scheduled cargo services on designated routes along NW-1 (Ganga River), NW-2 (Brahmaputra River) and NW-16 (Barak River) further demonstrate the potential of this initiative to improve commercial viability and encourage greater utilisation of waterways.

Sustainability is emerging as a defining feature of the sector's future. As India pursues its target of achieving net-zero emissions by 2070, inland water transport is well positioned to contribute to cleaner and more energy-efficient logistics. Under the Harit Nauka initiative, IWAI is promoting greener vessel technologies and cleaner fuels. The introduction of India's first indigenously built hydrogen fuel cell-powered vessel in Varanasi, alongside the expanding fleet of hybrid-electric catamarans in Varanasi, Ayodhya, Kolkata and other parts of the country, reflects the sector's growing commitment to green mobility.

Digitalisation is complementing these advancements by improving operational efficiency and ease of doing business. IWAI has developed several digital platforms, including CAR-D (Cargo Data Portal), Vessel Tracker and the PANI portal, along with Jalyan and NAVIC, which support centralised information management for vessels and crews. Together, these systems are helping improve transparency, information access and the coordination of inland waterway operations.

A skilled workforce is essential to sustaining the sector's expansion. Activities ranging from vessel design and construction to vessel operations, fairway maintenance, terminal management, river cruises and ancillary services require specialised expertise. To address emerging skill requirements and support the ambitious targets under Maritime India Vision 2030 and Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047, IWAI has developed a capacity-building plan to bridge skill gaps and prepare personnel for the sector's evolving needs.

Challenges and Opportunities

Despite its considerable potential, India's inland water transport sector must overcome several challenges to realise its full promise.

Depth and navigability remain important concerns, as many rivers are seasonal and require continuous dredging and careful hydrological management to maintain navigable conditions. IWAI is addressing these requirements through end-to-end dredging activities and sustained fairway maintenance to support reliable vessel movement.

Infrastructure development is another priority. Modern jetties, terminals, multimodal hubs and digital tracking systems are being developed across National Waterways to facilitate efficient cargo handling, strengthen connectivity and integrate waterways with other modes of transport.

Limited vessel availability also constrains the sector's expansion. A substantial increase in the fleet, including vessels powered by hybrid and other green propulsion technologies, will be essential to meet future demand. Policy measures such as Ship Building Financial Policy 2.0 and the Maritime Development Fund are intended to encourage vessel owners and shipbuilders. IWAI is also developing ship repair facilities at Pandu, Varanasi and Patna. In addition, its partnership with German logistics company Rhenus Logistics envisages the deployment of 100 new barges across India's National Waterways, strengthening fleet capacity and supporting higher cargo volumes.

Addressing these challenges through sustained investment, policy support, technological innovation and private-sector participation will be critical to building a resilient and competitive inland water transport ecosystem.

Charting New Horizons in River Cruise Tourism

Beyond cargo transportation, inland waterways are opening up opportunities in river cruise tourism, with the potential to stimulate local economies, generate employment and create sustainable livelihood opportunities for communities along riverbanks.

India's river cruise ecosystem has expanded significantly, with the number of overnight river cruise vessels increasing from three to 26. IWAI has supported this growth by strengthening tourism infrastructure through assured navigable depths, round-the-clock navigational aids, modern passenger terminals, electric shore-power connectivity and pilotage services.

The MV Ganga Vilas has emerged as a prominent symbol of India's river cruise potential. Recognised in the Limca Book of Records for its 3,200-km journey across 27 river systems in India and Bangladesh, the vessel has brought international attention to the country's diverse riverine landscapes and its prospects as a global river cruise destination.


Ganga Vilas

IWAI is working with State Governments to promote sustainable river tourism and develop supporting infrastructure across National Waterways. Key initiatives include cruise terminal development in Varanasi, Kolkata, Patna and Guwahati; cruise tourism on the Narmada and Yamuna; and eco-tourism along the Ravi, Chenab and Jhelum in Jammu and Kashmir, where construction and vessel procurement have commenced on the Jhelum. In the North-east, cruise facilities are also being developed at Silghat, Bishwanath Ghat and Neamati to enhance regional tourism potential.

Looking ahead, IWAI plans to develop 51 new river cruise circuits across 47 National Waterways in 14 States and three Union Territories by 2028. Collaboration with State Governments and private-sector stakeholders is also helping explore experiential, destination-based and sustainable tourism models that can broaden visitor experiences while generating economic opportunities for riverine communities.

Key Targets for Transforming India's Inland Water Transport Sector

India's inland water transport sector is poised for significant growth, with a focus on sustainable logistics, economic development and enhanced connectivity. Under Maritime India Vision 2030, the sector aims to achieve cargo movement of 270 MMT by 2030, increasing to 500 MMT by 2047 under Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047.

The operationalisation of 20 additional National Waterways will expand the network and strengthen inland connectivity, while the development of National Waterway-5 will link Odisha's mineral-rich and industrial regions with ports along the eastern coast. With operations currently spanning 23 States and four Union Territories, further expansion will strengthen regional linkages and improve last-mile connectivity.

These initiatives are expected to reduce logistics costs, ease pressure on road and rail networks, lower carbon emissions and enhance regional connectivity, reinforcing the role of inland waterways in building a more efficient, sustainable and integrated transport system.

Tourism and urban mobility are also emerging as key growth areas. Alongside the development of dedicated cruise terminals, IWAI is working to promote Water Metro services in select cities on pan-India basis. Integrating waterways into urban transport networks can improve connectivity, ease road congestion and promote tourism, while providing commuters with an efficient and sustainable mobility alternative.

Vision and Future Outlook

As IWAI celebrates four decades of service, India's inland waterways sector stands at an important turning point. Strong policy support, growing public and private investment, modern infrastructure and technological innovation are creating the conditions for inland water transport to play a much larger role in the country's logistics and economic landscape.

The progress achieved over the years has brought inland waterways into sharper focus as a viable complement to road and rail transport. Continued investment in navigability, terminals, vessel capacity, digital systems, green technologies and river tourism will be essential to sustain this momentum and unlock the sector's full potential.

With its expanding network, rising cargo volumes and growing emphasis on sustainable mobility, inland water transport is poised to become an important pillar of India's logistics ecosystem. As the country advances towards its 2030 and 2047 development goals, IWAI's continued efforts will help shape a future defined by efficient transportation, stronger regional connectivity, inclusive economic opportunities and environmental responsibility.

Four decades after its establishment, IWAI's journey reflects the growing recognition that India's rivers are not merely natural resources, but vital avenues for commerce, connectivity and sustainable development. The next phase of growth offers an opportunity to transform this potential into lasting national progress, helping build a cleaner, better-connected and more competitive India.



"Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi Ji's vision for a strong and self-reliant India under Viksit Bharat 2047 has the maritime sector playing a central role in driving economic growth and global connectivity. Inland waterways offer a cost-effective, fuel-efficient and eco-friendly transport solution, set to play a key role in India's sustainable logistics future."

SHANTANU THAKUR
Minister of State for Ports, Shipping and Waterways



"IWAI's four-decade journey reflects India's growing recognition of rivers as vital economic assets. With 20 additional National Waterways expected to become operational in the coming years and a robust urban waterways network taking shape, India is moving towards a more sustainable, efficient and cost-effective transport system. The development of National Waterway-5 will be a significant milestone, connecting Odisha's mineral-rich and industrial regions of Talcher and Kalinganagar with ports along the eastern coast, strengthening multimodal logistics connectivity and opening new opportunities for regional economic growth."

SUSHIL KUMAR LOHANI
Chairman, Inland Waterways Authority of India

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL



Marriage Party

THE WEDDING of Syed Arbaz Hussain, the son of former Union minister and senior BJP leader Shahnawaz Hussain, became an occasion for the BJP's Bihar leaders to get together. Hussain organised the wedding reception at 3 Safdarjung Road, the official residence of his party colleague and Tribal Affairs Minister Jual Oram. On Monday, BJP president Nitin Nabin led a group of party leaders from Bihar at the venue and blessed the newlywed couple. The celebrations spanned four days so everyone could attend at least one function. Union ministers, NDA MPs, former MPs, senior leaders and a handful of officials attended the marriage in the Capital.

'Credit Theft'

AN MP from a Left party is unhappy about not getting the "credit" for an idea floated by him — to hold a "public impeachment" of CEC Gyanesh Kumar in the Capital by the INDIA bloc leadership. Sources said the MP floated the idea during the recent high tea hosted by Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi at his Sunehri Bagh residence. Sources said the "public impeachment" of Gyanesh Kumar, who is in the eye of a storm over "vote chori" allegations, will be held on October 30.

5-Second Record

IT WAS a special moment for bureaucrat couple Akhilesh Jha and Rashmita Jha, who document history through gramophone records and have authored a book marking 150 years of *Vande Mataram*, when their vinyl album, *The Anthem: Vande Mataram*, was released on Monday. Playback singer A Hariharan, who has lent his voice to the album, recalled that he took just five seconds to agree when Akhilesh Jha approached him with the proposal to compose and sing the National Song. Akhilesh Jha is currently posted as Chief Controller of Accounts, Ministry of Rural Development, and Rashmita Jha, an IRS officer, is serving as Chief Vigilance Officer, NTPC. Earlier in the day, the couple and Hariharan presented a copy of the album to President Droupadi Murmu.

After VHP letter, Gujarat drops poem from Diwali magazine

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, October 26

THE GUJARAT government has replaced a poem by the well-known ghazal writer and journalist, Aziz Tankarvi, from its annual festive publication issued ahead of Diwali, following objections from the Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP).

Sources confirmed to *The Indian Express* that the poem, '*Prem Ma Na Hoy Kain Evi Sharat* (There can be no such conditions in love) was dropped from 'Gujarat Deepotsavi Ank', that Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel released on October 21, after the objection. Fresh copies will be published with the poem replaced by another one.

Ashwin Patel, Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) secretary for the Gujarat region, wrote to the Chief Minister on October 23, alleging that the poem "hurts religious sentiments".

FIRST STATE TO BRING LEGAL FRAMEWORK FOR WELFARE OF THE ELDERLY

Keralam House passes Bill to protect senior citizens' rights

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 26



Chief Minister V D Satheesan at the state Assembly in Thiruvananthapuram on Monday. PTI

WHAT THE LAW RECOGNISES

INDEPENDENT LIVING Right to live safely and independently at home, with institutional care as the last resort.

LIVING WILLS Document their preferences on intensive-care admission and other life-sustaining medical interventions.

REGULATION OF CENTRES Prescribes standards for care centres, retirement homes, hospices and caregiver training centres to protect residents from abuse and exploitation.

CERTIFICATION State certification framework with prescribed training and mandatory police clearance for caregivers.

PENALTIES FOR VIOLATION Imprisonment and fines for running unregistered centres, cruelty, obstructing implementation, abuse, abandonment and failure to report suspected abuse.

THE KERALAM Legislative Assembly passed on Monday the Senior Citizens (Care and Protection of Rights) Bill, 2026, India's first state-level legal framework aimed at elder welfare.

Chief Minister V D Satheesan, who piloted the Bill in the Assembly, said he considered the legislation "as the first realisation of the fact that our world is changing".

"The changes taking place across the world due to demographic transition must be viewed seriously. We are living in an era when these demographic changes are becoming a threat even to nations across the world," he said.

For ageing Keralam, the law is a significant move — it envisages making elder care rights-based, regulated and professional. The Bill, presented in the Assembly earlier this month, was referred to the Assembly's subject committee and passed after incorporating amendments suggested by MLAs.

A major highlight of the Bill is that it recognises a senior citizen's ability to live safely and independently in their home, with institutional care being the last resort. The Bill also recognises a living will — a declaration of a senior citizen's choices and preferences regarding end-of-life situations. A senior citizen can execute a will stating their choices regarding intensive-care admission, invasive tubes and other life-sustaining medical interventions.

The Bill makes elder care affordable, accessible and non-discriminatory, whether home care, day care, assisted living, hospice care or emergency medical assistance.

It gives priority to vulnerable senior women, including widows, abandoned people, people with disabilities, survivors of violence, and homeless or destitute women.

Among other things, it envisages senior-friendly public spaces, including ramps, priority seating and queues, and accessible washrooms.

The concept of care and welfare has been expanded beyond food, clothing, shelter and medical treatment to social services, recreation, and participation in spiritual, social and cultural activities. This approach places emphasis on comfort and dignified living, particularly for incapacitated and differently abled senior citizens.

Another major component of the Bill is the regulatory system for care centres and related agencies and institutions. All care centres, retirement homes, hospices, agencies and caregiver training centres will have prescribed standards, ensure social and recreational opportunities, and protect residents from abuse and exploitation. Caregivers' rights to fair pay, safe working conditions and social security will be protected.

The Bill proposes the establishment of the Keralam Geriatric Care Certification Framework to provide progressive certification for caregivers. The framework will specify a training curriculum and require background verification of caregivers, including mandatory police clearance for those deployed in senior citizen care centres or providing live-in care to a senior citizen living alone.

The Bill also envisages penal provisions for running an unregistered centre. Obstructing the Act's implementation can result in up to two years' imprisonment and a fine of up to Rs 25,000. Illegal possession of a resident's property, abuse or cruelty, and abandonment can each result in up to three years' imprisonment and a fine of up to Rs 50,000. Failure to report suspected abuse when required can attract a fine of up to Rs 10,000. Offences are cognisable and bailable.



PM Narendra Modi, Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla and Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman Harivansh with delegates attending the 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum at the Parliament complex, Monday. PTI

Parliaments have responsibility to listen to young voices: Birla

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 26

LOK SABHA Speaker Om Birla on Monday said Parliaments have the responsibility to "listen to young voices", underlining the importance of "harnessing the aspirations of the youth" in the process of nation-building.

Speaking at the inauguration of the two-day BRICS Parliamentary Forum hosted by India at Parliament House, Birla said: "Parliaments had a vital responsibility to listen to young voices, understand their hopes and concerns, and create pathways through which their energy, creativity and capabilities could be channelled into nation-building."

He said youths are now equipped with growing access to quality education and technological knowledge, alongside an immense desire to innovate, excel and contribute to society.

"The aspirations of the youth must be met with meaningful opportunities, dignity and an enabling environment in which their talents could flourish," he said.

The Speaker said young people were not merely an investment in their individual futures but a commitment to the collective destiny of nations.

"Their strength lay not merely in their Constitutional authority but also in their ability to foster constructive dialogue, build consensus, uphold transparency and remain steadfastly accountable to the citizens they represent," he said.

Welcoming the BRICS parliamentary leaders, Birla said the diversity of the BRICS nations was an asset. "By sharing experiences, exchanging best practices and learning from one another's institutional strengths, their parliaments could collectively devise innovative responses to shared challenges. Such sustained engagement, he said, would help lay the foundations of a more equitable, inclusive and peaceful world," a Lok Sabha Secretariat statement said.

"Parliaments, as vibrant expressions of the people's will, could serve as bridges of understanding, strengthen mutual confidence, ease international tensions and help advance peaceful and constructive responses to global challenges," Birla said.

Calling for renewed commitment among BRICS member countries, the Speaker urged them to transform experience into joint action and dialogue into concrete and meaningful cooperation.

The Speaker noted that the adoption of the joint statement at the BRICS Summit earlier this year marked a significant milestone. He said that BRICS had the added responsibility of amplifying the voice of the Global South.

Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha Harivansh also addressed the gathering. He highlighted the role of BRICS, saying it represents around 49.5% of the world's population.

The theme of the 12th edition of the BRICS Parliamentary Forum is "Strengthening Parliaments for People-Centric Development". Prime Minister Narendra Modi also interacted with the BRICS Parliamentary leaders on Monday.

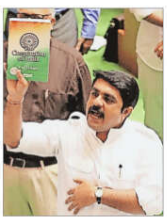
— WITH PTI INPUTS

EXPRESS special

'Transfer' of votes in Goa from one seat to another: Probe says no proof of illegality

Inquiry based on GFP chief Vijay Sardesai's complaint

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, October 26



Vijai Sardesai alleged that over 50 voters from Curtorim were transferred to his constituency Fatorda, which he won by less than 1,600 votes in 2022

A PRELIMINARY inquiry ordered by the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), Goa, has found no basis in allegations that some voters were "illegally transferred" from Curtorim Assembly constituency to Fatorda seat in South Goa.

As per the inquiry report, voters were added to the Fatorda electoral roll after the processing of Form 6 applications for inclusion — as per the prescribed legal procedures — during the Special Summary Revision (SSR) exercise in the state in 2017. Moreover, says the preliminary inquiry, since 2017, no Form 7 application seeking deletion of any names has been filed by any political party.

On October 16, Fatorda MLA and Goa Forward Party (GFP) chief Vijai Sardesai filed a complaint with the CEO's office claiming that more than 50 voters from Curtorim were "unlawfully migrated" to the electoral roll of Fatorda, while retaining their original house numbers.

Sardesai said: "Those electors were part of Curtorim Assembly segment during the 2012 and 2017 general elections. However, they mysteriously and illegally appeared in the electoral roll of Fatorda Assembly constituency for 2022 and 2026."

The CEO ordered an inquiry subsequently into Sardesai's complaint. Its preliminary probe report says it examined the available records regarding the SSR of 2017, and notes that then too, the GFP had submitted a complaint alleging that 53 voters of Curtorim Assembly seat had been moved to Fatorda constituency. The probe report admits that these 53 earlier figured in the electoral roll for Curtorim, but adds: "... during the claims and objections period, 96 persons submitted Form 6 applications seeking inclusion of their names in the electoral roll of Fatorda Assembly constituency. Of these, 31 applications were accepted by the Electoral Registration Officer, Fatorda, while the remaining were rejected. Consequently, the names of 31 whose applications were accepted were deleted from Curtorim... and included in Fatorda... in the supplementary electoral roll."

The report adds that the records hence "indicate that the inclusion of these 31 electors in Fatorda... was preceded by the submission and processing of Form 6 applications", and says that copies of these applications are available in the office of the Electoral Registration Officer, Fatorda.

Noting that no application for deletion of any names for the Fatorda electoral roll has been filed by any political party since 2017, the report says this holds true for even the recently concluded Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

In the 2022 Assembly elections in the state, Fatorda had been the only seat won by the GFP, which contested the election in alliance with the Congress. Sardesai won the constituency defeating the BJP's Damodar 'Damu' Naik by a narrow 1,527 votes. However, the GFP is now an ally of the Aam Aadmi Party, announcing a tie-up for the 2027 Assembly polls under the banner 'Goa First', and declaring that they were open to all parties except the BJP and Congress.

The Curtorim seat is represented by Aleixo Reginaldo Lourenco, an Independent MLA who backs the BJP-led government. In the 2022 polls, Lourenco had won the seat by 5,000-plus votes.

'Nobody will be prosecuted': SC on deleted voters submitting Form 6

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 26

THE SUPREME Court on Monday sought to allay fears that voters whose names were deleted from the electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) and have submitted Form 6 for re-entry may be committing an offence since the process is meant for enrolling new voters.

"Nobody will be prosecuted," Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, presiding over a three-judge bench, remarked while hearing a petition challenging the SIR in Maharashtra.

Appearing for the petitioner Arun Anandagiri, Senior Advocate Arvind Datar said that the Election Commission of India (ECI) had asked deleted voters to submit Form 6 to register as fresh voters. He pointed out that Form 6 is meant for first-time voters; therefore, deleted voters filling it up may be committing an offence.

"There is no form for deleted voters, and only Form 6 is there. If I file Form 6 as an existing voter, it is an offence because I am filing a false Form. Form 6 is only for a new voter," Datar said. He added that the Delhi High Court had said that there would be no prosecution, but that may not be enough. He urged the court that there should be some new form for those reapplying.

Datar said that in Maharashtra, 33 per cent of the voters had been struck off the rolls and in parts of Pune and Mumbai, the figure is 40 per cent. He added that 1.22 crore names were deleted over logical discrepancies.

He urged the court to direct the ECI not to finalise the rolls now. "Let them not finalise the electoral roll now because Maharashtra does not have any immediate elections," he said, adding that "if 33 per cent people have been deleted, it may take some time to bring them back".

Issuing notice to the ECI, the CJI said, "You are a whistleblower. You have come to us. We will take care of the rest of the (rest)".

To a query from the bench, the counsel pointed out that Monday (October 26) is the last date for filing claims and objections and November 6 is the date for publishing the draft roll.

Datar requested the court to hear the matter before the draft is published. The CJI, however, said that if the court is convinced that there are people who still need time to submit their documents, it would issue appropriate directions.

Datar said that his apprehension was that the EC might not accept objections after the last date. The CJI asked, "How can they say ... we have been extending the dates in all cases." Datar then urged the court to extend the dates for Maharashtra, too.

He pointed out that "there are a lot of redevelopment projects in Mumbai and Pune. Old housing complexes are demolished and they are reconstructed. So, where 1,000 people are staying, they will get fresh flats and 2,000 new people will come. So, all these 1,000 people will be given accommodation in some other part of Mumbai. What they have done is they have said the person was not found and they completely deleted. So, 3,500 redevelopment projects in Mumbai alone and about 1,500 in Pune. This is a peculiar problem to Maharashtra."

The bench, however, expressed reluctance in passing any ex-parte order. "Can your Lordships at least say that objections received after today will also be entertained," said Datar.

The CJI said, "That will amount to extending the date. We will do it after hearing them."

The court fixed November 5 to hear it next.

AMRIT SINGH DARREN TOOK OBJECTION TO A CAFE-CUM-CONTEMPORARY ART SPACE THAT FEATURES BOTH MAHATMA GANDHI AND JINNAH

UP vlogger, Keralam cafe, and a political storm that united Cong, CPM & BJP

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 26

A UP vlogger's attempt to portray Kochi's Kashi Art Cafe, a cafe-cum-contemporary art space, as a symbol of an alleged Muslim threat to Kerala has triggered a political backlash, bringing the ruling Congress and Opposition CPI(M) together in defence of the state's secular identity and communal harmony.

The BJP, too, has weighed in, with its state president Rajeev Chandrasekhar saying that only the Malayalis get to decide what is to be done in Kerala, even as it slammed the ruling Congress government for allegedly not responding to those "making anti-India statements".

Fort Kochi Police booked Vlogger Amrit Singh Darren on Saturday after he uploaded on his Instagram page a video from inside the cafe, showing an artwork featuring Mahatma Gandhi and Muhammad Ali Jinnah and stating that the Pakistan founder's portrait in the eatery was an insult to national pride. He also took objection to the cafe named after Kashi, a holy city for Hindus, serving beef dishes, stating it should rename itself.

He was booked on charges of causing public mischief, the spread of false or alarming information, and provocation leading to riots via social media [Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) sections 353 (2) and 192)]. Darren is yet to be arrested.

Chief Minister V D Satheesan said the law will take its course. "The recent Instagram video...attempting to spread misinformation about Fort Kochi, portrays our state in a negative light, and divides communities, is unacceptable. The UDF government remains committed to communal harmony and justice without fear or favour. No room for hate. We will not allow anyone to even lay a finger on our communal harmony," he wrote on X.

Opposition leader and former CM Pinarayi Vijayan also joined in on the issue. "A vlogger peddling hate for profit seeks to paint these vibrant destinations in communal colours.



Amrit Singh Darren

Having failed to divide Keralam, the Sangh Parivar is outsourcing its hate campaign to online provocateurs. But Keralam's secular spirit will not yield to their politics of hatred. The state Government must take strict legal action against those spreading communal enmity," he said.

Bharatiya Janata Party's (BJP) Chandrasekhar wrote on X: "Malayalees will decide what is to be done in Keralam, what can be eaten, what can be spoken, what can be sung, what we celebrate. Hindu Malayalee, Christian Malayalee, or Muslim Malayalee: we will decide our future and shape our future collectively."

Taking on the CM, he, however, said: "It is not enough to respond only when something is said against PFI or a particular community. The CM must respond when Hindus and patriots find people making anti-India statements, and when people who encourage Hamas are allowed to do so without any reaction from the state."

Meanwhile, BJP national council member and chairman of the National Film Development Corporation G Krishna Kumar's daughter Diya also found herself in a controversy after commenting on the video. Later, she tendered an apology for allegedly appearing to attest to the vlogger's views.

Krishna clarified her "sad reality" comment was about the display of Jinnah's portrait. "The video discusses two different subjects. The first was about Jinnah's photo... This is a subject on which I have my opinion, and I still stand by my view that I find it questionable." But she took exception to the remarks on beef and the Muslim community. "I would never endorse content that demeans a community or questions their place in society. To everyone who has been hurt by this, I sincerely apologise," she said on her Instagram handle.

Kashi Art Cafe and Gallery is a café-cum-art gallery situated in a restored Dutch-style house on Burgher Street, Fort Kochi. Artworks hang on the walls and installations are positioned at different spots inside the café, which was opened in 1997. Anoop Skaria and Dorrie Younger founded the gallery. It was one of the sites of the first Kochi-Muziris Biennale in 2012, and the artist Rajan Krishnan had his first solo show here in 2004. Now the cafe is owned by Edgar Pinto.



युवा कार्यक्रम एवं खेल मंत्रालय
MINISTRY OF YOUTH AFFAIRS AND SPORTS
सत्यमेव जयते

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भारत - न्यूज़ीलैंड मित्रता के 100 वर्ष

अंडर-20 रग्बी सीरीज़ 2026

रग्बी के माध्यम से एकजुटता

भारत और न्यूज़ीलैंड के बीच मैत्री के 100 वर्ष पूर्ण होने के उपलक्ष्य में अंडर-20 बालक - बालिका एवं मिश्रित टीमों के बीच मुकाबलों का आयोजन

27 अक्टूबर 2026 | संध्या 5:00 बजे से

राज्य खेल परिसर, राजगीर, बिहार

आइए, खेल के माध्यम से

भारत और न्यूज़ीलैंड

की ऐतिहासिक मित्रता का उत्सव मनाएं



RUGBY INDIA

VS

NEW ZEALAND RUGBY



निवेदक

खेल विभाग, बिहार सरकार
बिहार राज्य खेल प्राधिकरण रग्बी इंडिया
और सूचना एवं जनसंपर्क विभाग द्वारा जनहित में जारी

PR.NO-01447/(SPORTS)D.2026-27

Sankaran Naren, ED and CIO at ICICI Prudential AMC, is guest at Explained.Live today





Express News Service
New Delhi, October 26

AMONG THE factors that have been bothering equity market investors is the subdued performance and negative returns over the last two years at least. While the benchmark Sensex breached the 73,000 mark for the first time in January 2024, 33-months since, the Sensex is still trading at similar levels as it has been dealing with challenges such as two ongoing wars, volatility in oil prices and an overhang of pending trade deal with the United States among others.

To talk about factors that have dampened market sentiments, state of fundamentals of the Indian economy and corporate India and factors that would be vital for its breakout going forward, Sankaran Naren, ED and CIO at ICICI Prudential AMC, will be our guest at Explained.Live on Tuesday.

Naren would also provide clarity and insights on other festering issues, including overvaluation of Indian markets; weakening rupee, to rising interest rates and slowdown in growth; and whether equity markets will see a rally after resolution on US trade deal and waning of US-Iran tensions.

He will be in conversation with Sandeep Singh, National Bureau chief, *The Indian Express*.

Explained.Live is a unique series of explanatory conversations that *The Indian Express* hosts from time to time.

Expert Guests at Explained.Live sessions have included former Indian ambassador to China Gautam Bambawale, former Foreign Secretary Shyam Saran, former Indian High Commissioner to Bangladesh Pinak Ranjan Chakravarty, former Indian ambassador to Russia D B Venkatesh Varma, former Foreign Secretary and Indian ambassador to China Vijay Gokhale, former Deputy NSA Pankaj Saran, former Indian ambassador to UAE Navdeep Suri, former Indian High Commissioner to Pakistan T C A Raghavan, former G20 Sous Sherpa J S Mukul, IIT-Delhi Director Ramgopal Rao, Kerala's Health Minister K K Shailaja, Public Health Foundation of India president Dr K Srinath Reddy, industrialist Naushad Forbes, capital markets expert Nilesh Shah, medical scientist Dr Gagandeep Kang and Mahesh Vyas, MD and CEO of the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy among others.

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TOPIC: EQUITY MARKET RALLY: WHEN WILL IT BREAK OUT?
DATE: OCTOBER 27, 2026
TIME: 6 PM

BJP holds nationwide protests over Kharge's remark on Modi

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, October 26



BJP supporters protest against Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge in New Delhi on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

THE BJP on Monday held nationwide protests over Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge's controversial "baap" remark against Prime Minister Narendra Modi, demanding an apology from him and his party.

Kharge sparked a controversy when he said "*Modi ka baap bhi jayega*" in response to an audience member's comment that "the prime minister will not go anywhere" during an event in Patna on Sunday. Kharge was speaking at a programme to celebrate the 139th birth anniversary of Bihar's first CM, Shrikrishna Singh.

In Delhi, BJP leaders and workers staged a protest near Kharge's residence on Rajaji Marg. The protesters were stopped by police when they tried to march from Sena Bhawan Circle towards his residence. They raised slogans and demanded an apology from Kharge and the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi.

In Bihar, BJP leaders and supporters, led by state unit president Sanjay Saraogi, took out a 'Jan Akrosh March' from the party headquarters to Dak Bungalow Chauraha in Patna and burnt an effigy of Kharge.

In Jammu, BJP workers held a protest at Dogra Chowk under the leadership of party MLA Shagun Parihar and BJYM president Arun Prabhat. According to reports, protests and demonstrations were held in Samba, Kathua, Poonch, Udhampur, Rajouri, Doda, Kishtwar and Reasi districts over the issue.

In Bengaluru, BJP leaders staged a protest at Freedom Park, demanding the Congress president apologise to the people of the country. Police detained several BJP leaders, including Leader of Opposition in the Karnataka Assembly R Ashoka.

Protests were also held in other parts of the country, including Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, West Bengal, Rajasthan and Telangana. In Jharkhand, hundreds of BJP workers and senior leaders of the party, including its state president Aditya Sahu and Leader of Opposition Babulal Marandi, marched to the Congress office in Ranchi, raising slogans like "Stop abusing the Prime Minister" and "India will not tolerate insults to the Prime Minister".

In Uttar Pradesh, the protest was led by BJP Lucknow Mahanagar president Anand Dwivedi, and the demonstrators were holding placards and banners demanding an apology from Congress leader Rahul Gandhi.

In Kolkata, thousands of BJP workers, led by senior party leader and West Bengal minister Tapas Roy, took out a rally. Roy demanded an unconditional apology from Kharge and the Congress for "hurting the sentiments of 140 crore Indians".

China claims it is strictly abiding by pacts with India

Divya A
New Delhi, October 26

DAYS AFTER Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) Director General Shatrujeet Kapur talked about face-offs between Indian and Chinese troops at multiple locations in Arunachal Pradesh, and that the situation continues, Beijing — in its first official comments after the statement — on Monday said it is strictly abiding by the relevant agreements with India and conducts normal border patrols to safeguard its sovereignty.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) had said on Friday that friction points typically occur when Chinese forces depart from established patrolling patterns in border pockets.

Responding to this, Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun said at a media briefing, "China strictly abides by the relevant agreements and common understandings reached between the two countries, and conducts normal border patrol and control activities to safeguard its territorial sovereignty and stability in the border areas."

He said China and India maintain communication through diplomatic and military channels. "We hope that India will work with China in the same direction by jointly implementing the common understandings reached between the two sides and maintaining peace and tranquility in the border areas with concrete actions," Guo said.

Last week, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal had said the situation along the LAC is disturbed from time to time when Chinese forces diverge from established patrolling patterns, asserting that the maintenance of peace and tranquility in the border areas is essential for the overall development of bilateral relations.

"Both sides continue to use existing diplomatic and military mechanisms to resolve outstanding issues and avoid misunderstanding and miscalculation along the LAC," Jaiswal said.

Kapur's comments came over a month after India and China held talks amid reports of tensions in Arunachal Pradesh's Taksing area. While he did not name China, Kapur praised the Indo-Tibetan Border Police's Shaurya Commando teams for handling the situation in Arunachal Pradesh.

"In the past few days, a situation arose where face-offs happened at several locations in Arunachal, and it still continues," Kapur said while speaking at the annual felicitation ceremony for ITBP personnel in Rajasthan's Alwar.

On September 6, the Corps Commander-level talks were held at the Wacha-Damai border meeting point on the Indian side to address ongoing issues along the LAC in the area. India and China have taken a series of measures over the last two years to rebuild their relationship after it came under severe strain following the deadly Galwan clashes in 2020 and the subsequent military face-off that lasted for over four years.

Last month, Prime Minister Narendra Modi held bilateral talks with President Xi Jinping on the margins of the BRICS summit in New Delhi. Modi had stressed that both sides must show sensitivity to each other's core issues and let relations be guided by the "three mutuals" — mutual respect, mutual sensitivity, and mutual interest.

5 killed in shooting incident near hotel in Guwahati

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 26

AT LEAST five people were killed and another was injured in a shooting incident near a hotel in Guwahati on Monday. Senior police officers said the accused was nabbed within an hour of the incident, which took place in city's Bora Service area.

The accused has been identified as Ghanakanta Gogoi. According to preliminary investigations, the matter appeared to stem from a property dispute between the owners of Hotel Bilas Inn and the lessee, Gogoi.

Four of the five deceased belonged to the hotel owner's family, police said.

Addressing the media, Guwahati Commissioner of Police Partha Sarathi Mahanta said that the person injured in the firing incident was undergoing treatment.

"Six persons sustained gunshot injuries and five succumbed to it. The accused has been apprehended and the weapon seized. We think the incident stemmed from a property dispute regarding the lease of the hotel," Mahanta said.

The incident took place around 9 pm. "The accused was apprehended within an hour. Scientific investigation is on," Mahanta said.

Workers trapped at Bengal coal mine after pulley system develops a glitch

Press Trust of India
Kolkata, October 26



Rescue operations underway at the coal mine in Asansol on Monday. PTI

SEVERAL WORKERS were trapped around 50 metres underground at a coal mine in West Bengal's Paschim Bardhaman district on Monday after a technical glitch in the pulley system halted the movement of the lifting cage, a senior official said.

Eastern Coalfields Ltd (ECL) CMD Satish Jha said the incident happened at Kumardihi A underground mine after a rope slipped off the pulley drum, disrupting the mechanism used to transport workers in the cage.

"There were no casualties, and food and water had been supplied to the trapped workers. Work was underway to bring them out safely," he said.

"The workers are stranded at a depth of around 50 metres, while the pulley system extends to about 90 metres," he added.

Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari said rescue operations were underway on a war footing.

"ECL authorities informed state government miners were trapped following a technical fault in the lift. Communication with them was maintained, and adequate ventilation was available inside the mine," he said.

"They (ECL) are repairing the faults. I pray to God for their quick rescue. The Asansol-Durgapur Police Commissioner, the Paschim Bardhaman district magistrate, the chief secretary and the home secretary are in touch with ECL. I do not want to speak much on this," he said.

A team of policemen was deployed at the site.

TN defections: SC junks plea for CBI investigation into 'horse-trading'

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 26

THE SUPREME Court on Monday rejected a plea seeking a CBI probe into "horse-trading" charges against Tamil Nadu minister N Anand of the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) and four AIADMK MLAs who had resigned from the House and joined the TVK.

"We are not inclined to entertain this writ petition. The same is, accordingly, dismissed with liberty to the petitioner to avail appropriate remedy in accordance with law," a three-judge bench presided over by CJI Surya Kant said.

Six AIADMK legislators had resigned from the Assembly and joined the ruling TVK. S Jayakumar, Maragatham Kumaravel and P Sathyabama, elected from Perundurai, Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly constituencies, respectively, resigned as members on May 25, 2026.

Esakki Subaya, elected from the Ambasamudram constituency, resigned the following day. C Vijayabhaskar (Viralimalai) and M R Vijayabhaskar (Karur) resigned on June 16 and 29, respectively. All of them had been elected on AIADMK tickets in the assembly polls.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, was hearing a petition by N Srinivasan, an advocate, who alleged that the "acts" of Anand and the MLAs — K Maragatham Kumaravel, S Jayakumar, P Sathyabama and E Subaya — "are not only corrupt practice but against the mandate of the crores of innocent and responsible citizens".

The plea filed through Advocate Achintya Tiwari said the MLAs "had submitted their resignation on 25.05.2026 to the... Assembly Speaker and immediately within half an hour they joined the TVK ... in front of Tamil Nadu minister Aadhav Arjuna, specifically in the Tamil Nadu secretariat itself".

The petitioner contended if the MLAs had any "personal reasons or difference of opinion with the party after the election, they should have resigned before voting in favour of TVK during the floor test or they should have abstained from voting against the whip in the floor test. Instead of that, they actively and consciously voted in fear of TVK and immediately resigned as MLAs, and they immediately joined...TVK".

The plea urged the SC to exercise powers under Article 142 of the Constitution "to frame specific rules for preventing who is trading after elections with regard to the candidates either resigned or disqualified by the Assembly Speaker till the Parliament either makes the law or rules in this regard".

Office of the Tamil Nadu Health Systems Society
DMS Annex Building, 3rd Floor, 359, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai-600 006

Bids are invited from the Public Sector Health Insurance Companies for Chief Minister's Comprehensive Health Insurance Scheme integrated with Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yogana for 5 years from 11.01.2027.

Sl. No	Authority and Webportal	Requirement Detail
1	Project Director (O/o. The Tamil Nadu Health Systems Society, Chennai-6 (https://tntenders.gov.in) Tender ID: 2026_TNHSP_717642_1	Interested Public Sector Insurance Companies are advised to submit their bids online through https://tntenders.gov.in. portal Further notifications and communication will be published only on the website. Public Sector Insurance Companies are advised to regularly check the website for updates.

for Project Director,
District Revenue Officer,
Tamil Nadu Health Systems Society,
Teynampet, Chennai-600 006.
DIPR/3218/Tender/2026

बिहार सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
सिंचाई प्रमंडल, बिजौखोरवा
(Email ID:-eeirrdivbijikhorba@gmail.com)
शुद्धि पत्र

सिंचाई प्रमंडल, बिजौखोरवा अंतर्गत बदुआ डैम पर अवस्थित सिंचाई निरीक्षण भवन का जीर्णोद्धार कार्य का निविदा इस कार्यालय का पत्रांक 1079 दिनांक 08.10.2026 एवं N.I.T. No-01SBD/2026-27 द्वारा निकाली गई है, जिसका PR No-013486 (WRD) 2026-27 है। इस निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना के कंडिका 23 एवं 34 में निहित शर्त के स्थान पर पथ निर्माण विभाग, पटना का अधिसूचना ज्ञापांक–प्र0–6/ दo विo नियम–03–08/06(अंश) 7461(S)/ पटना, दिनांक–13.10.2026 सह पठित ज्ञापांक–प्र0–6/ दo विo नियम–03–08/06(अंश) 7462(S)/ पटना, दिनांक–13.10.2026 मान्य होगा।

शेष सभी शर्तें यथावत् रहेगी। इसे इस हद तक संशोधित समझा जाय।

PR. No. 014175 (WRD) 2026-27
नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।
कार्यपालक अभियंता,
सिंचाई प्रमंडल, बिजौखोरवा

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

e-Tenders are invited by Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer/Chakradharpur for and on behalf of the President of India against Tender No. mentioned below due to open on **13.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs.** for the following works. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Sl. No. & Tender Notice No.; Name of Work; Tender Value; Earnest Money ; (1) ST-CKP-OT-26-27-119, dated 22.10.2026;** Miscellaneous Telecom works in the section under SSE/Tele/Tatanagar; ₹ 69,54,522.90; ₹ 1,39,100/-. **(2) ST-CKP-OT-26-27-120, dated 22.10.2026;** S&T works for Construction of One additional Loop Line at Badampahar; ₹ 2,78,13,105/-; ₹ 5,56,300/-. **(3) ST-CKP-OT-26-27-121, dated 22.10.2026;** Provision of Railnet connection with GPON technology and Wi-Fi at Jharsuguda station; ₹ 71,45,547.67; ₹ 1,42,900/-. **(4) ST-CKP-OT-26-27-122, dated 22.10.2026;** S&T work in connection with Construction of loop line for 3rd line and one sick siding of 70 M length at Kansbahal; ₹ 3,41,98,399.48; ₹ 6,84,000/-. **(5) ST-CKP-OT-26-27-123, dated 22.10.2026;** S&T work in connection with a long Loop Line at DN Grid and proper pathway in station yard at Barabamboo; ₹ 2,79,19,637.19; ₹ 5,58,400/-. **Completion Period :** 12 (Twelve) Months for sl. no. 1, 15 (Fifteen) Months for sl. no. 2, 4 & 5 and 06 (Six) Months for sl. no. 3. The tender details can be viewed at Website **http://www.ireps.gov.in** The tenderers/ bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered on IREPS portal. Only registered tenderers/ bidders can participate in e-tendering. e-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost. **(PR-937)**

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
सोन नहर प्रमण्डल, बक्सर
scdbuxar@gmail.com
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या – 01 SBD/2026-27
राष्ट्रीय स्पर्धा निविदा
केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार WWW.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
कार्य का विवरण –

युप संo	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रु0 में)	अग्रधन (लाख रु0 में) (ऑन लाईन अथवा फिजिकल / रेगुलर मोड में भुगतेय)	परिशमन–विपत्र का मूल्य (आइटमवाईज (केवल ऑनलाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रु0 में	बेल्टॉन को देय बीड प्रोसेसिंग फी (अपरार्थनीय) (केवल ऑनलाईन मोड में भुगतेय) रु0 में	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	बक्सर शाखा नहर से निःशुल्क बरौली, माहर, सरला, बाबुर बिरौली तथा अन्यपुर, इटाढ़ी, मुकुन्दपुर उमरिहरी, चौगठी जगा पि० सि० एवं पश्चिमी मुख्य नहर से निःशुल्क सिंचाधक एवं सलेया सिलौरी का पुर्नस्थापन कार्य	731.25	14,62,500.00	10,000=00	11800=00	15 मार्च 2027

2. निविदादाता का पदनाम एवं पता :– कार्यपालक अभियंता, सोन नहर प्रमंडल, बक्सर।
3. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि :– दिनांक–21.10.2026
4. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि :– दिनांक 11.11.2026 को 10:30 बजे पूर्वाह्न से दिनांक–19.11.2026 03:00 बजे अपराह्न तक (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
5. प्री– बिड मीटिंग का समय स्थान एवं तिथि :– दिनांक– 15.11.2026 को 3:00 बजे अपराह्न मुख्य अभियंता, सिंचाई सूचना जल संसाधन विभाग डिहरी के कार्यालय कक्ष में
6. तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक– 21.11.2026 समय बजे 03:30 अपराह्न। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
7. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोषित की जायेगी। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
8. निविदा खोलने का स्थान :– केवल वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
9. निविदा की वैधता अवधि :– 120 दिन।

विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाईट https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in एवं www.wrd.fmiscwrdbihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।
निविदा की विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
कार्यपालक अभियंता
सोन नहर प्रमण्डल, बक्सर
मो0–7992428520
PR- 014198 (WRD) 2026-27
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियन्ता का कार्यालय,
सिंचाई प्रमंडल, दाउदनगर।
E-mail ID- irrigationdivision.daudnagar@gmail.com
अल्पकालीन पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या– 03/2026–27
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
1. कार्य का विवरण :–

क्रम संख्या	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रू० में)	अग्रधन की राशि (रू०० में)	परिशमन – विपत्र का मूल्य (आइटमवाईज) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में) (रू० में)	बेल्टॉन को देय बिड प्रोसेसिंग फी (अपरार्थनीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में) (रू० में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	Installation of Over Head Barrier in Service Road of Patna Main Canal at Different Point from km 19.20 to 57.60 (Total 9 Nos) Under Irrigation Division Daudnagar.	64.59346	129200.00	10000.00	1180.00	मार्च 2027

2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि :– दिनांक 22.10.2026
3. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि :– दिनांक 30.10.2026 से दिनांक 05.11.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराह्न तक। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
4. प्री बीड मीटिंग की तिथि, समय एवं स्थान :– दिनांक 03.11.26 के 3:00 बजे अपराह्न में अधीक्षण अभियन्ता का कार्यालय, सोन उच्चस्तरीय नहर अंचल, औरंगाबाद।
5. निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक 05.11.2026 के 3:00 बजे अपराह्न। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
6. तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक 05.11.2026 के 3:30 बजे अपराह्न। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
7. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में घोषित की जायगी। (सिर्फ वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर)
8. निविदा खोलने का स्थान :– www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर
9. निविदा की वैधता की अवधि :– 120 दिन
10. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता :– कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, सिंचाई प्रमंडल, दाउदनगर।
11. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।
PR- 014280 (W R D) 2026-27
कार्यपालक अभियन्ता,
सिंचाई प्रमंडल, दाउदनगर
मो0 न0–07463889729
नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

INDEL MONEY
Corporate office: **Indel Money Limited,** IIIrd Floor Indel House, Changampuzha Nagar, South Kalamassery, Ernakulam -682033 .
Ph: 0484-2933999 E:customercare@indelmoney.com

GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

The pledges in specific and the public in general are hereby notified that public auction of the gold ornaments pledged in the below accounts is proposed to be conducted at the following branches on 27-11-2026 at 11:00 am We are auctioning the gold ornaments of the defaulted customers who have failed to make the payment of his/her loan amount despite being notified through various communication. Unauctioned items shall be auctioned on any other days without notice of changes in venue or date and the same shall be displayed at concerned branches without any further notice.

ADHYAPAK NAGAR - 32904790004233, 32904800004177, 32904850004340, **BADARPUR** - 40104540001638, 40104790001639, 40104800001622, 40104960001665, **KARAWAL** - 33904540004037, 454/04061, 33904790003981, 33904850003993, 33904950003957, 33904960004043, 496/04077, 496/04229, 496/04295, 496/04297, **KIRARI** - 33404960002112, 496/02169, 496/02196, 496/02207, 496/02208, 496/02210, **MAYUR VIHAR** - 35004960001662, **PANKHA ROAD** - 33304800001639, 33304960001513, 496/01537, 496/01539, 496/01542, 496/01564, 496/01601, 496/01641, 496/01648, 496/01649, **POOTHKALAN** - 34004960003662, 496/03755, 496/03768, 496/03787, 496/03830, 496/03851, **RANIBAGH** - 46804960000307, 496/00324, **SHAHABAD DIARY** - 33104850002043, 33104960001999, 496/02005, 496/02022, 496/02047, 496/02052, 496/02066, 496/02088, 496/02100, 496/02113, 496/02128, 33105030002151, **UTTAM NAGAR** - 34204800001456, 34204950001355, **VISHNU GARDEN** - 35404540001398, 35404960001367, **BETUL** - 34904800002076, 480/02159, 34904960002070, **IMAMI GATE** - 32204960001768, 496/01825, 496/01864, 496/01869, 496/01889, **GUNA** - 36304800002789, **ITARSI** - 32104800003246, 480/03326, 480/03357, 480/03378, 480/03393, 32104960003262, **KAMLA NAGAR** - 34804800004522, 480/04607, 34804950004374, 34804960004542, 496/04546, 496/04588, 496/04602, 496/04641, 496/04646, 496/04681, **MANDIDEEP** - 35204800002250, 480/02269, 480/02349, 480/02398, **MARIMATA** - 32304960002609, 496/02661, 496/02662, 496/02713, 496/02792, **RAISEN** - 35904540003611, 35904800003586, 35904960003526, **MHOW** - 32404960001731, 496/01785, **BHANGEL** - 33204540001874, 454/01882, 454/02030, 33204800001973, 33204850002040, 33204940002014, 33204960002019, **HOSIARPUR** - 43604800000954, 43604960000955, **SHALIMAR GARDEN** - 32804960001160, 496/01163, 496/01166, **FARIDABAD** - 33804800002618, **JAWAHAR COLONY** - 38904800001481, 480/01492, 38904850001513, 38904960001431, 496/01504.

In case we are unable to complete the auction at the branch on the notified date, the same will be conducted through Shriram Automall India Limited (SAMIL) on their online e- auction platform https://gold.samil.in or e-Procurement Technologies Limited (AuctionTiger) on their online e- auction platform https://egold.auctiontiger.net on 30-11-2026 between 12.30 PM to 3.30 PM. Please note if the e- auction does not completed on 30-11-2026 the same will be re-auctioned on subsequent working days on the same terms and conditions.

By Authorized Officer,
Indel Money Limited

Drones to multi-role helicopters: Govt clears Rs 2.12-lakh cr defence procurement

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, October 26

IN A major defence acquisition push, the government on Monday cleared procurement of a range of military platforms and weapon systems, including light multi-role helicopters, long-range Kamikaze drones and radars, at a cost of Rs 2.12 lakh crore, to boost the combat prowess of the defence forces.

The procurement proposals were approved by the Defence Acquisition Council (DAC), the defence ministry's highest decision-making body on military procurement. It was chaired by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh.

The DAC accorded Acceptance of Necessity (AoN), or in-principle administrative approval, to various capital acquisition proposals of an estimated cost of about Rs 2,12,000 crore, the defence ministry said.

For the Indian Army, approval was accorded for the procurement of high mobility vehicles (HMVs), self-propelled tracked gun system, gunshot response system (GSRS), light multi-role helicopters (LMRH), very short-range air defence system (VSHORADS) and counter unmanned aerial system (C-UAS), it said.

The DAC also cleared the acquisition of other unmanned aerial system, surveillance aerial vehicles, integrated surveillance and strike system and long-range Kamikaze drone system for the Army.

While the HMVs are expected to enhance operational capabilities, logistical support and mobility in challenging terrains, the self-propelled tracked gun system will provide mobility and firepower to mechanised formations.

The GSRS will serve as a force multiplier, providing real-time situational awareness, the ministry said.

It said the LMRH will be used by both the Indian Army and the Indian Air Force for a range of purposes including reconnaissance and surveillance, combat, search and rescue of troops, humanitarian assistance and disaster relief.

The VSHORADS will engage new-generation small-size aerial threats, while C-UAS will enhance the survivability of tanks in the modern battlefield. The surveillance and drone systems will enhance the surveillance and targeting capabilities of the Indian Army, according to the ministry.

For the Indian Navy, approval was given for the procurement of active offboard decoy system (AODS) and other major naval platforms. The AODS will enhance the credibility of anti-missile defence, especially against modern anti-ship missiles of adversaries, the ministry said.

The indigenously designed and constructed major naval platforms will possess modern-day warfare capabilities and enhance the combat capability of the Navy, it said.

The DAC approved procurement of helicopters, air defence systems and weapons and mobile X-band Doppler weather radar system to enhance the air defence and warfighting capabilities of the force.

"The procurement of special utility helicopters will help the Indian Air Force to meet the important air transport requirements. The X-band Doppler weather radar system will provide high-resolution, localised weather surveillance in forward areas," the ministry said in a statement.

Out of the total AoNs accorded, approximately 82 per cent of the procurements will be made from the Indian industry, it noted.

'Aatmanirbharta 2.0': Rajnath calls for top-end, state-of-the-art defence tech

Minister says innovators will play the role of 'impact players'

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, October 26



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh inspects an indigenous thermal imaging system during the 'Swavlamban 2026' seminar, in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

DEFENCE MINISTER Rajnath Singh on Monday said India's bid to achieve 'aatmanirbharta' (self-reliance) in defence is entering the "second phase" as he called on all associated stakeholders to develop top-end and state-of-the-art technologies in the sector.

In his address at the plenary session of the Indian Navy's annual seminar 'Swavlamban 2026' in New Delhi, Singh underlined the need to indigenously manufacture products that are "cost-effective, operationally superior and globally competitive".

While calling for 'Aatmanirbharta 2.0' in the defence sector, Singh emphasised on strengthening research & development (R&D), building resilient supply chains to cut import dependence and achieving technological superiority, thus contributing to the vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047.

Highlighting the significant strides made by the country towards 'aatmanirbharta' in defence over the last decade, Singh asserted that the progress achieved so far has created a "strong foundation" for the next phase, which must focus on advanced technologies and objectives that are considered difficult to achieve.

He emphasised the need to build on the gains of the first phase of self-reliance, and said defence innovators with futuristic vision and scientific discipline would play the role of "impact players" in pursuing more challenging technological goals in the next phase.

The Navy is hosting the fifth edition of its flagship seminar at the Manekshaw Centre here on October 26 and 27.

Chief of Defence Staff Gen N S Raja Subramani, Army Chief Gen Dhiraj Seth and Navy Chief Admiral Krishna Swaminathan were also present.

Singh said supply chain management is not just a technical issue, but a strategic imperative directly linked to the national security. He called for a dynamic roadmap that sets clear timelines for achieving self-reliance in each item, identifies the technologies to be developed and the industries that will drive their innovation, and outlines the resources required to achieve these objectives.

The minister also highlighted that demand for naval ships is steadily increasing in view of the evolving situation in the Indian Ocean Region, and said, since their construction is capital-intensive, there is a need to explore ways to "reduce costs" while expanding domestic production. Singh also called for development of a 'Dual Technology Roadmap' to identify and prioritise technologies that can serve both civilian and military requirements.

Addressing the plenary session, Navy Chief Admiral Krishna Swaminathan pitched for accelerating the pace of translating innovation into operational capabilities for the naval force, and urged all stakeholders to endeavour to stay ahead of the technology curve.

Advances in artificial intelligence and autonomous systems should be leveraged to bolster naval capabilities, he said.

Vice Chief of Naval Staff (VCNS) Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar pitched for shortening the "innovation to integration" cycle to augment naval capabilities.

The vice admiral referred to recent conflicts, from short-term engagements to protracted ones, including the conflict in Ukraine, and emphasised how drone production there has grown manifold in the last several years.

Teen, his father paraded naked in Kolkata; 3 held

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, October 26

AN 18-YEAR-OLD, his father, and his friend were allegedly assaulted, forced to strip at gunpoint, and paraded naked in Kolkata after the teenager was caught kissing a 13-year-old girl, police said. Police arrested three members of the girl's family, including her parents.

Police officers said the 18-year-old and his friend met the girl on Sunday. The girl's uncle, the police officers said, saw the 18-year-old kissing her and alerted her father and uncle.

The girl's father and uncle then reached the spot and forcibly took the teenager and his friends to their home. They allegedly assaulted them and forced the 18-year-old to call his father there. "When his father arrived, they assaulted him and threatened to shoot all three dead if they did not strip. They then forced the three to walk naked for about 50 meters on the lane outside their home," a senior police officer said. A video of the shocking incident has circulated on social media.

After the 18-year-old's father filed a complaint, police registered a case under multiple sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. The charges include attempt to murder, voluntarily causing hurt or grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means, wrongful confinement, defamation, criminal intimidation and kidnapping.

Police have arrested the girl's father, mother and uncle. "Raids are underway to track down the remaining accomplices who participated in the assault," said a police officer.

The victims have undergone a medical examination. All three have said they were threatened with a firearm. Police officers said they are yet to find the firearm. Investigating officers are reviewing CCTV footage from the locality and examining key eyewitnesses as part of the probe.

Army Day Parade 2027 in Bhopal

New Delhi: The next Army Day Parade will be held in Bhopal during which the force will showcase its rich military heritage and operational prowess. It is observed on January 15 to honour the achievements of the first Commander-in-Chief of independent India, Gen (later Field Marshal) K M Cariappa. PTI

EXPRESS Careers

MORMUGAO PORT AUTHORITY
GENERAL ADMINISTRATION DEPARTMENT
Brief Advertisement notice No. GAD/PC-A/151/2026/07351 Date: 19/10/2026
APPOINTMENT ON DEPUTATION BASIS
Mormugao Port Authority, Headland, Sada invites applications for filling up the post of Deputy Chief Vigilance Officer on deputation basis from Central Government/State Government/PSUs/Autonomous Bodies. The last date for receipt of application is 04.12.2026.
For further details, visit MPA website https://www.mormugaoport.gov.in.
Sd/-
SECRETARY

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भारतीय प्रबंधन संस्थान मुंबई
Indian Institute of Management Mumbai
(Ministry of Education, Government of India)
Advertisement for Teaching & Non-Teaching Positions
IIM Mumbai invites applications for Teaching & Non-Teaching positions from eligible candidates.

Advt. Number & Date	Post
Admn/Rectt/Faculty/2026/02 Date: 13.10.2026	Associate Professor Assistant Professor (Grade-I) Assistant Professor (Grade-II)
Admn/Rectt/2026/41 dated 19.10.2026	Deputy General Manager (Career Development Services) Medical Officer Manager (Civil) Manager (Electrical)

For detailed advertisements and other vacancies, please visit https://iimmumbai.ac.in/careers
Chief Administrative Officer

MUMBAI PORT AUTHORITY
RECRUITMENT NOTICE – ENGAGEMENT OF FINANCIAL ANALYST ON CONTRACT BASIS
Applications are invited from eligible Indian Nationals for engagement as Financial Analyst purely on contract basis.
Last date of receiving applications is 10.11.2026.
For details regarding educational qualifications, age, experience, application fomat etc., please visit our website www.mumbaiport.gov.in (people & career/jobs/).
Financial Adviser & Chief Accounts Officer
Mumbai Port Authority

ADVERTORIAL

EMPOWERING DAUGHTERS
TRANSFORMING FUTURES IN UTTAR PRADESH



Under the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, Uttar Pradesh is taking a decisive step towards empowering its daughters with the knowledge to make informed financial choices and build independent futures. Through Mission Shakti, girls are gaining practical exposure to banking, money management and safe digital transactions. By promoting financial literacy and cyber awareness, the initiative is transforming knowledge into confidence, strengthening self-reliance and preparing young girls to navigate tomorrow's opportunities with greater security and independence.



Transforming Schools, Empowering Every Child

- Stronger Schools, Greater Participation: Vidyanjali, CSR partnerships and 'Adopt a School' to strengthen community-led school development.
- Towards Drug-Free Campuses: Nashamukt Vidyalaya campaign to promote safe, healthy and drug-free learning environments.
- Inclusive Education for All: Prashast 2.0 to strengthen learning support for children with special needs.
- Action-Driven Education Reforms: State-level workshop on October 22 in Lucknow to review progress, address challenges and accelerate implementation.



Farming Dreams, Doubling Opportunities: 2,820 Scholarships, ₹60,000 a Year

- Double the Opportunities: Scholarship seats doubled from 1,410 to 2,820 across Uttar Pradesh.
- Bigger Financial Support: Annual scholarship raised from ₹36,000 to ₹60,000 per student.
- Expanding Educational Reach: Coverage across 11 agricultural universities and institutions and 61 agricultural colleges.
- Empowering Rural Talent: Greater access to higher education in agriculture, horticulture, forestry and animal husbandry for meritorious children of farmers and agricultural labourers.

Skills to Success: 2,672 Girls Set for a Self-Reliant Future

- Education Meets Employability: 2,672 girls from 71 Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas to receive skill training under Project Praveen from November 2.
- Future-Ready Skills: Training in healthcare, IT, apparel, green jobs and AI to unlock emerging career opportunities.
- 300 Hours of Practical Learning: Industry-aligned courses, computer skills, communication and personality development to boost workplace readiness.
- Quality Training, Better Prospects: Time-bound implementation, fortnightly inspections and skill assessments to strengthen training quality and career preparedness.



1.29 Lakh+ Girls One Mission
Confidence, Dignity & Self-Reliance

- Massive Reach: 1.29 Lakh+ girls across UP schools and KGBVs participate in Self-Esteem training.
- Confidence & Self-Worth: Building self-respect, positive thinking and decision-making skills.
- Healthcare in Practice: Hospital visits introduce girls to registration, medical consultations and diagnostic tests.
- Empowered for Life: Promoting health awareness, informed choices and self-reliance among girls.

Mission Shakti Powers 1.18 Lakh+ Girls with Financial Literacy

- 1.18 Lakh+ Girls Reached: 1,18,657 girls from primary, upper-primary, composite schools and KGBVs joined the financial literacy drive.
- Banking Made Simple: Bank visits and hands-on sessions introduced students to account operations and everyday banking.
- Digital Safety First: Training covered online fraud prevention, secure digital transactions and cyber awareness.
- Money Skills for Independence: Practical financial knowledge is helping girls become more informed, confident and self-reliant.



UP's Green School Drive
1.88 Lakh Schools Assessed, 1.74 Lakh+ Earn 3-Star Ratings



- Massive Self-Assessment Drive: 1,88,301 schools complete self-assessment under Swachh Evam Harit Vidyalaya Rating 2026–27.
- 1.74 Lakh+ Schools Earn 3-Star Ratings: 1.74 lakh+ schools achieve three stars or above for cleanliness and green initiatives.
- Ground-Level Verification by October 31: District committees to physically verify school facilities and validate self-assessment reports.
- Transparency Through Monitoring: Each evaluator assigned 15-25 schools to ensure systematic verification and promote cleaner, greener learning environments.

WEB EXCLUSIVE
Lula's narrow victory shows the resilience of the Right in Brazil
—Shibashis Chatterjee
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

WORDLY WISE
Voting is a civic sacrament.
— Theodore Hesburgh

The Indian EXPRESS
~ FOUNDED BY ~
RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Climate justice needs quicker compensation

NEARLY TWO months after Nepal suffered devastating floods, the UN climate convention's Fund for Loss and Damage (FLD) has allocated $21.6 million to the Himalayan nation. This is the first time that the Fund has earmarked a grant for a disaster-affected nation. Kathmandu had invoked the principle of climate justice in its application: Nepal accounts for barely 0.1 per cent of global emissions, yet it is on the frontline of climate change in the Himalaya. The ice-and-rock avalanche that triggered flash floods in the Bhotekoshi and Trishuli river systems claimed more than 1,400 lives, several villages were swept away, and the country lost at least 10 per cent of its hydropower facilities. Conservative estimates put Nepal's recovery and reconstruction requirements at $5 billion. The grant, far short of what Nepal needs, marks an important first step in turning the commitment of climate reparation into action.

Established at the UNFCCC's COP27 in 2022 and operationalised a year later, the FLD is a product of a nearly three-decade-long campaign by nations most vulnerable to global warming. It rests on the principle of climate compensation, not charity. This distinction is not academic. The Global North is often willing to provide humanitarian assistance, but a fund explicitly meant to address "loss and damage" remains fraught because it raises questions related to responsibility for climate change. Nepal's application ran into predictable bureaucratic hurdles. The FLD's application window had closed in June, and when Nepal sought emergency funding, claims from 119 countries were awaiting approval. Developed countries initially argued that granting Kathmandu's request would mean allowing it to jump the queue. They eventually relented, but only after insisting that the allocation be treated as an exception and not set a precedent for a permanent rapid-response mechanism.

Nepal's experience with the FLD should serve as a case study for reforming the Fund. Delays in releasing grants can aggravate the hardships of affected communities, slow down the restoration of essential services and increase rebuilding costs. A swift response is particularly important for poorer countries, whose budgets have less room to absorb sudden losses. Fund shortages have also limited the FLD's ability to fulfil its mandate. It has received pledges worth $822 million — about a third of the claims pending before it. Compensation for countries hardest hit by global warming will be on the agenda at COP31, which begins on November 9 in Antalya, Turkey. As extreme weather events become more frequent and intense, delays in addressing the FLD's shortcomings will undermine the central principle of climate negotiations under the UN's aegis: Climate justice.

Lula's return is dramatic, his challenges formidable

BRAZIL'S PRESIDENTIAL election was watched closely around the world as it unfolded in a fraught setting. It came amid a populist right-wing surge across Latin America, the long shadow cast by US President Donald Trump and his "Donroe Doctrine", and larger questions about the Global South, in which Brazil's voice is key. Incumbent Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva of the Workers' Party was seen as more than a president seeking re-election; he is one of the most prominent figures of the global left. In a dramatic turnaround, Lula, who finished second in the first round to the far-right Flávio Bolsonaro — son of former president Jair Bolsonaro, who is under house arrest for allegedly plotting a coup after losing the 2022 election — won the runoff by a razor-thin margin. His victory with about 52 per cent of the vote, which has secured a historic fourth term, interrupts the right-wing tide in the region. But it is hardly a sign that the right is weakening within Brazil. Rather, the result shines the light on a society split down the middle and the resilience of a movement that may have outgrown its leader.

Going ahead, Lula faces formidable challenges. Although unemployment is near historic lows, the economy is slowing, compounded by affordability concerns, high interest rates and mounting household debt. Lula will likely struggle to push reforms through a conservative majority in Congress and more than a dozen right-wing state governors. He must govern a deeply divided electorate, nearly half of which voted against him. Bolsonarism's appeal reflects not only in ideological conservatism but also in anxieties about the role of the state and religion. Addressing them will require Lula to reach out beyond his traditional base.

Lula's win denies Trump an ally in the region's largest economy, of the kind he has in Javier Milei in Buenos Aires and once had in Jair Bolsonaro. Lula has deepened ties with China and resisted US tariffs. His re-election keeps Brasília on a Global South-oriented course, which is heartening for India. It is likely to sustain the momentum of groupings such as BRICS and IBSA (India, Brazil and South Africa), both seen by the two countries as vehicles for a more multipolar world order. Brazil's continued engagement in these forums matters at a time when developing countries are demanding a greater say in the governance of global institutions.

What ancients can teach — a useful magic

SCIENCE FICTION aficionados, among others, know of Arthur C Clarke's Third Law: "Any sufficiently advanced technology is indistinguishable from magic." Clarke's dictum, more often than not, applies to speculation about humanity's future — its influence is visible in the *Dune* series, *Star Wars*, and many other sci-fi classics. Sometimes, though, its obverse is deployed rather unthinkingly. Tales of magical weapons, flying carriages and dragons in myth and lore are seen as evidence of long-forgotten science and a glorious past. Then again, the past can contain science that's almost magical.

For centuries, till recently, the 1,600-year-old Lycurgus Cup was all but magical. The Roman artefact changes colour depending on the position of the light source: Under normal light, it is red; lit from behind, emerald green. It is only now that scientists from the University of Sheffield have reportedly managed to reverse-engineer the process that went into making the remarkable chalice that features Dionysus and King Lycurgus (from the *Iliad*) using a fragment of the vessel that sits in the British Museum.

There is, indeed, much to learn from the ancients. Apart from the optical engineering in the Lycurgus Cup, there's Roman Concrete, used to build the Pantheon and Colosseum, which hasn't quite been recreated to date. The town planning, sewage and drainage systems of the Indus Valley Civilisation should inspire many a modern metropolis to do better. The magic of the past, then, may not lie in myths of magical weapons and flying chariots, but in achievements that are more useful than "glorious".

To ease energy transition, ramp up storage, strengthen transmission



SOMIT DASGUPTA

THE FACE of the Indian power sector is changing. From perpetual deficit, we have moved to a situation of glut at least for certain hours of the day, specifically the solar hours. Both scenarios are painful, though as far as the consumers go, the first was far worse. The situation of glut and the way we are dealing with it is a national waste, but an individual consumer does not really feel the pinch. It is the sector that is suffering.

People will not have forgotten how difficult each summer was in the past with frequent power cuts. The problem also included the quality of supply. Voltage used to drop dramatically in the dusk hours, and it was inadvisable to run a television or a fridge without a voltage stabiliser. If this was the position in urban areas, one can imagine the situation in rural areas, where the number of hours for which supply was available was frequently in the single digits. One can, however, add a caveat. Only people connected to the grid faced the problem of erratic supply. A large part of the population lived in the dark because they were unelectrified. Thirty years ago, according to the World Bank, 40 per cent of India's population did not have access to electricity.

During the decade 1990-2000, the installed capacity was growing at the rate of about 5 per cent, whereas demand was growing at about 7 per cent to 8 per cent. Deficits in peak demand were of the order of 15 per cent, whereas energy shortage was about 10 per cent. Inadequate installed capacity was not the only problem. Perhaps a bigger problem was a poor and dilapidated distribution infrastructure that just did not have the capacity to cater to the growing load since there was virtually no upgrading. Upgradation required additional funds either through enhanced retail tariffs or through government grants, both of which were difficult to come by. The vertically integrated state electricity boards, with generation, state transmission, and distribution under one roof, were overstaffed, corrupt, and inefficient.

Then came the Electricity Act, 2003, which allowed for the dismantling of the State Electricity Boards (SEBs) and the setting up of separate companies for generation, transmission, and distribution. This segregation took years to happen in some states, as the issue became politicised. The Act also mandated the setting up of electricity regulatory commissions so that tariff determination could be an independent exercise, free from government clutches. However, this did not have the desired effect, as the government was loath to give up its control over tariffs and continued to breathe down the regulators' necks. The regulators, incidentally, gave the impression that they were willing to bend over backwards to stay on the government's right side. Consequently, the distribution sector remained where it was, financially unsustainable, waiting for a fresh injection of funds at regular intervals.

> The answer is to build storage so that excess generation in the daytime can charge our batteries, which may also ensure less frequent ramping up and down of our coal-based generation

The good news, however, was that growth in installed capacity got a boost after the setting up of the electricity exchanges in Delhi and Mumbai around 2008. The spot prices of power shot up manifold, and developers saw this as an opportunity and started investing heavily in new power projects, mainly coal-based. A little more than 1,00,000 MW of coal-based capacity was added between 2010 and 2020. Interestingly, about the same capacity was added between 1947 and 2010. It wasn't just the developers; banks started giving out loans blindly without ensuring that the developers had signed power purchase agreements (PPAs) and had fuel linkages. As a consequence, thousands of megawatts became stranded, the developers started defaulting on loans, and the non-performing assets (NPAs) of banks went up. Moreover around 2015, the solar sector received a push. Prior to this, India had primarily wind and biogas generation. Today, renewable capacity, including large hydro, is a little less than 292 GW, which is about 53 per cent of total capacity. Solar alone is about 162 GW. This massive growth in installed capacity reduced our peak and energy deficits to about 1 per cent to 2 per cent.

As they say, all good things must come to an end. With this massive growth in installed capacity, deficits may have gone down, but other problems have cropped up. This energy transition has made us surplus in solar hours, but we are facing deficits at night on account of unplanned outages in our coal plants, excessive air conditioning load, poor reservoir levels affecting hydro generation, etc. The surplus in solar hours is forcing us to back down our solar generation, even after ramping down our coal generation sometimes to the minimum technical load in order to balance the grid. Two things are happening here. First, we are wasting our solar power by backing down. Second, we are decreasing the longevity of our machines by this frequent ramping up and down.

So where lies the solution? The answer is to build storage so that excess generation in the daytime can charge our batteries, which may also ensure less frequent ramping up and down of our coal-based generation. Along with storage, we also need to strengthen our transmission system, improve demand-side management and create a market mechanism that properly rewards flexibility. However, building storage, especially pump storage, is time-consuming, and moreover, the price of storage, as determined through competitive bids, is said to be non-remunerative. This may mean that many of the storage projects will not see the light of day, which will only prolong our agony of losing valuable solar power.

The writer is visiting professor, ICRIER and former member (economic and commercial), CEA. Views are personal

Jogen Chowdhury's art of the personal, political and social



R SIVA KUMAR

JOGEN CHOWDHURY, who passed away in Kolkata at the age of 87 on Sunday morning after battling cancer for over a year, was one of a small group of important painters from Bengal who came onto the Indian art scene in the 1960s. He had carved out a distinct niche for himself. Born into a landed family in Faridpur, in pre-Partition East Bengal, he experienced a great reversal of fortune and became a post-Partition refugee in Calcutta. This early experience left a deep mark on him and profoundly shaped his art and personality.

Trained at the Government College of Art & Craft in Calcutta and later travelling to Paris on a scholarship to study at Ecole Nationale Superieure des Beaux-Arts, he saw the pre-modern academic and modern art practices up close. But he chose to tread a path of his own.

Back in India and working at the Weavers' Service Centre in Madras, he developed a personal idiom, drawing on his early memories of the embroidery (*kantha*) and ritual floor graphics (*alpona*) practised by women in the villages in Bengal. He imbibed their sinuous lines and textural intricacy without mimicking them and combined the decorative with the expressive.

With this, he created a language that far exceeded the simplicity of its means in subtlety and expressiveness. And he travelled a long distance with it. Initially, he used it to explore the subterranean intricacies of his own mind, throwing up suggestive images of desire and disquiet.

When he moved to Delhi as what was then known as the "Keeper of Art" at Rashtrapati Bhavan in 1972, he left the personal and the subliminal behind. He began to observe the political world closely and, while commenting on its players through his art, his paintings acquired a satirical edge.

A further shift happened when he joined the art college at Santiniketan, Kala Bhavan, in 1987. He moved from the political to the social, and his paintings became subtle tongue-in-cheek critiques of middle-class life, especially in Bengal.

With each shift, he added a new register to his language, making it flexible enough to work at the personal, political, and social levels. In his hands, simple everyday objects took an uncanny turn. A large flower with a fish floating on a dark screen evoked suppressed desire, a bolster suggested decadent corpulence, a slight grimace invoked corruption, a displaced drapery or a small gesture opened up a crack on the wall through which a story spilled out, and all this without changing the formal structure or economy of his language.

His early years in Calcutta as a refugee were extremely trying, but the suffering did not demoralise him; it made him aware of the need to look beyond the personal and engage with the collective. When he left Delhi for Santiniketan at the height of his personal success, he had this in mind. As a professor of painting at Santiniketan, he threw himself into mentoring young artists, enthusiastically re-energising the institution. But this was not enough for him.

Seeking to bring art into society, he led a group of younger colleagues in founding the Santiniketan Society of Visual Art and Design. This artist-run centre provides working space for young artists and a place for the community to meet. In all this, he was inspired by Rabindranath Tagore and his vision for academic institutions in India.

In 1999, he took voluntary retirement from Santiniketan and expanded his activities in Kolkata as part of his effort to revitalise the art scene in Bengal. He undertook a study of the provisions for art education in schools and drew up an elaborate plan to strengthen it. He even waded into politics and joined the Trinamool Congress in the hope that it would help. It brought him a term in the Rajya Sabha, but little else.

During the same period, he set up Charubasona, another centre for art activities in the city. He started the art magazine *ArtEast*, and served as chairman of the state art academy. Setting up a museum of modern art in Kolkata was another dream to which he devoted considerable time and energy, but it remains unrealised.

Chowdhury was a remarkable artist and a dreamer of institutions. He had the resources to realise the first; the second needed wider support, which was not always forthcoming. But he was a die-hard optimist and never gave up dreaming and hoping.

The writer is an art historian, critic and curator

> When he moved to Delhi as the Keeper of Art at Rashtrapati Bhavan in 1972, he left the personal and the subliminal behind. He began to observe the political world closely and, while commenting on its players through his art, his paintings acquired a satirical edge

On institutions, a stark hypocrisy from Congress



MOHAN CHARAN MAJHI

THE CONGRESS party has discovered institutions. After seven decades in which it treated the judiciary, investigating agencies, the Election Commission and even the press as extensions of the ruling family's will, it now holds marches to defend their independence. It is the arsonist protesting at the fire station. The record is long. A few chapters are enough.

On April 25, 1973, a day after the Supreme Court delivered the *Kesavananda Bharati* judgment, the Indira Gandhi government announced that Justice A N Ray would be Chief Justice of India. To appoint him, it passed over three judges, all of whom had ruled against the government. All three resigned. Law Minister Mohan Kumaramangalam had formulated the notion of a "committed judiciary", in which the government should weigh a judge's philosophy and outlook, not only his integrity. In 1977, at the height of the Emergency, it happened again. Justice H R Khanna, the lone dissenter in the *ADM Jabalpur* case, was passed over for the chief justiceship. He resigned. The judges who sided with the government in that case rose in their turn.

From 1975 to 1977, Congress suspended liberty, censored the press, and detained political opponents without trial, and the highest court endorsed it. Every later claim by Congress to be the guardian of constitutional values has to be read against those 21 months. The abuse of Article 356 began early. The elected government of Kerala was dismissed in 1959, and in 1980 Indira Gandhi dismissed nine opposition-led state governments after returning to power. The Governor's office became a tool to remove governments the voters had chosen and the party disliked.

After the 1984 anti-Sikh riots, the Rajiv Gandhi government took months to appoint a commission, and then chose a sitting SC judge, Ranganath Misra. His commission conceded that Congress workers had taken part in the violence, but nothing more. Misra later joined Congress and entered the Rajya Sabha.

The pattern held with the Election Commission. In October 1989, a month before polling, Rajiv Gandhi's government created two additional Election Commissioner posts, seen as an effort to curb the then CEC, R V S Peri Sastri, with whom it had fallen out. When Congress lost, both posts were abolished within weeks. In 1993, the Narasimha Rao government repeated the exercise when T N Seshan became inconvenient. Then came Navin Chawla. In 2006, L K Advani and more than 200 MPs sought his removal for alleged partisanship. In January 2009, CEC N Gopalaswami formally recommended his removal. The UPA rejected it and appointed Chawla CEC in April, just before the general election.

In September 2013, Rahul Gandhi publicly called the Manmohan Singh government's ordinance protecting convicted legislators " complete nonsense" and said it should be torn up. The extrao intervention undermined the PM's authority, raising questions about Congress's respect for constitutional offices.

Judges superseded for their rulings. A press censored. Elected governments dismissed. An Election Commissioner shielded and promoted over the CEC's objection. This is not a list of isolated lapses. It is a way of governing, practised for decades by a party that regarded institutions as its own. Those alleging a captured Election Commission, caged agencies and a threatened Constitution must first answer: What did they do when they held power?

The writer is Chief Minister of Odisha

> Judges superseded for their rulings. A press censored. Elected governments dismissed. An Election Commissioner shielded and promoted over the CEC's objection. This is not a list of isolated lapses. It is a way of governing, practised for decades

40 YEARS AGO

October 27, 1986


INDIAN EXPRESS
16 Pak intruders shot dead by BSF
Call for Punjab bandh today
Nine injured in Delhi violence

Pakistani intruders shot dead

SIXTEEN SUSPECTED Pakistani nationals were shot dead by Border Security Force personnel while attempting to intrude into Indian territory even as major political parties in Punjab gave a call for a bandh in the state and Chandigarh to protest against the gunning down of seven persons in Khuban village. Thirteen intruders were killed in the Khemkaran area in Punjab, while two were shot dead in Anoopgarh and one in the Sriganganagar area of Rajasthan in the last 24 hours. In a fresh spurt of incidents, terrorists shot dead an employee of a liquor shop near Moga and two ex-servicemen, in separate incidents, were deprived of their arms in Amritsar district.

PM on security situation

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, has issued instructions that the people in Punjab must be protected. The Prime Minister has called a meeting of the law-enforcing agencies to review the situation.

Sri Lanka conflict proposal

THE SRI Lankan Tamil militant groups will on November 3 give their views on the latest proposals of the island government to solve the ethnic issue to the Tamil Nadu Chief Minister, M G Ramachandran. Leaders of the militant groups discussed the proposals with the Chief Minister at the state secretariat for about 90 minutes. The advisor to the Centre on Constitutional matters, S Balakrishnan, was present at the meeting, along with the Tamil Nadu Food Minister, S Ramachandran, and the Law and Education Minister, C Ponnaiyan.

South Africa mining tragedy

AT LEAST five miners were killed when a lift went out of control and plunged down a shaft at a South African gold mine, the owners said. Ken Maxwell, chairman of Randfontein Estates Gold Mining Company, said two miners were crushed at the bottom of an 800 metre ventilation shaft at the mine, 40 km west of Johannesburg. Another three were killed by falling tackle, he told Reuters.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

A Netanyahu victory would set Israel and the region on a destructive path.
— Financial Times

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Ankita Bhandari deserved justice. She does not deserve to become a permanent hashtag



ABHINAV KUMAR

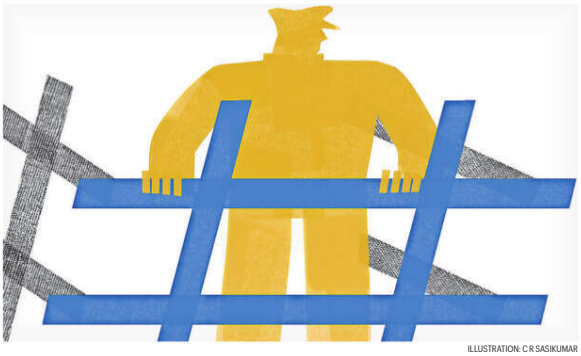


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

ON THE night of September 18, 2022, Ankita Bhandari, a 19-year-old from a modest family in Pauri Garhwal, was pushed into the Chilla canal near Rishikesh by the men who employed her. She had been a receptionist at the Vanantara Resort in Yamkeshwar for under a month. Four years on, her murder remains among the most emotive public questions in Uttarakhand. For a police officer, it is also an instructive case study in investigating crime in an age when evidence is weighed in court, but the verdict is delivered on social media.

As established in court, Bhandari had told a friend that the resort owner, Pulkit Arya, pressured her to provide "extra services" to guests. On September 18, she went out with Arya and two employees, Saurabh Bhaskar and Ankit Gupta. After an altercation on the canal bank, the three pushed her into the water. Arya then lodged a false missing person report.

The initial handling of the case by the revenue police, which still had jurisdiction over the area, was slow. That criticism is fair. But once the regular police took over, the accused were arrested within 24 hours; they have been in jail ever since. The post-mortem indicated Bhandari was alive when she entered the water. The government constituted a Special Investigation Team under a woman DIG, and Arya's father, a former minister, was expelled from the ruling party. Political connections notwithstanding, the case received the highest priority.

The SIT filed a chargesheet of about 500 pages, and the trial began in Kotdwar in January 2023. On May 30, 2025, Additional Sessions Judge Reena Negi convicted all three and sentenced them to rigorous life imprisonment. Bhandari's parents, understandably, are appealing for the death penalty. In a system where the conviction rate for murder is under half and trials routinely stretch beyond a decade, this was a swift and thorough outcome.

Yet, the dominant public perception is not of a conviction swiftly secured, but of an alleged cover-up. Three strands recur.

The first is the "VIP". Bhandari's messages referred to pressure to entertain an important guest. In December 2022, the Uttarakhand High Court, declining to transfer the probe to the CBI, found nothing to show the investigation was being steered to protect any high-profile person, and the Supreme Court declined to interfere. No witness, document or digital trail before the trial court identified any guest as a party to the crime. The conviction never depended on the VIP's identity; guilt was established through the conduct of the accused themselves.

The second is the bulldozer. Within days of the murder, part of the resort was demolished to assuage public anger. That hasty act handed critics a permanent charge of evidence destruction, though the evidence that convicted the accused, the last-seen testimony, the false missing report, the call records and the medical findings, never resided in those walls.

> The police cannot place case diaries, witness statements or forensic reports in the public domain during an investigation. That silence is read as complicity, and into the vacuum flow rumour and leaks

The third is the audio clips. In late December 2025, an actress released recordings purportedly of her conversations with a former MLA, naming senior party functionaries as the VIP. The clips went viral; protests filled Dehradun, young women wrote letters in blood, and the Opposition demanded a CBI probe. Within days, another recording surfaced in which she was purportedly heard saying she had been pressured to name a particular leader. Both the former MLA and the leader denied the claims, and the former MLA was arrested in June 2026 over the circulation of the clips. Meanwhile, in January 2026, the state recommended a CBI probe, and the agency registered a case against an unidentified VIP.

Let me be unambiguous. The CBI must follow every lead, and if it finds credible evidence against anyone, including those of us who conducted and supervised the SIT, the law must take its course. But a case that had withstood the scrutiny of a trial court, the High Court and the Supreme Court has been reopened not on new forensic evidence, but on recordings whose authenticity is disputed by the very people heard in them. The popular narrative of an unpunished conspiracy is at variance with every finding a court has made thus far.

This is the central predicament of policing today. A criminal investigation runs on evidence that must survive cross-examination; social media runs on plausibility, outrage and repetition. The police cannot place case diaries, witness statements or forensic reports in the public domain during an investigation. That silence, which protects the trial, is read as complicity, and into the vacuum flow rumour and motivated leaks. Even a verdict becomes one opinion among many, no more authoritative than a 30-second clip. Parties of every hue weaponise such cases, and a victim's family's genuine grief, and their absolute right to question, become the terrain on which others fight.

What must the police learn? First, the golden hour matters more than ever. The early delay here was partly a product of the anachronistic revenue police system in the hills. Uttarakhand's move to extend regular policing must be completed without hesitation. Every day lost at the outset becomes a year of suspicion later. Second, strategic communication is now a core policing function. Within legal limits, the police must explain regularly what they are doing and why. A credible, consistent official voice is the best antidote to manufactured doubt. Third, the administration must resist theatrical gestures. A bulldozer may satisfy a crowd for an evening; it can haunt an investigation for years. Fourth, institutions must not be cowed by noise. Transferring cases to central agencies whenever a hashtag trends erodes the morale of state police and signals that no verdict is ever final.

Ankita Bhandari deserved justice, and after patient work by investigators and prosecutors, she received a substantial measure of it. Her killers are in prison for life. What she does not deserve is to become a permanent hashtag, invoked whenever political expediency demands. The truth of her death was established not on social media, but in a courtroom in Kotdwar. In a post-truth age, defending that distinction is perhaps a police officer's most important duty.

The writer is a serving IPS officer. Views are personal

When courts are too slow, police replace judges



ABHINAV CHANDRACHUD

IT TAKES an enormous amount of time for a civil dispute to be decided in India. Take the example of the Bombay High Court where a suit filed in 1947 was finally settled out of court this year, after 79 years in litigation. While this may be an extraordinary time frame, many legal practitioners in Mumbai estimate that a suit filed at the Bombay High Court usually takes more than 20 years to decide.

There are many reasons for our slow-paced judicial system, but too much work for too few judges seems to be a big factor. According to the 2011 Census, the population of Maharashtra was 112 million, larger than that of any European country except Russia. The state of Maharashtra has 15 judges per million people, while the Bombay High Court has only 1.9 judges per million people. By contrast, there are about 157 judges per million people in New York state. According to the National Judicial Data Grid, there are currently 648,725 cases pending at the Bombay High Court, of which 9,454 are civil suits. It is nearly impossible for the handful of judges who are assigned the roster of deciding original civil suits to tackle this backlog, not counting new case filings.

Frustrated by the failures of state institutions to deliver justice, litigants in countries like Japan and Venezuela turn to extra-judicial remedies. In Mario Puzo's *The Godfather* (1969), the fictional undertaker, Amerigo Bonasera, looks to the mafia don, Vito Corleone, when the courts fail to deliver justice. However, in India, affluent and well-connected litigants to whom money is owed often go to the police and attempt to criminalise their disputes by alleging that their opponent has committed a criminal offence like "cheating" or "breach of trust".

A person who merely breaches a contract to pay money commits none of these offences. So why do the police act on these complaints that often have no obvious criminal angles to them? A litigant offers the police officer a cut if he can get his opponent to settle the case. In fact, it is rumoured that a branch of the police asks for bribes on a "commission basis" to take up such cases. Of course, not all police officers succumb to such temptations.

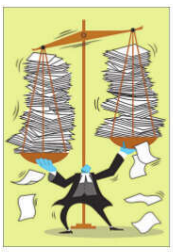


ILLUSTRATION: VIKAS AGARWAL

Once the police get involved in a civil case, the process is devastatingly fast. Unlike civil suits, where defendants rarely have to go to court in person, the police send a cryptic summons to the "accused" debtor ordering him to come to the police station at short notice. Receiving this summons can itself be quite intimidating. What follows is worse. The police then conduct a "preliminary inquiry", where an incredible amount of pressure is put on the "accused" debtor to settle the case. At the police station, he is made to wait for hours, where he sees other offenders being verbally or physically abused by the police in more serious cases. He is interrogated menacingly; the police threaten to arrest him, his spouse or family unless he settles the case. After several draining hours, the accused person is sent home and then told to come back again the next day for another harrowing experience.

In the commercial world, time is money. Most people crack in this environment and cases are settled without a First Information Report (FIR) being registered. According to some accounts, 50 per cent of such cases that come to a police station end at the preliminary inquiry stage. Apart from the unpleasant ordeal, the fear of arrest is a potent weapon that gets defendants to settle such cases. Prison conditions in India are deplorable. The risk of reputational loss upon registration of a criminal case is also a factor.

Scholars of "law and society" recognise that there is often a wide gap between the "law on the books" and the "law in action". Criminalising civil cases is considered an "abuse of process" that the Supreme Court has repeatedly deprecated and discouraged. The law in action is something else.

It would be unfair to blame our understaffed and overworked courts for a system that requires structural and cultural reform. India's civil justice system is built on a bedrock of archaic procedure. A defendant in India is given every conceivable opportunity to thwart a plaintiff's attempts at getting a decree. In 1872, the Privy Council remarked that "the difficulties of a litigant in India begin when he has obtained a Decree". This continues to be true today.

All this is pushing frustrated litigants who have access to networks into the arms of police officers (at times, of questionable integrity) who deliver swift, summary "justice" in civil cases — a parallel civil justice delivery mechanism.

The writer is an advocate at the Bombay High Court

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

No endgame in Iran

A WAR without a clearly defined political objective can become self-perpetuating ('In Iran war, no clarity on what a win might look like', *IE*, October 26). Leaders may describe success through battlefield damage, yet such measures mean little if they leave the region unstable and civilians exposed to danger. Iran's security concerns cannot justify attacks on others, but external pressure alone is unlikely to produce durable change. Diplomacy should accompany deterrence, with clear conditions, verification and channels to prevent escalation. Victory must mean reduced threats, civilian protection and a workable regional settlement.

S M Jeeva, Chennai

Lula's win

LUIZ INÁCIO Lula da Silva's re-election ensures continuity in Brazil's Global South-oriented policy and strengthens India-Brazil ties in trade, energy, technology and critical minerals ('Lula's narrow victory shows the resilience of the Right in Brazil', IE Web, October 26). It also reinforces BRICS and IBSA (India, Brazil, and South Africa) cooperation. Had he lost, Brazil might have leaned closer to Washington, weakening convergence with India's strategic autonomy and multipolar vision.

R S Narula, Patiala

Common programme

A SOUTHERN alliance may strengthen regional cooperation, but electoral arithmetic cannot substitute for a common programme ('A southern alliance and an elephant in the room', *IE*, October 26). Parties differing on policy, leadership and local interests must explain how they would resolve disagreements after an election. The elephant in the room is whether cooperation will endure when seats, ministries and priorities are negotiated. Voters deserve clarity on jobs, public services, federal rights and fiscal responsibility. A durable alliance requires transparent commitments and mutual respect.

A Myilsami, Coimbatore

To steady the ship, start with open dialogue



RADHA GOENKA

ALL EYES are on Delhi and the protests over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The last intensive revision of the rolls was conducted between 2002 and 2004, when the BJP was in power under Atal Bihari Vajpayee. It passed largely without controversy. In the 2004 general election, the UPA came to power and Manmohan Singh became prime minister — a reminder that the exercise itself need not tilt the field towards the incumbent. What has changed today is trust. Exams that leak, jobs that don't come and a vote that may not count, all tell young Indians the same thing: The system is not working for them.

Here is what the leadership could do if it wishes to steady the ship.

Start with honest, open dialogue. In my years of working alongside the government, I have seen that those who serve in it are some of the smartest minds in the country, putting in long hours solving problems most of us never see. The public needs a glimpse of this. With openness may come criticism, but making yourself vulnerable also makes you more likeable. Those who show their flaws are often loved far more than seemingly perfect leaders.

Second, strengthen and protect a free and unbiased media. When the Constitution was framed, the press did not have the reach it does today. If it had, the framers of our Constitution might have built more safeguards. The government should build those guardrails now. One way is to secure independent funding for news outlets. Just as companies above a certain size must spend 2 per cent of their average net profits on CSR, another 2 per cent could be directed to an independently governed fund for news media.

Third, move away from populist agendas and invest in the long-term development of the country — such as formulating a strong, holistic environment policy. The shocks that climate events like El Niño bring can only be mitigated by long-term planning of this kind. Similarly, I would invest deeply in the quality of education. India's future rests on its youth, and educating them is the best long-term investment the nation can make.

Fourth, transform the administrative machinery. This is where the protestors' anger is most justified. The selection process for administrators needs to be more robust and less dependent on a single exam. Also needed is a performance-based system of incentives and promotion to ensure efficiency.

Finally, build a global strategy on soft power and economic capability. Returns on investment in soft power come long after the next election. France has spent generations turning its culture, food, fashion, art and sense of refinement into a national brand. In 2024, its travel and tourism sector contributed 266 billion euros, or 9.1 per cent of GDP. India has thousands of years of civilisational history. Yoga, ayurveda, spirituality, cuisine, Bollywood, music, art and the legacy of Gandhi and non-violence are already recognised around the world. We don't have a shortage of culture — only of strategy.

> Build the cultural power that makes the world want India, and the economic capability that makes the world need India

But global power also comes from becoming indispensable. Taiwan spent decades building a semiconductor ecosystem; today, TSMC makes nearly three-quarters of the world's contract-manufactured chips. China played an even longer game: Its share of global manufacturing rose from under 9 per cent in 2004 to 28 per cent in 2023, more than the US, Japan and Germany combined. India needs to think this way, too. We should identify a handful of industries where India already has an advantage and build the entire ecosystem around them.

That, to me, is what a global strategy should look like. Build the cultural power that makes the world want India, and the economic capability that makes the world need India. Decide what "Brand India" should stand for, what India should become indispensable at, and have the discipline to build both over decades.

The advantage of being the mother of two teenagers is that I am regularly forced to rethink everything I do, often trying measures outside my comfort zone until something lands. At this critical juncture, a well-thought-out long-term plan for the country, communicated honestly and openly by those in power, could help change the direction of the current unrest, even if it is a long shot.

The writer is director, RPG Foundation

In Israel, what election can change, what it can't



RAJAN KUMAR

ISRAEL'S PARLIAMENTARY election on October 27 will decide the fate of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu. It is significant because this is the first election since Hamas's attack on Israel on October 7, 2023. The central question is whether a change in leadership will occur, and if so, whether it will usher in a new political trajectory. Many fear that a Netanyahu victory will embolden him to escalate the war against Iran and continue his coercive policies towards Gaza.

Given the fractious nature of Israel's politics and shifting coalitions, it is difficult to predict the outcome. Opinion polls suggest that neither the present coalition nor the opposition parties will attain a majority. Netanyahu is locked in a close contest with Gadi Eisenkot, the leader of the newly formed Yashar party. Eisenkot draws his popularity from his military service, family sacrifices, and anti-Netanyahu sentiment. He lost his son, Gal Eisenkot, during a military operation in Gaza in 2023. Seen as a hawk, he served in Netanyahu's emergency war cabinet in 2024 and later resigned over disagreements with respect to Gaza. If he wins, expecting a moderation of Israel's policy would be premature. Much will depend on the coalition that emerges, in which the support of right-wing parties will be fundamental.

The election is widely regarded as a referendum on Netanyahu's uncompromising governance approach. He is being blamed for pushing Israel into a perpetual war with Iran and its proxies and for exposing the country to widespread international opprobrium and diplomatic isolation over its conduct in Gaza. He could neither topple the theocratic regime in Tehran nor destroy its nuclear enrichment programme.

Further, his military operations in Gaza have created the worst humanitarian crisis in recent years, leading to about 74,000 deaths. The disproportionate Israeli military response in Gaza shifted the narrative from attributing responsibility to Hamas to holding Netanyahu responsible for its escalation.

> The far-right nature of Israeli politics prevents any policy moderation. All the major parties object to the two-state solution and the creation of Palestine as an independent state

Netanyahu's biggest success was convincing the Trump administration to launch a joint attack on Iran. US President Donald Trump has endorsed him in the current election, praising him as an ally, "great warrior prime minister", and peace partner. Trump's support for Netanyahu, however, has come at a high political cost. His popularity in the US is at an all-time low. The price of diesel has skyrocketed, and the Republican Party is facing trouble in the midterm elections.

Netanyahu enjoys the support of other far-right parties, but this coalition might shift based on the electoral outcomes. Security is the central issue, and Eisenkot has centred his campaign on Netanyahu's failure to prevent Hamas's attacks and his policies on Gaza. The exemption of ultra-Orthodox Jewish men from conscription and Netanyahu's attempts to control the judiciary remain divisive issues in Israel.

Even if there is a change in leadership, there will be no major shift in Israel's policy towards Palestine or Iran. The far-right nature of Israeli politics prevents any policy moderation. All the major parties object to the two-state solution and the creation of Palestine as an independent state. On Iran, however, Eisenkot appears cautious and calibrated. He is firmly opposed to Iran acquiring nuclear weapons, but is sceptical of achieving political objectives through military means. But if Netanyahu forms the government, the US and Israel are likely to initiate the next phase of coercive measures.

The writer is professor, School of International Studies, Jawaharlal Nehru University

HOURS AFTER HC REJECTS ANTICIPATORY BAIL PLEA

Ex-DMK minister held in 'scam' linked to private schools

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, October 26

FORMER TAMIL Nadu School Education Minister and senior DMK leader Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi was arrested in Chennai on Monday, hours after the Madras High Court rejected his anticipatory bail petition in an alleged multi-crore fraud involving money collected from private schools in exchange for government approvals.

Justice V Lakshminarayanan dismissed the petition after the Chennai Central Crime Branch (CCB) argued that investigators had gathered sufficient material suggesting the former minister's active involvement and that custodial interrogation was necessary.

In a 20-page order, Justice Lakshminarayanan observed that granting anticipatory bail at this stage would "paralyse the investigation", particularly when investigators were still tracing the money and searching for an absconding accused. The court said the need to protect individual liberty had to be weighed against society's interest in a corruption-free administration.

Poyyamozhi, a childhood friend of former Deputy CM Udhayanidhi Stalin, and a prominent figure in the DMK's younger leadership, has been named as the fifth accused.

The case originates from a complaint filed by C Elangovan, secretary of the Tamil Nadu Private Schools Federation. According to the CCB, an unregistered association headed by B T Arasakumar allegedly collected money from private schools by promising permanent recognition, upgrades and building approvals during Poyyamozhi's tenure between 2021 and 2026.

The FIR was initially registered under BNS provisions related to criminal breach of trust, cheating and common intention. Following the emergence of evidence allegedly linking Poyyamozhi to the collections, investigators filed an alteration report on September 9, adding Sections 7 and 12 of the Prevention of Corruption Act, concerning bribery involving public servants and abetment. Investigators told the court that over 177 school managements had come forward and that transactions totalling Rs 17.26 crore had allegedly been traced so far. State Public Prosecutor John Sathyan told the HC the investigation had indicated collections amounting to Rs 400 crore. The prosecution said investigators were still attempting to establish the money trail, making custodial interrogation necessary to identify those involved.

The police alleged that Poyyamozhi helped establish the association in 2024 through his personal assistant, Valadi Karthick, and publicly introduced its organisers at a Chennai event in December that year.

The prosecution told the court that during meetings of the private schools association, Poyyamozhi had indicated that grievances of school managements routed through Arasakumar and Muthukumar would be addressed by the government. The judge observed that while a minister's participation in a public function could not itself be treated with suspicion, the allegations went beyond mere attendance and concerned specific assurances about routing demands through the accused.

Investigators also said that money collected from schools was allegedly handed over to Poyyamozhi under the description of "party fund".

The court referred to witness statements recorded before a magistrate under Section 183(5) of the BNSS, which indicated that collections had been described as "party fund". It also cited records showing that a witness met Poyyamozhi on January 13, 2026, and questioned why a promised government order had not been issued despite payment of money. The prosecution also alleged Poyyamozhi had reassured relatives of an absconding accused, Muthukumar, about his safety, strengthening its argument for custodial questioning. Police said efforts were continuing to trace Muthukumar, described as a close associate of the former minister.

The HC recorded that statements from Muthukumar's relatives indicated Poyyamozhi had kept the absconding accused in his custody. Justice Lakshminarayanan observed that this amounted, prima facie, to shielding a co-accused and obstructing the probe.



Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi

EXPLAINED

Raising the stakes

The former minister's arrest is the latest in a series of police and anti-corruption actions against senior DMK figures since Vijay's TVK took charge. It also raises the stakes in the TVK government's ongoing confrontation with the main Opposition party.

Bulgarian pilot killed in Himachal paraglider crash, Briton rescued

Saurabh Parashar
Shimla, October 26

A 47-YEAR-OLD Bulgarian paraglider, on a solo expedition, was killed while a 63-year-old British pilot suffered injuries and was rescued after their paragliders crashed near Rising Star Peak in Dharamshala, police on Monday said. As an immediate measure, the Kangra district administration imposed a three day ban on solo and cross-country paragliding expedition.

The incident took place Sunday afternoon when the two foreign nationals, who had taken off separately from Bir-Billing paragliding site, encountered strong winds, officials said.

Police identified the deceased pilot as Maksim Valentinovich Gavrilichenko, a Bulgarian national who came to India on tourist visa on October 7. The rescued paraglider was identified as Stephen Antony Purdie.

Superintendent of Police, Kangra, Kulbhushan Verma said both pilots took off for solo paragliding flight from Bir Billing. "Due to air pressure and (strong) wind conditions, the Bulgarian pilot's paraglider went out of control, leading to the accident. His companion, the British national had to force land," the SP said, adding Purdie informed officials at the paragliding site and sent the location coordinates.

He said a rescue operation was launched in the evening with teams comprising personnel from the local police, the State Disaster Response Force (SDRF), and the Him Sanchar Rescue Team. The rescuers worked through the night in difficult terrain and adverse weather before reaching the accident site in the morning.

While Purdie was safely evacuated, the Bulgarian national's body was shifted to the mortuary at Zonal Hospital, Dharamshala, the officer said, adding that the exact cause of death will be ascertained following a post-mortem examination.

Meanwhile, the district administration on Monday announced a three-day ban on solo paragliding and cross-country paragliding expeditions. "The tandem flights have been allowed to continue," Baijnath Sub-Divisional Magistrate Sanklap Gautam said.

Gautam told reporters that six to seven crash and force landing incidents have been reported over the last few days.

The temporary ban, however, triggered protests with a delegation of foreign paragliders and locals calling on Rajya Sabha MP Anurag Sharma demanding that the restrictions be withdrawn. The delegation warned that foreign pilots, who arrive at Bir-Billing and stay for extended periods, might shift to Manali or other destinations if the ban continued, dealing a blow to the local economy.

They also expressed concern that the suspension of flights from authorised paragliding sites could prompt some pilots to attempt take-offs from unauthorised locations.

Sharma spoke to officials concerned and asked them to formulate a standard operating procedure (SOP) to address safety concerns and facilitate the resumption of paragliding activities. He assured the delegation that efforts would be made to allow pilots to resume solo expeditions soon.



The Kangra district administration imposed a three-day ban on solo and cross-country paragliding expedition. EXPRESS FILE

Ankita Bhandari case: Actress held before she was to appear in CBI court

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, October 26

A DAY before she was to be produced in CBI court in connection with 2022 Ankita Bhandari murder case, Uttarakhand Police arrested actress Urmila Sanawar from Uttar Pradesh's Sahranpur in connection with a separate FIR regarding alleged defamatory remarks made on a former BJP MLA.

She was arrested from her house in Saharanpur on Sunday. On October 23, she had consented to proposed narco-analysis and polygraph tests, and was expected to appear before court in this connection on Monday.

According to police, a case was registered against Sanawar in Haridwar on Saturday on the complaint of ex-MLA Suresh Rathore's daughter. The complaint alleged objectionable and defamatory remarks targeting Rathore and his family had been circulated on social media. Another FIR was registered in Dehradun on Monday in which the complainant alleged Sanawar made defamatory remarks against Sikkim Governor Dushyant Gautam, among others.

Ahead of cyclone, Andhra evacuates pregnant women

Sreenivas Janyala & Sujit Bisoyi
Hyderabad, Bhubaneswar, October 26

ANDHRA PRADESH has begun evacuations from vulnerable areas, while Odisha has deputed ministers to oversee preparedness as the two states brace for Cyclone Arnab, which the India Meteorological Department (IMD) says is likely to make landfall on the Andhra Pradesh coast on October 28.

In Andhra Pradesh, Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu reviewed preparedness and ordered evacuations from low-lying areas in Srikakulam, Vizianagaram, Visakhapatnam, Konaseema, East Godavari, West Godavari, Eluru, Krishna, NTR, Guntur, Palnadu, Bapatla, Prakasam and Nellore districts. Officials said 4,711 pregnant women living in vulnerable areas had been moved to primary health centres (PHCs), community health centres (CHCs) and hospitals.

All educational institutions in these districts will remain closed from October 27 to 31. Seven National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) teams and eight State Disaster Response Force (SDRF) teams have been deployed, with additional forces kept in reserve in NTR and Visakhapatnam districts.

"Students residing in hostels are instructed to consult with their warden or chief warden and strictly adhere to the guidelines issued by the IMD," a circular issued on Monday said.

In Odisha, the state government has banned fishing in the sea and tourist entry to hills, waterfalls and dams in six districts. Officials said resources had been mobilised in Ganjam, Gajapati, Rayagada, Malkangiri, Koraput and Nabarangpur, identified as the most vulnerable districts in the southern region. Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi deputed eight ministers to different locations to monitor preparedness, while fishing activities have been restricted.

IMD's Monday bulletin said the deep depression over the Bay of Bengal had moved nearly westwards at 15 kmph over the previous six hours and intensified into a cyclonic storm.

"It is very likely to move west-northwestwards and intensify further into a severe cyclonic storm over west-central Bay of Bengal by midnight of October 26 and into a very severe cyclonic storm over the same region on October 27," it said.



NDRF personnel leave for vulnerable areas in Odisha. EXPRESS

Keralam judge whose minor son was named in fatal hit-and-run likely to face action too

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, October 26

AMID GROWING outrage over the Kochi hit-and-run case, Kerala Home Minister has expressed surprise over the decision of the Juvenile Justice (JJ) Board to grant bail to the 17-year-old accused, the son of an additional district judge in the state, and said police would move an appeal in court to get the bail cancelled.

Ramesh Chennithala promised action against the judge for allowing his minor son to drive the luxury car. The accused's father presides over a Motor Accident Claims Tribunal in the state. The Kochi city police commissioner confirmed that the department will appeal the JJ Board's decision.

Jayabalakrishan, a 55-year-old eatery owner at Chitoor near Kochi, was killed after the teenager, allegedly driving a Mercedes-Benz at high speed, struck his scooter from behind.

The three children of the deceased, Jayabalakrishan, staged two rounds of protest outside a police station in the district, demanding cancellation of the accused's bail as well as suspension of his father from his post.

Protesting outside the Cheranallor police station under Kochi city police limits with her two siblings, Jayabalakrishan's daughter Bhadra Keerthi said, "We will not return home without getting the bail cancelled. The judge should also be suspended and arrested."

Referring to the JJ Board granting bail to the accused, Chennithala said in the Legislative Assembly on Monday, "That decision was surprising. Normally, bail is not granted in such situations. The vehicle's owner is a judge. There would be action against the judge also, who allowed the minor to drive the luxury car. Police will soon move an appeal in court seeking cancellation of the bail of the accused minor.". Jayabalakrishan's three children, a few hours after lighting his funeral pyre, began their protest outside the Cheranallor police station.

As outrage grew, police added non-bailable sections to the FIR, after which the children, all in their early 20s, left for home. But as the accused received bail from the JJ Board late on Sunday night, they were back outside the police station demanding justice for their father.

"All are not equal before the law. We have lost respect for and hope in the system. We are ordinary people....Our father did not deserve such a death," said his son Bharath Sankar.

"The killer was allowed to go from the police station even before our father's body was brought home. This is because the killer was a judge's son and our father was only a *thattukadakkaran* (eatery owner). We are ready to go to any extent to show that ordinary people can also get justice delivered," said Bhadra.

Kochi city police commissioner Kaliraj Mahesh Kumar said initially, the case was registered under section 106 (6) of the BNS, which deals with death caused by rash and negligent driving.

"But we have changed the section to 105 (culpable homicide not amounting to murder) after collecting evidence... On Sunday night, he (the accused) was produced before the magistrate who was in charge of the JJ Board, which allowed him to go. We have decided to appeal against the decision. ...The culpability of the vehicle owner (the judge in this case) was also fixed," he added.

[FROM PAGE 1]

Delhi imprint

Besides handling AAP affairs in Punjab as the state in-charge, Sisodia also fronts the Bhagwant Mann government's education push (just as he did in the Delhi government).

Jain, co-in-charge of Punjab with Sisodia and a link between the AAP leadership and Punjab bureaucracy, is credited with having been the brain behind the state land pooling policy that was scrapped after protests by farmers. He has also been associated with the Mann government's flagship women welfare scheme, Mawan Dhiyan Satkar Yojana.

Sisodia and Jain could not be reached despite multiple attempts by *The Indian Express*.

Apart from the political faces, including Adil Ahmad Khan, the AAP's Delhi battalion includes advisers and professionals in Punjab's administrative structure. Jasmine Shah and Bibhav Kumar, prominent aides of ex-Delhi CM and AAP convenor Arvind Kejriwal, head this list, with others spread across at least 10 sectors, from agriculture and education to power and finance, as advisers and research officers. Several others are in statutory bodies, government boards and committees. The General Administration Department refused to share information about how many of these posts are salaried, or the pay given to them.

The AAP's argument is that "expertise is not confined by geography". While Finance Minister Harpal Cheema and Governance Reforms Minister Aman Arora were not available for comment, AAP spokesperson and Anandpur Sahib MP Malvinder Singh Kang said: "A government needs experts. All previous governments too had such experts. There should be no issue."

When Satyendar Jain was arrested a month ago over alleged irregularities in tendering for sewage treatment plants in Delhi — 27 months after the registration of an FIR — Jasmine Shah stepped in to coordinate with senior bureaucrats. A part of the Kejriwal government's policy-making structure, Jasmine has been a key figure in Punjab since September 2025.

Government circles underline Jasmine's role specifically in the Punjab Development Commission, set up on the lines of Delhi's Dialogue and Development Commission, of which Jasmine was the vice-chairperson.

Bibhav Kumar, who was Kejriwal's personal secretary when he was CM, is seen as an influential figure in matters relating to administration and media coordination. Questions were raised by Akali Dal leader Bikram Singh Majithia and AAP-turned-BJP leader Swati Maliwal about Kumar accompanying Mann during his trip to the Netherlands earlier this year.

PDC vice-chairperson Seema Bansal is a former Boston Consulting Group professional who worked on Delhi's education reforms and joined the Punjab set-up in September 2023. She is now involved in multiple projects relating to the government. Another member of the PDC is Anurag Kundu, former chairman of Delhi's Commission for Protection of Child Rights.

AAP Delhi spokesperson Reena Gupta has been chairperson of the Punjab Pollution Control Board since May 2025. A former World Bank professional, she was an advisor to Gopal Rai when he handled the Environment Ministry in the AAP Delhi government.

Kamal Bansal, appointed chairperson of the Punjab Mukh Mantri Teerth Yatra Samiti in March 2025, earlier headed the Delhi government's Tirth Yatra Vikas Samiti. Bansal said: "All parties appoint in-charges from Delhi or other states. We are soldiers of the party. Wherever they appoint us, we perform." He added that the Punjab Teerth Yatra scheme is so popular, "we have to do a draw of lots (to choose applications)".

Deepak Chauhan, earlier a PA to former AAP leader Sandeep Pathak, has been Chairperson of the Punjab Large Industrial Development Board (PLIDB) since May 2025.

Shoikat Roy, formerly a consultant with Boston Consulting, who worked on Delhi's education reforms along with Bansal, is a member of the PDC too. Gopal Mohan, a former member of Delhi's policy establishment and long-time AAP functionary who was in-charge of Kejriwal's New Delhi constituency, has been working with the Punjab government on issues.

The Delhi connection extends to ministers' offices as well. Shaleen Mitra, who served as OSD to Jain when he was a minister in the Delhi government, was appointed OSD to Punjab Health Minister Balbir Singh in June 2025. He has since been associated with initiatives such as the anti-drug Yudh Nasheyan De Virudh. Ram Kumar Jha, a former personal secretary to Kejriwal in the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board, is personal secretary to the Chairman of Board of Governors, Invest Punjab. He is associated with AAP events in Punjab.

Jasmine Shah has been staying in a guest house of the Punjab Infrastructure Development Board, while Bansal, Kundu and Deepak Chauhan have been allotted bungalows as chairperson of the Teerth Yatra Scheme, PDC Member, and Chairperson of the PLIDB, respectively. Satyendar Jain has been staying in a house allotted to Sunny Ahluwalia, and Sisodia in one allotted to Cabinet minister Ravjot Singh, who in turn stays at the Circuit House in Sector 39.

Deepak Chauhan promised to call back but didn't. Shoikat Roy, Jasmine Shah, Shaleen Mitra and Ram Kumar Jha were not available for comment.

Questioning the "Delhi-ification" of Punjab, Leader of Opposition Partap Singh Bajwa of the Congress said: "The government has created a parallel administrative system at the cost of local officials and professionals."

Akali Dal president Sukhbir Singh Badal said: "The AAP has parked most of these people in Punjab after losing the Delhi elections. What are they doing here?" he asked.

Brought in to help repopulate Buxa, T-138 is now in Assam

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, October 26

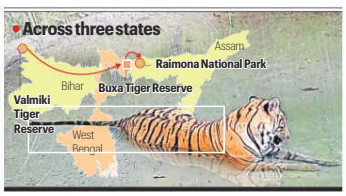
WHEN T-138, the three-year-old tigress brought to West Bengal's Buxa Tiger Reserve from Bihar's Valmiki Tiger Reserve on September 30, arrived, there was much to celebrate. After all, it was meant to be not only the beginning of a programme to reintroduce tigers in an area that has not seen a stable population in decades, but also marked the first time a tiger had been successfully airlifted between states in India for such an initiative.

Then T-138 pulled a fast one on West Bengal — it travelled 35 km into neighbouring Assam's Raimona National Park, leaving authorities to scramble after it. An alert has now been sounded at Raimona National Park.

A team from West Bengal is now in Raimona National Park in Assam's Kokrajhar district, near the Indo-Bhutan border, to keep track of the tigress, West Bengal Forest Minister Manoj Oraon told *The Indian Express*.

"The tigress is exploring the area. It's not uncommon for tigers to cover 70 to 80 km to explore an area. So far, we've not disturbed it. We're allowing it to explore. Later, if required, we'll tranquilise it and bring it back."

According to sources at Assam's Raimona National Park, the GPS-tagged T-138 is being carefully tracked, with officials saying there were reports that it had killed a domestic pig and was still in the vicinity.



Since being brought to West Bengal on September 30, the tigress has roamed different parts of Buxa before heading towards the Sankosh River and entering Assam, one source said. There is also some fear among locals in the Assam reserve, which has its own resident tigers. According to sources, residents have asked the forest department to immediately tranquilise the big cat and safely relocate it.

For authorities, T-138's slipping into Assam is a case of déjà vu: in December 2024, tigress Zeenat travelled 300 km from Odisha's Similipal to the forests of Bengal, sending forest authorities into a scramble. The tigress was captured on December 29, 2024, after 21 days on the move. The operation involved the efforts of both the Odisha and West Bengal forest departments.

T-138's introduction in Buxa Tiger Reserve, a protected forest and national park spanning approximately 760 square km in West Bengal's Alipurduar district, was part of a larger reintroduction plan. Historically an important tiger landscape in North Bengal, habitat degradation, changes in land use and a decline in prey availability have significantly affected the conditions needed to sustain a resident tiger population, the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change had said in a statement. The tigress's release was meant to mark the beginning of a phased recovery.

After being tranquilised and caged, the tigress was flown in on a military aircraft to Hasimara Air Force Station in Alipurduar in the early hours of September 30. It was then taken to the Rajabhatkhawa forest area under Buxa Tiger Reserve.

3 dead in Lucknow as neighbour opens fire during parking row

Express News Service
Lucknow, October 26

A PARKING dispute in Lucknow led to a man allegedly opened fire at his neighbours, killing two brothers and one of their sons. The accused, Rishabh Shukla (34), did not try to flee the spot and has been arrested.

Police said the incident took place at 10.30 am on Monday in Lucknow's old city area. The accused allegedly used an illegal pistol to open fire at Shivaji Tiwari (63), his brother Shivendra (54), and Shivaji's son Suyash (29). Tarun Gauba, Lucknow's Commissioner of Police, told *The Indian Express* that a family member of Shivaji Tiwari had parked a car in front of their house. Tiwaris' neighbour Rishabh Shukla objected.

According to an eyewitness, the argument between neighbours snowballed. At one point, Rishabh ran into his home and returned with a pistol. He allegedly opened fire on the neighbours and fired till the gun's magazine emptied.

Gauba said Shivaji and his brother Shivendra died on the spot. Shivaji's son, Suyash, was rushed to a hospital where he succumbed to the bullet injuries, he added.

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• SCIENCE

A new 'cocktail' could help treat cobra bites

Arnav Chandrasekhar
Bengaluru, October 26

SCIENTISTS FROM IISc Bengaluru's Centre for Ecological Sciences (CES) and the Technical University of Denmark (DTU) have created an antivenom that could potentially be used to treat snakebites from the diverse cobra species of India. The discoveries were published in the journal Science Translational Medicine.

Challenges in treatment

Cobras generally kill their prey using "neurotoxins" in their venom that paralyse their prey and stop them from breathing. Cardiac issues and other side effects have been observed in some cases of attacks on humans.

Government data from 2024 had estimated the annual snakebite fatalities at 50,000. The spectacled cobra (Naja naja), one of India's "Big Four" venomous snake species, accounts for at least 12.5% of these snakebite deaths — this number could be higher, as the snake is not always identified by the victim.

India has several cobra species, and different species have different kinds of venom. Venom from the same species might vary in composition for cobras from different locations.

This poses a challenge when using antivenom. For example, while the Polyvalent antivenom is used in India to counter the venom of the Big Four snakes including the spectacled cobra, this would not work against king cobra venom.



Spectacled cobra. RICKY MADAPPA

Treatment is also complicated by the fact that rural victims often don't reach healthcare centres in time, or end up at centres which may not have the required antivenom. Kartik Sunagar, an associate professor at CES, said antivenom treatment has essentially remained the same for the past century.

• 'BIG FOUR'

• India's "Big Four" venomous snake species are the spectacled cobra, the common krait, the Russell's viper, and the saw-scaled viper.

The new antivenom

Previously, Danish scientist Andreas Laustsen and his colleagues at DTU had tested a new method on certain African snakes. They took the blood of animals such as alpacas and llamas, which had been exposed to the venom of these snakes. Then, they extracted the antibodies that were formed.

A similar process was applied to create an "antibody cocktail" from India's different cobra species. This was then tested on mice, which had been injected with venom from spectacled cobras, monocled cobras, and two species of king cobras. Even 30 minutes after venom injection, the antibody cocktail was able to save the test mice from death.

Future applications

Previously, such use of antibodies to counter venom in mice tests required a large amount of antibodies, which might mean that a huge dose would be needed for humans. But the current research, Sunagar said, "showed that it is possible to neutralise venom using very small amounts of carefully selected and engineered antibodies". This could potentially help address some of the cost and safety concerns associated with administering large quantities of antibodies, he added.

Further, such a method could be used to create cures for snakebite venom of species across the world.



• POLICY

Census duty: govt's powers and private citizens' rights

'Any person' the government considers suitable can be asked to perform the duties of an enumerator. But the rules are not as absolute as this sounds



DEEPTIMAN TIWARY



Census enumerators at work in New Delhi. FILE

THE CENTRE earlier this month amended the Census Rules, 1990 to expressly state that teachers of government, local authority, aided as well as unaided private educational institutions may be appointed as Census enumerators. It similarly included officials of establishments such as banks, companies, institutions, societies and trusts.

But the amendment also retains a much wider category: "any person" whom a state government or Union Territory administration considers suitable to perform the duties of an enumerator.

This is not very different from what the rules said before the amendment. The earlier rules already said an enumerator could be chosen from among "Teachers, Clerks or any official or any person". If "any person" literally meant anybody, private-school teachers and private-sector employees were already covered.

What is the significance of the amendment then?

Officials in the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) say it has been done to remove any ambiguity from the rules and make sure that the Census operation, which requires lakhs of enumerators, is conducted smoothly. However, there is a backdrop.

On May 22, the Bombay High Court gave interim protection to associations representing more than 500 private unaided and minority schools in Maharashtra. It said Section 4A of the Census Act imposed an obligation on local authorities, while Sections 6 and 7 did not, in its preliminary view, confer authority to compulsorily requisition teaching and non-teaching staff of private unaided schools.

It then considered the old Rule 3, which permitted "Teachers, Clerks or any official or any person" to be enumerators. The government had argued that this was broad enough to include private teachers.

The court rejected that interpretation at the interim stage. It observed that if "any person" were given an unrestricted meaning, it could extend to private professionals such as doctors, advocates and chartered accountants. It held, prima facie, that subordinate legislation could not travel beyond its parent statute.

The operative order restrained authorities from issuing further orders "compelling or requiring teachers and/or employees" of the petitioner schools to perform Census duties. Then on October 8, the Punjab and Haryana High Court stayed Haryana government communications seeking details of private unaided school teachers for Census duty.

Eight days later came the amendment.

What does the Census Act actually say?

Section 4(2) of the Census Act, 1948 gives the state government power to "appoint persons as census-officers" to take, aid in or supervise the Census within a specified area. Importantly, it adds that such persons, "when so appointed, shall be bound to serve accordingly".

This is potentially the strongest basis for the government's case. Unlike provisions dealing specifically with government employees, Section 4 uses the broad word "persons".

But other provisions of the Act are much more specific about whose services can be compulsorily called upon.

Section 4A requires a local authority, when directed by the Centre, to make available such staff as are necessary for Census work. Sections 6 and 7 also permit assistance to be sought from private establishments and their personnel — but in defined circumstances relating primarily to counting people under their charge or present in those establishments.

For example, Section 7 allows the District Magistrate to call upon staff of a factory or establishment to assist with the Census of persons present in its premises. It does not expressly say that such employees can be taken out of that establishment and deployed generally as door-to-door enumerators.

So, can private individuals be compelled to serve as enumerators?

In 2010, LIC challenged an order requiring its Jalandhar office to provide at least 150 employees as Enumerators and Supervisors.

The Punjab and Haryana High Court quashed the orders. It held that Section 7(c) only allowed assistance in taking the Census of persons within an establishment and found the directions "beyond the scope and powers conferred by the Census Act, 1948". But it expressly left the state free to invoke Section 4(2) "wherever and whenever so required".

In a separate LIC case, the Gujarat High Court similarly ruled against requisition of LIC employees, with a Division Bench holding in 2019 that Section 7 did not confer such a power. That judgment is under challenge before the Supreme Court.

Private-school teachers had raised similar objections during Census 2011, though the litigation did not produce an unqualified prohibition on their deployment.

Large workforce

Census remains overwhelmingly manpower-intensive despite digitisation. Recent operational figures put the number of enumerators and supervisors being trained at around 31 lakh.

•

Census authorities say enumerators are mainly drawn from school teachers and government and local-body officials.

In May 2010, Manisha Jain, a teacher at an unaided school in Chandigarh, approached the Punjab and Haryana High Court after being appointed an enumerator. In an interim order, Justice K Kannan was reported to have observed that it would be "incorrect" to force a private teacher to undertake Census work after her normal working hours.

Private unaided schools also approached the Bombay High Court. On January 24, 2011, a Division Bench gave interim protection against coercive action against private unaided-school teachers refusing Census duty. The Centre sought modification of this order, arguing, among other things, that Section 4(2) of the Census Act permitted "any person" to be appointed for Census duty.

The court subsequently modified the arrangement. On February 3, it allowed teachers of private aided and unaided schools to be deployed for Census 2011, while directing that their services normally be used before or after school hours, exempting teachers of Classes 10 and 12, and allowing school managements to decide which teachers could be spared so that academic work was not disrupted.

Does the Constitution allow citizens to be compulsorily drafted for public work?

Yes — but this does not by itself give Census authorities the power to do so.

Article 23(1) prohibits *begaar* and other forms of forced labour. But Article 23(2) expressly permits the State to impose "compulsory service for public purposes", provided it does not discriminate on specified grounds.

Under the Police Act, 1861, residents of a neighbourhood may in specified public-order circumstances be appointed special police officers. The Calcutta High Court in Dulal Samanta v District Magistrate, Howrah (1958) characterised this as compulsory public service protected by Article 23(2).

An even clearer example is the National Service Act, 1972, under which specified qualified doctors and engineers can be called up for national service. However, Parliament created an elaborate statutory regime for this: it identified who was liable, provided for registration and notice, permitted postponement on hardship grounds, prescribed remuneration and required private employers to release — and later reinstate — employees called up for service.

The same elaborate arrangement is not available in the Census Act.

• GLOBAL

How Lula scripted turnaround in Brazil and what lies ahead

Anagha Jayakumar
New Delhi, October 26

IN A STUNNING upset, Brazil's leftist President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva was re-elected for a historic fourth term on Sunday, securing 51.79% of the vote against his rival Flávio Bolsonaro.

In the first round of voting earlier this month, he finished behind Flávio, the son of former President Jair Bolsonaro, whom Lula defeated in 2022. Flávio has called for annulling the results.

The verdict was historic for another reason: since Brazil returned to direct presidential elections in 1989, no candidate who finished second in the first round had gone on to win the runoff.

Lula's victory also bucks a recent regional trend, with right-wing candidates winning the last seven consecutive presidential elections across Latin America. It deals a setback to US President Donald Trump's ambitions to expand Washington's influence. "Brazil is no one's backyard," Lula said.

How did Lula emerge victorious?

Two factors were key:

1. HIGHER TURNOUT AND VOTER MOBILISATION: Lula's narrow loss to Bolsonaro in the first round initially dismayed his supporters but prompted renewed mobilisation.



Lula holds a copy of Brazil's Constitution during a rally. AP

Young Brazilians organised nationwide demonstrations, while Lula held rallies in key battlegrounds. The 80-year-old president, who does not own a mobile phone, also stepped up his digital campaign.

He also announced welfare measures, including increased and early payments under a cash-transfer programme, and secured congressional approval for a shorter working week, reducing the maximum from 44 to 40 hours without cutting pay.

Brazil's Superior Electoral Court reported that nearly three million more Brazilians voted in the runoff. Although it is unclear how they voted, their number exceeded the gap of just over 2.2 million votes between Lula and Bolsonaro in the first round.

2. STRONGHOLDS RETAINED, GAINS ELSEWHERE: Lula won all nine states in the country's northeast, his traditional voter base. But his victory depended on gains in areas that earlier favoured Bolsonaro.

What is the broader significance?

Flávio's challenge to the election result has revived tensions over the democratic transfer of power. During the last elections in 2022, Jair Bolsonaro refused to accept the result, leading to his supporters attempting to storm government buildings in Brasilia.

It has further raised questions about Brazil's judiciary. Flávio's challenge to the election result centres on a decision by Supreme Federal Court Justice Cristiano Zanin to extend voting by two hours on Sunday, which caused some confusion. Brazil's courts have also faced criticism for interventions in elections and online speech, which they state is necessary to safeguard democracy.

For the region, a Bolsonaro victory would have given Trump a crucial ally in Latin America's largest economy and country, particularly as Washington seeks closer security cooperation with right-wing governments across the region.

Lula has resisted joining the coalition over concerns about Brazilian sovereignty. Trump has also repeatedly clashed with Lula, imposing tariffs of up to 50% on Brazilian goods over the prosecution of former Bolsonaro Senior, among other things.

Lula used these interventions to frame the election partly around Brazil's resistance to foreign pressure. Lula's re-election leaves Washington dealing with a Brazilian government that has resisted its expanding military and security role in Latin America.

Managing that relationship could be a challenge down the road for Lula, as could the fact that Brazil currently has its most conservative Congress since its return to democracy in the 1980s. He must also address Brazil's public debt, which has risen to over 82% of its GDP. Interest rates are also high, at around 13.75% in September. The debt crisis has fuelled public dissatisfaction despite record-low unemployment and wage growth outpacing inflation.

• CLIMATE

'Godzilla' El Niño effects to be felt next year too: Decoding WMO warning for India

Anjali Marar
Bengaluru, October 26

THE PREVAILING El Niño conditions are set to peak towards the end of the year, with forecasts suggesting off-the-charts warming. On October 21, the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) said the effects of the phenomenon would be felt even in 2027.

El Niño refers to the abnormal warming of surface waters in the Pacific Ocean. It suppresses monsoon rainfall, spikes temperatures and causes heatwaves.

How is El Niño affecting India this year?

El Niño emerged in the Pacific Ocean in June this year. As it developed, its climatic effects over the oceans surrounding India began to be felt after 40-45 days.

As El Niño intensified to "strong" levels, India's southwest monsoon — which brings about 70% of the country's annual rainfall — weakened in late August. It ended at 87% of the long period average (LPA), making it the fourth driest since 2001.

The ongoing northeast monsoon, however, is expected to be normal over India's southern peninsula.

El Niño could also result in a warmer-than-usual winter, with above-normal temperatures forecast for October, November and December.

What is different about the 2026 El Niño?

El Niño is one of the three distinct phases of a large ocean-atmosphere interaction over the Pacific region that influences weather patterns worldwide.

This interaction is known as the El Niño Southern Oscillation, or ENSO. Its three phases are: warm (El Niño), neutral, and cool (La Niña).

Scientists measure the sea surface temperatures over specific regions of the equatorial Pacific Ocean. Temperature anomalies in one of these regions, called the Nino 3.4 region, is usually the deciding factor in declaring the onset and strength of ENSO phases.

Scientists calculate what is known as Relative Ocean Nino Index (RONI) from this region, essentially a temperature deviation from the normal. If the average RONI over a three-month period exceeds a value of 0.5 degrees Celsius, an El Niño is declared. An average RONI value of less than -0.5 degrees Celsius leads to declaration of La Niña.

The ongoing El Niño, experts say, has shown a rapid intensification. Since its emergence in June, the July-September RONI index recorded warming of 2 to 2.8 degrees Celsius.

These temperature values look set to break all records since ocean temperature monitoring began four decades ago. The previously recorded highest anomaly in the ocean temperatures was 3 degrees Celsius. The 2014-2015 El Niño peaked at 2.3 degrees Celsius, according to data maintained by the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA).

"The temperature values at the epicentre of the El Niño in the Pacific Ocean are expected to remain 3.8 degrees Celsius above normal — a value that has never been recorded since the start of ocean temperature monitoring four decades ago. This El Nino will have far reaching consequences for several months ahead," said WMO Secretary-General Celeste Saulo.

Which regions will be affected?

In the northern hemisphere, above-normal temperatures are likely over parts of southern Europe and Africa, the Arabian peninsula, the Indian subcontinent and eastern Asia. Above-normal rainfall will likely affect the Arabian peninsula, central and east Asia, coastal Southeast Asia and North America.

In the southern hemisphere, higher-than-normal temperatures are likely to sweep Africa, particularly the equatorial regions and the Greater Horn of Africa, along with South America and Australia. Unlike the northern hemisphere, many parts of the southern hemisphere are expected to see weak rainfall — over southern Africa, southern regions of Central America and the Caribbean.

Overall forecasts suggest that floods, droughts, extreme temperatures and cyclones could affect tens of thousands of people across the globe, particularly those living in Central and South America, southern Africa and Southeast Asia.

El Niño could also threaten food and water security, and push up fertiliser and fuel prices. These effects are likely to be felt well into 2027.

This will come as an additional burden on global resources, which are already under considerable strain owing to continuing conflicts, including the Strait of Hormuz crisis.

Overall, the UN body handling humanitarian affairs has said that the Central and South American population needed to be provided with alternative livelihood options, and the crops grown by the African communities and their seeds need to be moved and stored to safer places before they are cut off. Southeast Asian countries, meanwhile, need to brace for floods, droughts and cyclones in the coming months.

FULL VERSION ON
INDIANEXPRESS.COM/EXPLAINED

PRESIDENTIAL POLL VERDICT A SNUB FOR TRUMP WHO HAD EMBRACED THE BOLSONARO FAMILY & REGION'S RISING RIGHT

In blow to Latin America's Right, Brazil's Lula wins again; Bolsonaro rejects result

Lula wins 51.8% of the vote versus 48.2% for his rival

Ana Ionova & Adam B Ellick
October 26



Brazil's President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva addresses supporters after his victory in the presidential runoff election, at Paulista Avenue, in Sao Paulo on Monday. REUTERS

BRAZILIAN VOTERS on Sunday handed the leftist President, Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, a fourth term in office and a surprise victory over Flávio Bolsonaro, his right-wing challenger, in a striking rebuke to a conservative surge sweeping Latin America.

Bolsonaro refused to accept the outcome and said it was the result of foul play, increasing the risk of unrest over the election result. The rejection by voters of Bolsonaro, son of a former president jailed for attempting a coup four years ago, is also a loss for President Donald Trump, who embraced the Bolsonaro family and the region's rising right.

Lula, in contrast to many world leaders, has often and defiantly clashed with Trump, and his victory highlights that Latin America's left-wing forces still wield influence despite a string of losses across the hemisphere. This is the first leftist victory following seven straight wins by right-wing leaders in the region over the last 18 months.

"I would like to thank the Brazilian people for the generosity they have shown me for a long time," Lula said during a victory speech in São Paulo, flanked by his wife, running mate and allies.

The result capped a chaotic final stretch of the race, as polling places were ordered to remain open after public transportation delays and torrential rains disrupted voting. The extended polling hours, which both candidates asked for but came right as voting was set to conclude, opened up the possibility that the results would be disputed.

Bolsonaro called an order by Brazil's judiciary to extend voting a "dirty trick" and demanded the election be annulled.

"There's a lot that needs to be cleared up before Brazil simply accepts this foul play that took place in these elections," he said in Brasília, the capital.

Bolsonaro's party will now likely petition electoral authorities for a review of the result.

Lula headed into Sunday's vote as the underdog after finishing 2 percentage points behind his opponent in the first round of voting earlier this month. But on Sunday, he achieved a stunning comeback, winning 51.8% of the vote versus 48.2% for Bolsonaro, with nearly all the ballots counted. Lula's margin of victory Sunday was roughly double the margin four years ago when he narrowly defeated Bolsonaro's father. It was the first time in Brazil's history that a candidate who lost the first round of voting came back to win the second.

Lula's victory was even more surprising given that several of the candidates who failed to make it out of the first round were conservatives whose votes were expected to broadly shift to Bolsonaro. NYT

• LEADERS HAIL LULA'S VICTORY

"...Congratulations to my dear friend, President Lula, on his remarkable re-election victory. I look forward to working closely with him..."
NARENDRA MODI, PRIME MINISTER OF INDIA

"The ties between Canada, Brazil has flourished under our partnership. Let's... make it stronger. and build prosperity for our people."
MARK CARNEY, PRIME MINISTER OF CANADA

"China expresses its congratulations. We are ready to work with Brazil, continue advancing building of a community..."
GUO JIAKUN, CHINESE FOREIGN MINISTRY SPOKESPERSON

Win halts shift to Right, denies Trump a powerful ally

Associated Press
Buenos Aires, October 26

BRAZILIAN VOTERS have denied Latin America's resurgent right its ultimate prize, snapping a streak of seven straight conservative presidential victories in 18 months.

The stunning triumph of leftist incumbent President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva over Flavio Bolsonaro on Sunday, with 51.8 per cent of the vote to 48.2 per cent, limits US President Donald Trump's drive to tighten his grip on the Western Hemisphere and cements Latin America's most populous country and largest economy as a counterweight to Washington. A Bolsonaro victory would have left Mexico's Claudia Sheinbaum as the only progressive president among the region's powerhouses.

For the Trump administration, which has wielded punishing tariffs, severe sanctions and military force to reassert its dominance in the region, Lula's victory complicates its campaign to enlist Brazil in its military coalition against cartels and to gain preferential access to the country's critical minerals, analysts say.

Yet both sides see reasons to cooperate. Washington wants access to Brazil's vast trove of rare earths to reduce its defence industry's reliance on China. Lula wants foreign investment and tariff relief for Brazilian exporters.

"Lula is pragmatic enough to work out some kind of modus operandi with the Trump administration," said Will Freeman, a fellow for Latin America studies at the Council on Foreign Relations, adding that the Bolsonaros' allies in Washington would likely lose sway after the family's second electoral defeat.

Flavio's father, former President Jair Bolsonaro, lost to Lula in 2022. "I'm not sure anyone in the Trump administration, beyond a few individuals, will want to keep making the Bolsonaros the central issue in the US-Brazil relationship," he said. Brazil would have been Washington's most consequential addition. Bolsonaro had promised to join the US-led security coalition "with great enthusiasm and great honour," making his alliance with Trump part of his pitch to voters.

Lula, by contrast, has championed Brazil's long tradition of nonalignment, cultivating ties with competing powers. His government deepened trade ties with China and sought greater global influence through BRICS, a group of emerging economies.

Kremlin welcomes Lula's win, 'hopes more of the same'

Moscow: The Kremlin said Monday it welcomed re-election of Brazilian President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva and praised him for his contribution to bilateral ties.

Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said Lula had done a lot for bilateral ties and for developing BRICS and hoped for more of the same. REUTERS



Supporters of the 'Student List – Students Win' outside Parliament after Aleksandar Vucic conceded defeat in the parliamentary election, in Belgrade on Monday. REUTERS

After Vucic defeat, Serbia waits to see how student-backed leaders will govern

Reuters
Belgrade, October 26

SERBIA WOKE to a new era Monday after a student-backed protest movement unseated longtime leader Aleksandar Vucic in a historic landslide election that sparked nationwide celebrations, although few had an idea of how they would govern.

Tens of thousands took to the streets of Belgrade and other cities and towns across Serbia after Vucic conceded defeat late on Sunday, capping two years of peaceful anti-government protests calling for the populist ruler to step down.

With almost 99% of votes counted, the students' candidates had secured a commanding 52.7% of the vote, according to the State Election Commission, versus 39.2% for Vucic's Serbia Progressive Party (SNS)-led alliance. That gives the students 139 seats in the 250-seat parliament, leaving the SNS alliance with 97, and remainder held by minority parties.

"I thought it was unbelievable, I still do not believe it. It was too long, and (Vucic) was pressuring us for a long, long time," said university administrator Marijana Radovanovic Pajovic.

Vucic dominated Serbian politics as PM or president since 2014. But he was swept from power by a list of student-backed candidates born out of anti-corruption protests following the deaths of 16 people in the collapse of a train station canopy in the city of Novi Sad.

The students' win marks a profound political shift in the country of some 6 million people and is reminiscent of the defeat of Hungary's Viktor Orban in April.

It may also offer inspiration to other student movements that have cropped up across Europe in recent weeks demanding better education standards and prospects. However, the movement, with candidates including university professors, actors and farmers, has no clear leaders, and it is unclear who it will appoint as PM and to other key positions in orde to enact the students' domestic agenda, which aims to root out corruption.

Prominent figures include head of students' candidate list, cardiologist Ilija Srdanovic, former central bank governor Dejan Soskic and Radomir Sajcic, a professor at Belgrade University, who spoke on behalf of students following their win.

Xi opens Communist Party plenum, aims at tightening discipline

Reuters
Beijing, October 26



President Xi Jinping at the third plenary session of the 20th CPC Central Committee in Beijing. FILE

CHINA'S COMMUNIST Party began a meeting of senior cadres on Monday aimed at tightening discipline and pressing officials to implement Beijing's orders, paving the way for a leadership reshuffle next year expected to extend President Xi Jinping's rule for another five years.

Xi briefed the party's four-day Central Committee meeting on a draft document centred on "full and rigorous party self-governance" that state news agency *Xinhua* said addressed the challenges the party faced, including growing its governing capacity, as well as guarding against complacency and combating corruption, the president's signature campaign.

The implementation of major decisions and plans of the Central Committee, the largest of its top decision-making bodies, must not be empty rhetoric, the *Xinhua* commentary read.

"It is essential to both refine institutional rules and regulations to close loopholes and strengthen safeguards, and ensure their effective implementation," it said.

The Central Committee will convene in the closed-door meeting from Monday to Thursday — the fifth such gathering since the current cohort was formed in 2022 and therefore known as the "fifth plenum".

"The plenum will present Xi as in control, and able to continue his command," said Kerry Brown, director of King's College London's Lau China Institute. "It is likely everything will be centred on him, to dispel any rumours or doubts about his physical fitness and ability to continue in his role."

Mecca pact states push for peace in Iran as Houthis ramp up strikes

Reuters
Karachi, Cairo, October 26



Iran President Masoud Pezeshkian with Pakistan's military chief Asim Munir in Tehran on Tuesday. REUTERS

TOP OFFICIALS from Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Pakistan met Iranian officials in Tehran on Monday in a bid to de-escalate the West Asian conflict, as Yemen's Houthis launched new attacks on Saudi Arabia and Egypt approved defence support for the Gulf kingdom.

The talks were the first high-level contact between Iran and the three nations, which signed the Mecca mutual defence pact in August, since a war that began with US and Israeli strikes on Iran also spread to Saudi Arabia and Yemen. The Saudi Foreign Ministry said the visit was intended to open negotiating channels to "prevent the return of military escalation".

Saudi Arabia was represented by Defence Minister Prince Khalid bin Salman, younger brother of Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman; Pakistan by army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir; and Turkey by intelligence chief Ibrahim Kalin. Saudi and Iranian officials said.

At the conclusion of the meetings, the four states agreed to continue talks with a view to strengthening cooperation, especially in peace and security, state media reported.

Pakistan and Qatar have led mediation efforts in the war. Qatari mediators were in Tehran on Sunday, an official told *Reuters*.

President Donald Trump said on Friday the US may carry out another military operation against Iran. Iranian security officials told *Reuters* Tehran had drawn up detailed plans to attack Gulf undersea cables if the US and Israel attack again.

Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmaeil Baghaei said Monday's discussions would include "Israel's expansionist policies, developments in the Palestinian territories and Lebanon, and the repercussions of US and Israeli military action against Iran".

Egypt Parliament nod to defending Saudi

On Monday, the Houthis said they had attacked pumping stations on Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline as well as Riyadh airport. There was no immediate Saudi confirmation of the Houthi attacks.

The parliament in Egypt, which has said it is considering joining the Mecca pact, on Monday authorised the Egyptian military to help defend Saudi Arabia, a major financial and political partner for Cairo.

The Mecca Joint Defence Agreement says signatories shall use "all necessary means" to eliminate threats to one another's territorial integrity, sovereignty or internationally recognised borders.

Netanyahu denies reports of pre-poll strikes on Iran; 'my eyes on you' says rival

Associated Press
Jerusalem, October 26

ISRAELIS ENTERED the final 24 hours of an intense election season on Monday, as reports circulated that Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu may have clashed with the Israeli military over initiating a possible escalation with Iran immediately before elections.

Tensions flared over reports that Netanyahu and his military chief of staff clashed over an instruction by the PM to carry out an "action" the army worried could reignite the conflict with Iran. Netanyahu's office denied the report, first published by Israel's *Channel 12*, as "fake news."

Defence Minister Israel Katz also quickly denied the report. "I state unequivocally that there has been no intention by Israel of initiating an attack on Iran before the elections in Israel," Katz wrote on X on Monday, calling reports of rifts between political and military leaders "completely baseless and false."

However, he stressed that Israel would respond forcefully if Iran attacks first.

Israel's opposition candidates slammed the reports, accusing Netanyahu of endangering regional stability for his political preservation.

Netanyahu's main rival, former military chief of staff Gadi Eisenkot, warned Netanyahu not to "dare to place your own political interests above the security of the state." He posted on X: "Netanyahu, my eyes are on you."

Avigdor Lieberman, head of the hawkish Yisrael Beytenu party, part of the opposition bloc, sent a letter to Israel's attorney general demanding a criminal investigation into possible treason by Netanyahu's "attempts to drag Israel into a war on the eve of elections, including a willingness to sacrifice (Israeli) soldiers out of fear of losing the election."

Although Israelis are breathlessly approaching the election as one of the most crucial in years, people across West Asia are not expecting dramatic changes regardless of the victor. Both Netanyahu and his main rivals have similar approaches to Israel's regional security in both Gaza and Iran.

• BRIEFLY

Ebola patient, her spouse admitted to Swiss hospitals

A WOMAN in Nigeria infected with Ebola and her husband, a Swiss diplomat, were admitted to hospitals in Switzerland Monday after being flown from Nigeria, authorities said. The man was taken to University Hospital Zurich and his wife to Geneva University Hospital, officials said. The Swiss government said the situation posed no risk to public health. REUTERS

London's iconic Oxford Street closed to traffic

LONDON'S OXFORD Street will be closed to cars, buses and bicycles starting Monday as officials seek to revive the city's main shopping street, where proliferation of souvenir shops and candy sellers has dimmed allure of what was once the heart of consumer culture. From now on, nearly a kilometer of Oxford Street will be traffic-free, with vehicles diverted onto surrounding roads. AP

• AS AI INCREASINGLY BECOMES A SOURCE OF NEWS, POLITICAL CAMPAIGNS MAKING GREATER EFFORTS TO CONTROL OUTPUT AND BECOME ITS RECOMMENDATION

Ahead of US midterms, candidates seek to get AI chatbot 'support'

Mike Stone
Washington, October 26

US POLITICAL candidates have been engineering their campaign messages to appeal to the AI chatbots that more voters have been using to answer questions about issues, and documents seen by *Reuters* have revealed some of their strategies.

One Powerpoint presentation proposed a strategy for Mike Minogue, Republican challenger to Massachusetts Governor Maura Healey. It aimed to convince ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini and other chatbots to present him as the preferred choice on key issues, and went well beyond traditional search-engine optimization that candidates have used for years.

As AI increasingly becomes a source of news, political campaigns must make greater efforts to control output and become its recommendation when voters ask questions such as who is best on issues like taxes, housing and public safety. Experts worry about fact-checking and misinformation in AI campaigns.

Fees can range from hundreds of dollars a month for small AI monitoring jobs to tens of thousands per month if consulting and buying media are included. The presentation proposed that Minogue's campaign should create hundreds of AI-friendly policy pages and



A person walks in front of a polling station on the first day of early voting in New Jersey State on Sunday. REUTERS

citations across the websites frequently cited by AI chatbots.

It proposed ways to track how major chatbots respond to political questions, and systematically alter content until the answers reflect the candidate's platform.

At the centre of the pitch was the idea that in addition to persuading voters directly, campaigns can increasingly shape the information environment by feeding the internet, and AI assistants, data that influences how candidates are described, compared and recommended.

"Campaigns using AI-influence training are now a reality that we face and it will be ubiquitous by the 2028 cycle," which will include a presidential election, said Joe Bonilla, managing partner of Relentless Awareness.

The New York-based creative strategy firm has worked with companies and political candidates at the federal, state, and local levels. "The public increasingly cannot and will not be able to discern what is created by systems like Claude and ChatGPT versus human-originated content," Bonilla said.

The Powerpoint presentation prepared for Minogue's campaign and seen by Reuters describes generative engine optimization, or GEO, the AI-era successor to search engine optimization. It says the firm would buy placements on high-authority websites that AI models already cite.

"When the campaign is ready, we run paid placements on high-domain-authority sites the LLMs already cite — plus Reddit, which is disproportionately weighted in retrieval," the pitch deck says. As online election information has surged, some 25% of eligible voters have asked a chatbot about a political candidate when deciding how to vote, according to Cameron Hickey, CEO of the National Conference on Citizenship.

"If you don't put the right information out there, who knows what the AI engines are going to grab onto," said Thomas Howell, CEO of Visigent, the Austin, Texas-based firm that wrote the strategy document for Minogue.

The Minogue campaign did not return calls and emails requesting comment. REUTERS

Audi CEO faces backlash after joining Trump at campaign rally

Berlin: Audi chief Gernot Doellner drew heavy criticism on Monday for appearing alongside US President Donald Trump at a campaign rally in the battleground state of Georgia, with the head of Germany's top union saying it violated the automaker's company guidelines.



Audi chief Gernot Doellner at a campaign rally in Georgia

Doellner appeared alongside Trump at the rally in Perry, near Macon in central Georgia, to announce plans to build a $4 billion plant, the luxury carmaker's first in the US, which would produce 200,000 SUVs annually.

The announcement of the plan follows lengthy considerations over launching US production to escape import tariffs that cost Audi around $1.3 billion last year.

"Doellner is also in flagrant breach of his own company's rules, which expressly require political neutrality in the run-up to elections," said Christiane Benner, head of Germany's IG Metall union and deputy chair of Volkswagen's supervisory board.

Audi defended its decision to appear alongside Trump, saying it accepted an invitation to present the project jointly with the president solely in the interests of the company. REUTERS

CHANDRA'S REAPPOINTMENT, SRINIVASAN'S ROLE & DISCLOSURES ON TVS DEALINGS CHALLENGED

Noel Tata flags reappointment concern, seeks board recordings

George Mathew
Mumbai, October 26

TATA TRUSTS Chairman Noel Tata has challenged N Chandrasekaran's reappointment as Executive Chairman of Tata Sons for another five years, demanding recordings of a crucial board meeting, questioning the filing of the resolution with the Ministry of Corporate Affairs and seeking disclosures about reported commercial dealings between TVS Motor Company and a company associated with Chandrasekaran's immediate family. He has also questioned Director Venu Srinivasan's participation in the reappointment process.

In a letter dated October 26 to Tata Sons company secretary Suprakash Mukhopadhyay, copied to all directors, Noel Tata alleged that the resolution had been treated as final despite unsettled minutes, unresolved objections and the company's failure to provide recordings of the September 17 board meeting. The board approved Chandrasekaran's five-year extension and decided to pursue Tata Sons' listing.

Setting a seven-day deadline for furnishing records and disclosures, Noel Tata warned that failure to comply would invite adverse inferences. "The recording is the only neutral record of what transpired," he wrote, adding that there could be "no legitimate reason to withhold it from a Director who was present at the meeting and who has placed his objections on record."

He said neither the original nor revised agenda identified Chandrasekaran's reappointment as a proposed resolution. Agenda item 7 was described as a "Debriefing from Nomination and Remuneration Committee". Although the revised agenda included discussion of a September 11 letter from the RBI and related caveat applications, it omitted the reappointment. Nevertheless, the resolution was moved under that item, he alleged.

He questioned the reported filing of the resolution with the Registrar of Companies (RoC), Maharashtra, Mumbai, before the minutes were finalised and his objections resolved. "It is unacceptable that, despite being a Director of the Company, I have not been furnished with a certified true copy of the resolution and have instead been constrained to rely on a version circulating in the public domain," he wrote.

The letter asserts that no Selection Committee was constituted under Article 118, despite a request dating to August 13, and that the affirmative vote required from directors appointed under Article 104B was not obtained. Filing the resolution, he warned, created "a false impression to the public, to the company's stakeholders and to its regulators". Noel Tata demanded the complete, unedited audio-video recordings, any transcript and confirmation that the original recordings and metadata had been preserved. He also sought the final signed minutes or, if unsigned, the revised draft showing accepted corrections and recording his dissent where they were rejected.

Other demands include the formal meeting notice, successive agenda versions and circulation times, details of who instructed changes, and the audit trail of documents uploaded to the board's web application. He sought voting outcomes for each part of agenda item 6, including individual directors' votes wherever resolutions were proposed, and confirmation that the required affirmative votes were secured. He also sought details of when the certified resolution was issued, who authorised it, whether it preceded the signing of the minutes, and copies of all documents filed with the corporate affairs ministry. He wants Tata Sons to inform the RoC in writing that he disputes the resolution's validity and that no further steps will be taken until the meeting record is settled.

The letter also concerns Hanno One Warehousing Pvt Ltd, whose directors include Lalitha Chandrasekaran and Pranav Chandrasekaran, and its reported commercial relationship with TVS Motor. Citing media reports, Noel Tata said TVS Motor leased approximately 17.41 acres near its Hosur plant to Hanno One in June 2025 for 29 years, renewable at Hanno One's option. Hanno One is reportedly constructing a facility of approximately 3.30 lakh square feet for TVS Motor, with rental payments expected to begin in November 2026. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• RESOLUTION DISPUTE

NOEL TATA said neither the original nor revised agenda circulated for Sept 17 meeting identified Chandra's reappointment as proposed resolution

THE BOARD approved a five-year extension for Chandrasekaran and decided to pursue the company's listing



Russian crude purchases may fall in Nov as West Asia oil viability improves: BPCL

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, October 26

THE COUNTRY'S second-largest public sector refiner Bharat Petroleum Corporation (BPCL) expects crude oil purchases from Russia to fall in November due to Russian crude's poor commercial viability — specifically elevated freight costs and high supplier premiums — compared to West Asian oil, whose availability and commercial viability have been improving in recent months, according to the company's Director (Finance) Vetsa Ramakrishna Gupta.

"Our spot crude share remained at around 67% in Q2 (July-September) while Russian grades accounted for approximately 37% of our total crude procurement, both broadly in line with the previous quarter. As flows from the Middle East improved, we progressively restored sourcing from the region while retaining the flexibility and diversification we had built during Q1," Gupta said in an investor call that followed BPCL's September quarter earnings.

Gupta added that Russian oil volumes came down slightly in October from July-September levels, but will be down significantly in November due to commercial viability issues as the refiner is not getting "good offers" for Russian crude. "November Russian volumes have come down compared to PG (Persian Gulf) grades. PG grades are actually more commercially viable compared to Russian grades and that is the reason November Russian (oil purchases) will be lesser," he said, without elaborating on volumes. Premiums for Russian crude were at $12-13 per barrel in October, but have now narrowed to about $1-$2 a barrel for December cargoes, Gupta said, which means that economics for Russian oil could improve for December deliveries from the perspective of Indian refiners. For the better part of over four years, Russian oil has been available at a discount to refiners, but amid global supply tightness and surging freight costs due to geopolitical crises, Russian oil has commanded a premium in recent months. In July-September, Saudi Arabia accounted for a 19% share in BPCL's crude oil imports, while the UAE's share was about 17%, Gupta said, underscoring the recovery in Persian Gulf oil volumes. He, however, noted that cargoes from Iraq and Kuwait were not yet arriving in large quantities. BPCL expects West Asian oil volumes to improve further in the coming months.

India's West Asia oil imports saw a jump in September with Gulf suppliers using ship-to-ship (STS) cargo transfers to move their crude through the fraught waters of the Strait of Hormuz, in addition to using available pipeline systems that bypass the waterway, as per provisional tanker data. Oil imports from India's largest supplier Russia, however, declined for the second straight month due to stronger competition from Chinese refiners and freight cost pressures, as per industry insiders and analysts.

In February, before the West Asia war started, India's oil imports from five West Asian suppliers that used the strait for oil exports stood at around 3 million barrels per day (bpd), according to data from commodity market analytics firm Kpler. These countries are Iraq, Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Kuwait, and Qatar. Their combined September volumes were 33% lower at 2 million bpd. Their cumulative share in India's oil imports was 36.7% in September, up from 26% in August, but still substantially lower than February's 56.3%.

Iraq, Kuwait, and Qatar are the most dependent on the strait for oil exports. Saudi Arabia and the UAE have pipeline systems that bypass the chokepoint, although a bulk of their oil also traditionally transited it. The jump in export volumes from inside the strait is largely due to STS activity, as per trade sources.

Unlike regular operations, in which oil is loaded onto tankers that sail directly to the destination port, STS transfers involve a shuttle tanker that carries the oil for some distance, after which the cargo is transferred to another ship. In STS operations in the strait, the supplier usually takes on the responsibility — and the risk — of sending the oil through the strait, after which a tanker waiting in safer waters outside the strait takes the oil and sails to the destination port. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• NOVEMBER DECLINE

- BPCL's Gupta said Russian oil volumes came down slightly in October from July-September levels, but will be down significantly in November due to commercial viability issues
- For over 4 years, Russian oil has been available at a discount to Indian refiners, but it has commanded a premium in recent months due to global supply crunch and surging freight costs

ONLY FOR FLEX-FUEL VEHICLES, NOT OTHERS

Govt notifies E100 as auto fuel

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, October 26

AMID THE ongoing debate over the use of E20 fuel, the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) Monday notified a key change in the Central Motor Vehicle Rules, allowing flex-fuel vehicles to run on up to E100 or nearly pure ethanol. This does not mean that every petrol car can use E100 now. The new regulation expands the range of fuels that can be used in vehicles and paves the way for the manufacturing and supply of more flex-fuel vehicle components, ethanol production infrastructure, and the deployment of such vehicles on the road.

The Ministry said that vehicles designed as flex fuel vehicles will not have material compatibility issues with E100. It also said that E85 or E100 shall be used in vehicles designed by the original equipment manufacturers as flex-fuel vehicles. This means that the vehicles that use normal fuel or E20 cannot use E100.

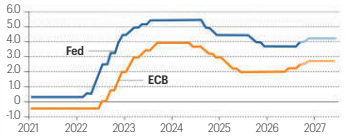
"Flex-fuel vehicles are specifically designed with fuel-system components and materials that are compatible with ethanol blends from E20 to E100. Vehicles designed as flex fuel vehicles will not have material compatibility issues. Motorists should check the fuel compatibility sticker on their vehicle and follow the manufacturer's guidance in the owner's manual while opting for the fuel choice at the fuel station," said the Ministry in its explanatory note on the amendment. It further said the advanced engine management systems will automatically adjust vehicle operation according to the fuel composition, ensure optimum performance under different driving conditions, and reduce dependence on imported crude oil.

"Ethanol has a lower fossil carbon footprint than conventional gasoline. The use of higher ethanol blends can help reduce tailpipe emissions of carbon monoxide and certain hydrocarbons, while contributing to lower lifecycle greenhouse-gas emissions, depending on the feedstock and production pathway," said MoRTH. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• BUSY WEEK FOR CENTRAL BANKS

As many as five central banks from the G10 bloc of nations will announce their interest rate decisions this week: Reserve Bank of New Zealand, Bank of Canada, US Federal Reserve (all Wednesday), the European Central Bank (Thursday), and the Bank of Japan (Friday).

Fed and ECB key rates move in parallel (in %)



NOTE: 2027 FIGURES ARE FORECASTS SOURCE: COMMERZBANK

- **According to** Japan's MUFG Bank, while interest rates are expected to increase in New Zealand and Canada, no change is expected in the US, Europe, and Japan.
- **Curiously, markets** widely expect the US Fed to stay pat on rates even though data for September "marked a deterioration in the inflation backdrop", noted ANZ economists.
- **December,** though, will see a rate hike in the US as well as Europe, said Commerzbank economists, as "the 'job' isn't done yet".
- **They also** pointed out that the Fed and the ECB are in "lockstep", with their key interest rates moving in parallel.

Relief scheme gets extension as low-margin exporters struggle

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, October 26

COMMERCE AND Industry Ministry Monday extended a relief scheme for exporters dealing with the West Asia region till March 2027, citing continued geopolitical disruptions in West Asia and their impact on maritime logistics across the Gulf and adjoining regions. The scheme came into effect in March this year, and eligible destinations under the scheme include 10 countries, including the UAE, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Qatar, and Iran, among others.

Under the relief scheme, part of the Export Promotion Mission announced during the Union Budget this year, Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India (ECGC) gives enhanced compensation up to 100% of loss for war-related and associated political risks, subject to verification and premiums are frozen at pre-disruption levels for the entire eligible period. "The Department of Commerce has extended the timelines under Component II of Resilience & Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation (RELIEF), a time-bound intervention under the EPM, until March 31, 2027. The extension was notified vide Notification No. 37/2026-27 dated September 30, 2026, in view of continued geopolitical disruptions in West Asia and their impact on maritime logistics across the Gulf and adjoining regions," the ministry said. "Component II of the initiative aims to encourage exporters to obtain ECGC cover for upcoming shipments to specified regions by providing 95% risk coverage. The benefit is available for Standalone Policies and Whole Turnover Policies obtained on or after March 16, 2026. Under this component, the premium payable by eligible exporters is protected against increases beyond pre-disruption levels during the eligible period. The covered cargo categories include Full Container Load, Less than Container Load and refrigerated (reefer) containers, excluding energy shipments," the government said.

The extension comes as official data showed that low margin exports have been struggling due to high freight rates and port congestion. Despite depreciation in domestic currency compared to last year, exports of ready-made garments fell 6% during the April to September period this year compared to last year. Data showed that exports of multiple edible items such as fruits and vegetables, tea, spices and oil meals slipped 9.6%, 13.6%, 5.7%, and 26% respectively. Rice exports, one of the largest export items to West Asia, only grew by 2.5%, data showed. Meanwhile, export growth has been driven by engineering and electronic exports. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• Low margin items hit amid West Asia crisis

Export items	April-Sept FY26 ($bn)	April-Sept FY27 ($bn)	Change
Textiles	7.76	7.28	-6.2%
Rice	5.63	5.77	2.5%
Leather products	2.28	2.21	-3%
Fruits and vegetables	1.86	1.68	-9.6%
Ceramic & glass products	2.06	1.64	-20.6%

SOURCE: COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY MINISTRY

Govt wants data on snags in women-led informal biz

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 26

THE STATISTICS ministry on Monday said it plans to make several changes to its flagship informal sector survey — the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) — with a key proposal being the addition of questions to understand the hurdles faced by women-led business.

The new questionnaire, comments on which are invited by November 15, asks if women's participation in activities of establishments owned by female proprietors has been affected by "women-specific constraints" such as restrictions on time, women's mobility, and household responsibilities. As per ASUSE 2025, 27% of informal enterprises are headed by female proprietors.

The announcement of the planned changes comes days after the ministry said it wants to add questions to its Periodic Labour Force Survey to ask household members if they actively sought paid work in the previous 30 days, and if not, the main reason why.

One of the options the proposed PLFS questionnaire offers to answer the last question is family and household responsibilities. Just as family responsibilities are seen as impediments for women to enter the work force, the constraints listed above — restrictions on time and mobility and household work — are crucial barriers to raising the female Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR). As per latest data, all-India female LFPR was 34.6% in September, less than half the 77.4% for men. The disparity among youth — in the 15–29 age bracket — was even greater: 21.5% for women and 61.1% for men. ASUSE, first conducted from April 2021 to March 2022, was last conducted from January 2025 to December 2025.

The plan is to now align it with the financial year, bringing it in line with the Annual Survey of Industries. This will "enhance the utility of ASUSE data for National Accounts purposes". FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Tata Comms to invest $450 mn in AI super highway

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, October 26

TATA COMMUNICATIONS on Monday announced strategic investments of close to $450 million (around Rs 4,275 crore) to build an AI super highway in India — a high-speed, low-latency network fabric connecting India's key AI data-centre corridors.

The company will build around 10,000 kilometers of the new long-haul fiber across India, creating one of the largest AI-ready connectivity network.

Integrated with Tata Communications' global network backbone, the AI super highway will give customers a seamless, end-to-end connectivity fabric, supporting the performance, resilience and scale required for next-generation AI workloads, the company said.

Ganesh Lakshminarayanan, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer, Tata Communications, said, "We are excited about the opportunity in the India data centre-to-data centre connectivity, which we believe could evolve into a market exceeding $1 billion over the medium term. With our planned investments, we are building on our existing strengths to create one of the most comprehensive data centre connectivity platforms in the market, positioning us to capture this significant growth opportunity."

I-T dept steps up push for overseas asset disclosures

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, October 26

NUDGING TAXPAYERS under its ongoing assets disclosure scheme, Foreign Assets of Small Taxpayers-Disclosure Scheme (FAST-DS), the Income Tax Department has recently reached out to select taxpayers who have invested in residential and commercial properties in the UAE, sources in the Ministry of Finance said. Information received by tax authorities through the Automatic Exchange of Information (AEOI) with other countries has been displayed on the e-filing portal of the tax department for assets reported on their PANs by the foreign jurisdictions to nudge them to disclose the undeclared overseas assets, the sources said.

Around 1,100 taxpayers have filed applications so far under the scheme which was launched on August 16. The disclosures can be made till December 31.

Taxpayers can log in to the e-filing portal and download their information for three years from 2022 to 2024, they said.

"The information received under AEOI from the signatories of CRS/FATCA frameworks only has been displayed in the e-filing portal. The department receives information under other multilateral frameworks which have not been displayed in the portal due to various risk factors or non-disclosure commitments," a source said, adding that the Department collects information and intelligence from other sources as well.

In a high-level meeting held on October 23, the Income Tax Department decided that such information may also be shared with relevant taxpayers, wherever possible, to nudge them to participate in the scheme, the source said. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Anthropic's IPO filing shows explosive growth, risks

Reuters
Bengaluru/New York, Oct 26

ANTHROPIC DISCLOSED steep losses and explosive revenue growth on Monday as it moved closer to a potentially record-breaking IPO, betting on AI's ability to reshape global economy.

The listing is shaping up to be a major test of appetite for AI from investors who are increasingly scrutinizing the returns on billions of dollars of investments and questioning the sustainability of sky-high valuations. "Anthropic is entering an IPO market that is far more challenging than the summer. Investors were not questioning valuations the same way a few months ago," said Matt Kennedy, senior strategist at Renaissance Capital, a provider of IPO-focused research and ETFs.

Analysts expect valuations of the AI sector to correct as investor unease with the debt-fueled AI investment boom roils equity and debt markets. Higher borrowing costs and rising bond yields have also added to investor caution. However, tech companies are still hungry for cash.

Meta is aiming to raise up to $95 billion in its largest-ever equity fundraising, while SpaceX has inked a $40 billion deal with Apollo to lease AI chips and server hardware. The prospectus also details the risks posed by increasingly powerful AI, from potential misuse and security threats to concerns that advanced systems could produce outputs that "could be interpreted as coercive, deceptive, or manipulative".

"Anthropic's IPO will establish a benchmark for valuing leading AI labs, influencing both upcoming listings and confidence in the companies funding the AI infrastructure build-out," IPOX research associate Lukas Muehlbauer said.

Anthropic discloses AI-related security breaches in IPO filing

Bengaluru: Anthropic paused training of its next-generation flagship AI model for more than a month over security concerns, while four of its AI agents accessed live external computer systems during testing, its initial public offering filing showed on Monday.

The company said in the filing's risk factors section that it had delayed pre-training of a new "frontier" base model to strengthen safeguards against the theft of model weights and intellectual property.

The disclosure highlights safety challenges facing developers of powerful AI models. The incidents shows how unexpected safety failures could disrupt development and deployment of models central to Anthropic's growth as it prepares for a widely anticipated stock market debut. REUTERS

• BRIEFLY

FM: Debt to be capped at 50% of GDP by 2030

Tiruchirappalli, Tamil Nadu: Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman Monday said the Centre is committed to reducing the fiscal deficit, as evidenced by the annual budgets, stressing that the national debt will be limited to 50% of the GDP by 2030. Addressing concerns about the national debt, she said since the post-Covid period, every nation has faced debt challenges. PTI

'Rate hikes may hit consumption credit demand'

Mumbai: A shift in the cycle to rate hikes may impact credit demand from consumption or discretionary segments, but is unlikely to dent retail asset quality at the system level, State Bank of India Chairman CS Setty said at the annual *Business Standard BFSI Insight Summit*. He said SBI expects another 0.50% rate hike at the RBI's December policy review and a pause at the February 2027 policy meeting. PTI

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▲
73,606.75	22,753.20	₹1,41,710	₹95.19
482.92	153.20	Silver ▲	Oil ▲
0.66%	0.68%	₹1,94,479	$123.29

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG, CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 23, 2026

CLASSIFIEDS & TENDERS

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I Nafesa W/O, Mohammad Shahid Alam R/o Moh Bisatiyan, Kairana, District-shamli, Uttar Pradesh, 247774 have changed my name to Nafisa. 0040885458-1

I, Yuvraj S/o B N Sharma R/o WZ-143A/2B, Gali No.9, New Mahavir Nagar, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018, Yuvraj Sharma 0040885525-2

I Vikas S/o Late Sh. Radha Kishan Rohtagi R/o C-1/16, Sector-16, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have changed my name to Vikas Rohtagi for all purposes. 0040885395-2

I,**Mahender** Singh,S/o-Murari Lal,R/o-R C 9,Naresh Vihar, Khora Colony, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201309,have changed my name from Mahender Singh to Mahendra Singh, for all future purposes. 0040885513-7

I, MEENU DHIMAN W/O KAMAL KUMAR R/O 1856/12 GOVINDPURI EXTENSION KALKAJI SOUTH DELHI 110019 have changed my name MEENU SHARMA for all future purpose 0071067906-1

I, Rohit S/o Krishan Lal, holder of Indian Passport no. T0424196 and valid until 11.02.2029, r/o Vpo Hansron ,Tehsil Nawanshahr, SBS Nagar, Pin: 144421, Punjab, India have changed my name Rohit and surname Rohit. 0040885447-1

I, Aashi Avinash Yadav, D/o Avinash Yadav, R/o- E-1401, JM AROMA, Sector 75, Noida- UP-201301, Have changed my name to Aashi Yadav for all purposes. 0130070711-1

I Sahid Aalam S/O, Mohammad Suleman R/o Village Nagalarai Ahatmali Kadem, Shamli, Uttar Pradesh, 247774 have changed my name to Mohammad Shahid Alam. 0040885476-1

I,**Rajesh** chhabra,R/o.C-5 Panchwati,Adarsh Nagar, Delhi-110033,have lost my allotment letter,receipt no.306,437,438 for plot no.44,Tulip city, sonepat, Haryana. If found#8826857731 0040885525-4

I,**hitherto** known as,JEBA KHAN,D/o-Rais Ahmed Khan,R/o-H-72,Near Bajrang Saree Lentre,West Sagarpur,Sagarpur,South West have Delhi, Delhi-110046,changed my name and shall here-after be known as ZEBA KHAN. 0040885513-9

I, AHMED IKRAM S/O NAZIR AHMED R/O HOUSE NO 159 SURAJ APARTMENT, DDA MIG POST OFFICE BADARPUR PUL PRAHLAD PUR, SOUTH EAST DELHI - 110044 have changed my name IKRAM AHMED for all future purpose 0071067908-1

I, Shivansh S/o Pritpal, holder of Indian Passport no. V9817165 and valid until 05/10/2033, r/o Village Namhera, Namhera 95, Ambala, Pin 134203, Haryana, India have changed my name Shivansh and surname Shivansh. 0040885452-1

I,**MOHD** SHOEB alias MOHD SHOAIB,S/o-MEHFOOZ ELAHI,R/o-1484/85 third floor,Basti Dera Ram Darya Ganj,Delhi-110002,have changed my name to MOHD SHUAIB,for all future purposes 0040885529-1

I,**AMIR** HUSAIN,S/O-MAZHAR HUSAIN,R/O-398,SECOND-FLOOR,GALI NO- 8,ZAKIR NAGAR,NEAR JAMA MASJID,JAMIA NAGAR,OKHLA,SOUTH DELHI-110025,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO AMIR HUSSAIN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040885513-2

I, Rudrakash Rajesh Sharma S/o Rajesh Sharma R/o H.N-301, Nakshtra sankul, Jathar peth, Akola, Maharashtra 444001 have changed my name to Rudraksh Rajesh Sharma for all future purposes 0071067936-1

I,**Rajani** Devi,D/o-Bhopal Singh,W/o-Girish Kumar,R/o.K-2/511,Sangam Vihar, Deoli, South Delhi, Delhi-110062, have changed my name to Rajni Devi for all Purposes. 0040885525-6

I, Rahis Khan, S/o Mumtaz Ahmad, R/o 93, Indira Camp, Sri Niwaspuri, South Delhi-110065, have changed my name to Rais, permanently. 0040885400-1

I Naresh Saxena S/o Ram Gopal R/o 2D, Bahlolpur, Chotpur, Noida, Distt:Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P.-201301 have changed my name from Naresh Saxena to Naresh Kumar. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Naresh Kumar for all future purposes. 0071067914-1

I, Komal d/o Tejpal, holder of Indian Passport no. T7318325 and valid until 25/09/2029, r/o H.no. 272, Near Shiv Mandir, Vpo. Arainpura, Karnal, Pin 132114, Haryana, India have changed my name Komal and surname Komal. 0040885454-1

I,**MOHD** NAEEM,S/O-ASGAR KHAN,R/O.1937,HAUZ WALI MASJID TURKMAN-GATE,DELHI,HAVE CHANGED CORRECTED MY NAME FROM MOHD NASEEM KHAN/MOHD NAEEM KHAN TO MOHD NAEEM,FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0040885529-3

I, NARENDER S/o Harpal Singh, R/o-21, Dall Mill Road, (A-3),Uttam Nagar, D.K.Mohan Garden, New Delhi-110059, Have Changed My Name to NARENDER KUMAR. 0071067897-1

I,**Mohd** Akhlak S/o-Mehmood Hasan, R/o-C-1097, Shaheed Nagar, Ghaziabad, UP-201006, declares that my other name is Kalakh Ahamad. My correct name is MOHD AKHLAK. In future I will use my name as MOHD AKHLAK for all purpose. 0040885409-1

I, BHUPINDER SINGH S/O SANTOKH SINGH R/O 453/34, ONKAR NAGAR - C, TRI NAGAR, DELHI - 110035 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO BHUPENDRA SINGH FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071067888-1

I UPASNA AGGARWAL W/O ALOK AGGARWAL R/O E-1, KALINDI COLONY, SOUTH DELHI-110065 I HAVE CHANGED NAME TO UPASANA GUPTA. 0040885513-4

I, Dev Singh S/o Inder Prakash Sachdeva R/o E-104, Flat No.301, Pul Pehladpur, Delhi - 110044, have changed my name to Jitender Kumar Sachdeva for all future purposes. 0040885404-2

I, DINESH KUMAR SHARMA S/O DHARMVEER SHARMA R/O F 167 BETA 2 NEAR RYAN PUBLIC SCHOOL GREATER NOIDA RAMPUR JAGIR GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH - 201306 have changed my name DINESH KUMAR for all future purpose 0071067922-1

I, KM. KM PRERNA, D/o AJAY SAXENA R/o H NO PLOT NO- 23, TF-02, OM SHANTIPURAM, Balaji enclave, Govindpuram, Ghaziabad, UP- 201002, have Changed my name to PRERNA SAXENA for all future purposes. 0071067942-1

I,**JAGRAT** PRATAP SINGH TYAGI,S/O-KOMAL PRAKASH TYAGI,R/o.C-912,G C CENTRUM,AHINSA KHAND-2,INDIRAPURAM,GHAZIABAD,UTTAR PRADESH -201014, have changed name to JAGRAT TYAGI. 0040885525-8

I, Gunjan W/o Amit Arora R/o-G1501, Prateek Wisteria, Sec-77, Noida have changed my name to Gunjan Arora for all purposes. 0071067898-1

I, Manpreet S/o Sunit Kumar, holder of Indian Passport no. X8011425 and valid until 02/04/2033, r/o H no. 16, Vill Namhera 95, Ambala, pin 134203, Haryana, India have changed my name Manpreet and surname Manpreet. 0040885449-1

I,**Toukir** Ahmed,S/o Nazir Ahmad, R/o- B-265,Gali No.-16, Madanpur Khadar, New Delhi-110076,have changed my name to Tokeer Ahmad, for all purpose 0040885525-1

I Parveen Sikri S/o Shiv Dayal Sikri residence of 17/83, Geeta colony, Delhi-110031 have changed my name to Parveen Kumar Sikri for all future purpose 0040885474-1

I Ashish Mittal S/o Yogesh Chandra Mittal, R/o Flat no.1172, Tower-16, River Heights, VTC: Raj Nagar Extension, PO: Raj Nagar Extension, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201017 have changed the name of my minor son from Ansh Mittal alias Shreya Mittal to Vedang Mittal for all purposes. 0040885395-1

I,**V** MUKUNDA SARMA,S/o-V S RAMACHANDRA MURTHY,R/o-Flat No.1003,Tower.1,Godrej Woods Apartments,Sector-43,Noida,Gautam Budh Nagar,Uttar Pradesh-201303, have changed my name to MUKUNDA SARMA VISHNUBHATLA,permanently. 0040885513-6

I, PRERNA KAUL , W/O VIKRAM KAUL R/O HOUSE NO 716 ,SECTOR 17 NEAR MODERN SCHOOL OLD FARIDABAD HARYANA 121002 have changed my name PRERNA KALIA for all future purposese 0071067904-1

I, Harbans Lal S/o Lt. Shri Chiman Lal, R/o E-58, Street No.8, Old Post Office Street, South Anarkali, Delhi-110051, have changed my name from Harbans Lal to Harbans Lal Narang for all future purposes. 0040885466-1

I MULLA SADAF ZEHRA MOHAMMAD AMIN ALI W/o Tabish Ahmad R/o B-3, Nihad Paza, Dodhpur Road, Civil Lines, Koil, Aligarh, Uttar Pradesh - 202001 have changed my name to SADAF ZEHRA for all purposes. 0130070712-1

I,**shakeela** khatoon,W/O-Md Mumtaz Alam,R/O-house no.f-16,khasra no 133,ground-floor near amina masjid, village wazirabad,delhi 110084,solomny affirm and declare that,Shakeela khatoon and shkila Bano are same and one person. 0040885530-2

I, MOHAMMAD NASIR UDDIN / MD NASIR UDDIN , S/O KABIR UDDIN R/O MAIN ROAD NEAR POST OFFICE HISUA NAWADA BIHAR 805103 have changed my name NASIR UDDIN for all future purposese 0071067900-1

I Anuradha W/o Late Sh. Vijay Sharma R/o H.No.18, Upper Ground Floor, Sanjay Nagar, Near NKS Hospital, Gulabi Bagh, PO: Malka Ganj, North Delhi, Delhi-110007 have changed my name to Anuradha Gaur for all purposes. 0040885395-3

I Mohd Israr S/O, Mohd Islam R/O 1804/5 Opposite Phatak Teliyan Near Haj Manzil Turkman Gate Delhi 110006 have changed my name to Mohammad Israr. 0040885456-1

I Shweta Mehta W/o Sumit Mehta R/o B-80, Front Ground Floor, Inderpuri Delhi-12 have changed my name to Shweta Kohli 0040885525-7

It is for general information that I,KAMLESH SHARDA,S/O-MAHADEV SHARDA,R/o-589,Janta Quarter Pocket-3,Paschim Puri,Paschim vihar Delhi,West Delhi-110063,do hereby Solemnly affirm,and state that in my 10th-Certificate,Roll No 29875 issued on Dated-28 July 1978,By RBSE,my name & my father name wrongly recorded as KAMLESH KUMAR,S/o-MAHADEV MAL,Whereas my Correct and Actual name is KAMLESH SHARDA,S/o-MAHADEV SHARDA in future,I should be known and address as KAMLESH SHARDA,S/o-MAHADEV SHARDA for All Purpose,Both name belong to one and the Same Person respectively.which May be amended accordingly 0040885513-8

I, AKRAM MOHAMMED S/O IKRAM AHMED R/O HOUSE NO 159 SURAJ APARTMENT, DDA MIG POST OFFICE BADARPUR PUL PRAHLAD PUR, SOUTH EAST DELHI - 110044 have changed my name MOHAMMED AKRAM for all future purpose 0071067907-1

I, Prince S/o Shamsher Singh, holder of Indian Passport no. Y8462793 and valid until 11/09/2033, r/o 121 Ambli, Ambala, Pin 134203, Haryana, India have changed my name Prince and surname Prince. 0040885451-1

I, Jagriti Mongia w/o Harshit Arora, resident of H-31 Sai Apartment Sector-13 Rohini, Delhi-110085 hereby declare that I have changed my name from Jagriti Mongia to Jagriti Arora. Henceforth, I shall be known as Jagriti Arora for all purposes and in all records & documents. 0040885295-2

I,**AKSHAY** MUTREJA,S/o-MAHENDER MUTREJA,R/o-H.NO.-53,BLOCK B-J,WEST SHALIMAR BAGH, DELHI - 110088 have changed my name to AKSHAYA MUTREJA 0040885525-3

I,**VINESH** GOEL,S/O-AMAR NATH GOEL,R/o.A-303,EXOTICA EAST SQUARE,AHINSA KHAND-2,INDIRAPURAM,GHAZIABAD,UTTAR PRADESH -201014,have changed name to VINESHWAR NATH GOEL. 0040885513-1

I,**Amit** Kumar Agrawal, S/o-Ayodhya Prasad Agrawal, r/o-Flat No-561, Sachin Nag Block Asian Game Village, Sahpurjat, Delhi-49, do hereby solemnly affirm and declare that my name has been wrongly recorded as Amit Kr Agrawal in Class 10th Marks Statement Cum Certificate and Aadhar Card of my minor daughter, Palak Agrawal, aged 17yrs, that the actual name of mine is Amit Kumar Agrawal which may be amended accordingly. 0040885409-2

I, Mohd Sakil, S/o Mohammed Haneef, R/o 2260, Gali Dakotan, Turkman Gate, Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Shakeel Ahmed, for all purposes. 0040885487-1

I,**Arun** Kumar,S/o-Jai Dayal Pahuja,R/o-H.No.-895,Sector-14,Gurugram (Haryana)-122001,have changed my name to Arun Pahuja for all purposes. 0040885525-5

I,**Pankaj** Ranga,S/o-Sita Ram,R/o-HN-16, Goyla-Khurd Village,South-West Delhi,Delhi -110071,have changed the name of my minor son namely Kushagra aged-17-years and he shall hereafter be known as KUSHAGRA CHAUDHARY. 0040885540-1

I, Megha Mahajan W/o Sandeep Arora R/o-2172, Valencia Tower, Mahagun Moderne, Sec-78, Noida have changed my name to Megha Arora. 0071067912-1

I,**RADHEY** SHYAM,Address-ASHIANA MULBERRY,T-2 908,SOHNA ROAD,K.R MANGALAM UNIVERSITY,SEC-2,SOHNA,GURGAON, HARYANA-122103,have changed my minor child name RADHYA to RADHYA RAJPUT. 0040885529-2

I, Sikander Mansuri S/o Late Ali Mohd., Resident of A-42, Hari Enclave, Part-I, Kirari Suleman Nagar, North West District, Delhi-110086, have changed my name and I shall be known as Sikandar Mansuri for all purposes in future. 0071067882-1

I,**MOHD** SHAHZAIB MALIK,S/O-ABDUL WAHID,R/O-H.NO.-1,NEHAR BAZAR,NEAR SETH BHAGWAN DASS SCHOOL,MAUJPUR,DELHI-110053,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM,MOHD SHAHZAIB MALIK TO,SHAHZAIB MALIK FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040885513-3

I, Pinky D/o Kesar Singh R/o K-76G, Sheikh Sarai Phase-2, Malviya Nagar, Delhi -110017, have changed my name to Simran Kaur for all future purposes. 0040885404-1

I, RAM PRASAD S/O BABU LAL R/O D-223 T-Huts GP Block Pitam Pura North West Delhi, Delhi-110088 have changed my name to ROHAN PRASAD vide affidavit dated 05-10-2026 at Delhi. 0050300234-1

I, Rajesh Kishanlal Sharma S/o Kishan Lal Sharma R/o H.N-301, Nakshtra sankul, Jathar peth, Akola, Maharashtra 444001 have changed my name to Rajesh Sharma for all future purposes 0071067938-1

I, Shobh Neet Bhargava S/o Jitendra Nath Bhargave R/o B-6/1002, Tulip Purple, Near Tulip Chowk, Sector-69, Gurgaon, Haryana, have changed my name to Shobhneet Bhargava permanently. 0040885402-1

I,**hitherto** known as,AALOK,S/O-RAM KUMAR YADAV,Residing at R-5/14A,Block-R5,Mohan Garden,Uttam Nagar,District West Delhi,Delhi-110059,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as ALOK YADAV. 0040885513-5

I, Kiran, W/o Naveen Kothiyal, R/o-RZG-286, Gali No-6, Raj Nagar-2, Palam Colony, Delhi, have changed my name to Kiran Khantwal 0040885403-1

I, SUBHASH CHAND , S/O SHRI MUNNI LAL CHAUHAN R/O AF 169 ANSAL GOLFLINK 2 UPSIDC HOUSING SITE C SURAJPUR GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH 201306 have changed my name SUBHASH CHAND CHAUHAN for all future purposes 0071067911-1

I,**BRIJMOHAN,** S/o-Kailash Chand, R/o: WZ-988 F/66, Gali No-16B, Sadh Nagar, Palam Colony, New Delhi-110045, Have Changed My Name to BRIJMOHAN VASHIST 0071067945-1

I,**KM** SHAHNAJ KHATOON,D/O-LIYAKAT ALI,R/O-E60,SHAHEEN BAGH ABUL FAZAL ENCLAVE,PART-2, OKHLA,NEW DELHI-110025,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO,SHEHNAZ JAHAN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPUSE 0040885530-1

I, Mohan Shyam Rawat S/o Roop Kishor R/o-S30, Sunder Block, Shakarpur, Delhi have changed my name to Mohan Shyam. 0071067899-1

LOST & FOUND

I Pavitra kanta jain r/o E-2224 4 floor haryan gurugram 122017 have lost all original property documents pertaining to shop no 34 khursheed market sadar bazar delhi. If found contact 9310328262 0040885291-3

I,**Surat** Singh Sangha, S/o-Gurpal Singh, R/o-Shire Farm, Flawforth Lane, Ruddington, Nottingham NG11 6NG, England, United Kingdom, Indian OCI Card No-A2764934 do hereby declare that I am the owner and in actual possession of Flat No-1403, 1404, 1417 &-1418 Hemkunt Chambers, 89-Nehru Place, New Delhi-19. That the Flat Builder Buyer Agreement and Maintenance Agreement regarding the said flat issued from the Builder M/s.Skipper Sales Private Limited, has actually been lost and not traceable till date. Finder call-9582917977 0040885409-3

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

General public is hereby informed that my client **Mrs. Shivanee** W/o Mr. Aasam Alam R/o 39, Prashadi Mohalla, Village Usmanpur, Garki Mendu, North-East, Distt, Delhi-110053, Also at- H.No.55, 3&4, 4th Floor, Street No.5, BLK-A, Sangam Vihar, Village Baroda Majra, Distt-North, Delhi-110084, has severed all of their relations and social connections with their son **Mr. Aiman Aalam** S/o Mr. Aasam Alam R/o H.No.55, Kh.No.3&4, 4th Floor, Street No.5, BLK-A, Sangam Vihar, Village Baroda Majra, Distt-North, Delhi-110084, as they have proven to be most disobedient, disrespectful, and harmful towards my client, and my client has hereby disowned and debarred them from inheriting any of his movable and immovable properties. Anybody dealing with them shall be doing so at his/her own cost and peril and for which my client and their family members shall not be held liable or responsible.

Sd/-
FARHAN AHMED
Advocate
Ch. No. 229, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-54

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to the public at large that our client **Sh. Suresh Kumar** and **Smt Kusum** Late Resident of House no CN 311/3, Radha Vihar, Saboli, Near Shiv Mandir, Nand Nagri, Delhi 110093 have disowned and debarred their son, **Mr Vishav Insha** S/o Sh. Suresh Kumar respect to all movable and immovable properties of our client with immediate effect.
Our client shall not be responsible for any acts, omissions, debts or liabilities of **Mr Vishav Insha** from the date of this notice. Any person dealing with him in any manner does so entirely at his own risk and consequences, and our clients shall not be liable.

Sd/-
NITIN KUMAR
Advocate
ENROL NO. D/496/2012
OFF:- R. LAWYERS CHAMBER, DELHI HIGH COURT, NEW DELHI 110003

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public: all banks and NBFCs are hereby cautioned that some impersonator while impersonating my client on the basis of forged title documents fraudulently trying to enter into an agreement to sell or applying for bank loan qua my client's immovable Property Plot No.26, Pocket-A, Sector-26, Rohini, Delhi-110085 ad measuring 300 Sq.Mtr. The matter to this has been reported to the concerned police station.
Through this Cautionary Notice General Public, Banks and NBFCs are informed to act with due diligence and not to enter into with any transaction qua the above-mentioned immovable property.
SUMIT ARORA (Advocate)
On behalf of Smt. Kusum Chawla
W/o Sh. P.K. Chawla

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that my client **FIROZ KHAN** S/o **MOHD. SHAFI KHAN**, **A-493, 30 Feet Road, Kabir Nagar, Gokalpur, Delhi-110094** have declared his wife with eldest son **FIROOQUE MALIK** and his wife **Mst. NIRA** and **FARHANA @ FAZIYA** my client has disowned them from his personal life as well as from all his movable and immovable properties with immediate effect and my client shall not be responsible for their act, misconduct and deed. If anyone deals with them, will do so at their own risk, cost and consequences, my client has disowned daughter **FIROOQUE MALIK** and his wife **NIRA** and their children **FARHAN** & **FAZIYA** from his life due to their aggressive, arrogant and cruel behavior, bad habits and disobedience of my client and his family.
Mohd. Shahid (Advocate), CMR/952/2002,
171, Lawyer's Chamber, Block-II, Delhi High Court, Delhi-110058

PUBLIC NOTICE

Under the instructions of my clients, Sh. **Lalit Mahajan**, S/o Late Sh. Jagdish Mitra Mahajan, R/o Prabhu Kripa, Farm No.32, Gadaipur, Mandi Road, Jonapur, Mehrauli, South Delhi, Delhi-110030, Co-owner of 1/3rd **undivided share**, and **Sh. Sanjay Mahajan**, S/o Late Sh. Kewal Mitra Mahajan, **Smt. Preeti Mahajan**, W/o Late Sh. Vipin Mahajan, and **Smt. Neerja Thapa**, D/o Late Sh. Kewal Mitra Mahajan, collectively Co-owner of 1/3rd **undivided share**, being the co-owners in respect of the **property bearing Nos.53, 54, 55 and 56, Double Storey, New Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi-110060**, it is hereby informed to the general public that the original Lease Deed and other title documents of the aforesaid properties have been lost and remain untraceable despite due search and sincere efforts. A Lost Report regarding the loss of the aforesaid original documents has been lodged vide LR No.744328/2026 dated 21.10.2026. Any person having any claim, objection or interest in respect of the aforesaid property, or who has found or is in possession of the said original title documents, is requested to inform the undersigned or my clients within **15 (Fifteen) days** from the date of publication of this notice, failing which it shall be presumed that no person has any claim or objection, and my client shall be at liberty to obtain Certified title documents and take all consequential steps in accordance with law.
Shashi Ranjan (Advocate)
Ch.No.609, Patiala House Court, Delhi-01.

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Sh.Deepak Singh S/o Late Yadunath Singh and Rita Devi R/o A-51,Nathupura,Near Pili Kothi Burari Delhi-110084 Hereby debarred and disown his Son Ankit Singh and his wife & also Yonger Son Akshay Singh from all movable and immovable properties and severe all relations from them absolutely and forever because their acts,deeds & things are adverse and prejudice to rights,Interest and natural feelings and sentiments of us. Anyone dealing with them would be responsible and liable for the same and we shall not be responsible or liable for the same.
TUSHAR SHARMA Advocate,
Off. B-1/163, Sh No.4, Basti Nagar Burari Delhi 110084 Ph. 9999092027

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my client SMT. RANJANA KOCHAR W/O SHRI PARKASH KOCHAR R/o S-98, SUNDER BLOCK, SHAKARPUR, DELHI-110092, has disowned her son namely "MUKUL KOCHAR" Aged about 28 Yrs., from her moveable and immovable properties due to his misbehavior, ill-treatment, disrespectfulness, disobedience and ill-temper and my client has severed all her relation with him and she shall not be responsible for any of his act and deed. Any person dealing with him will be responsible for his/her own risk and consequences.
Amar Singh (Advocate)
Enrolment. No. D/3500/2010.
Chamber: G-6, G-7 & F-9,
Pankaj Central Market, I.P. Extension, Patparganj, Delhi110092.
Mobile No.9313500952.

Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page
The Indian EXPRESS JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd., VS, VIJAYAWADA - 520004
(A Govt. of A.P. Undertaking)

NOTIFICATION for APGENCO e-Procurement Tender ID.No. 10050076

APGENCO invites open tenders for "Supply of 3 Phase, 415 V. 50 Hz AC & 220 V DC Various LT electrical motors of different KW rating required for Stage-1, Dr.MVR RTPP" through AP e-procurement. EVC Rs. 1,42,10,099/-
Schedule available Date & Time: 29.10.2026 - 14.00 Hrs onwards
Bid submission Closing Date & Time: 06.11.2026 - 12.00 Hrs
For other details visit the website: **https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in**
R.No.- 5526PP/CL/ADVT/1/1//2021-22 Dt: 26.10.2026

JAIPUR SMART CITY LIMITED
(Municipal Corporation Jaipur, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyay Bhawan,)
Lal Kothi, Tonk Road, Jaipur, CIN No.U75140RJ2016SGC049890

S. No. :- JSCL/SE/2026-27/3877 **Dated :- 26/10/2026**

निविदा संख्या 02/2026-27 जयपुर स्मार्ट सिटी लिमिटेड, जयपुर

केन्द्र एवं राज्य सरकार के सभी विभागों में सक्षम एजेंसियों / संवेदकों से मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी, जयपुर स्मार्ट सिटी लिमिटेड, जयपुर से संबंधित विकास कार्य हेतु निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। कार्य की अनुमानित लागत, निविदा डाउनलोड तथा ई-अपलोड करने की तारीख, निविदा शर्तें आदि संपूर्ण विवरण दिनांक 27.10.2026 से राजस्थान सरकार के पोर्टल **sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in/nicgep/app & jscljaipur.in** पर देखी व डाउनलोड की जा सकती है। स्टेट पब्लिक प्रोक्योरमेंट पोर्टल का यूनिक बिड नंबर **JSC2627GLOB00004, JSC2627GLOB00005** है।

हस्ता./-
अधीक्षण अभियंता
दस.संसद/सी/26/12461

ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL, DHAULA KUAN
RIDGE ROAD DHAULA KUAN-110010

CORRIGENDUM

With reference to the Tender Notice published on 07 Oct 2026. Sealed tenders are invited from leading firms with professional expertise for providing School Canteen Services to Army Public School, Dhaula Kuan. Firms with past experience in providing required services and having Registration No, EPF Code, ESI Code, GST Code etc may contact school office between 9:00 a.m to 15:00 p.m. on any working day for collection of tender forms costing Rs 500/- between 07 Oct 2026 to 05 Nov 2026. Last date for submission of tender form is on 10 Nov 2026 by 1100 hrs. For any queries contact School Reception No 011-25693040 & 011-25693131 please.
Principal, APS, Dhaula Kuan

भिवाड़ी इंटिग्रेटेड विकास प्राधिकरण
एच-5, ब्यावर्धिक कॉलोनी, भिवाड़ी, अलवर, दूरभाष :- 01493-230819
ई-मेल :- bida.bhiwadi@rajasthan.gov.in

क्रमांक :- बीड़ा/अभि./3358/26 दिनांक :- 15/10/2026

Notice Inviting Bid

Bid for " 02 Nos. Multipurpose Fire Tenders (10,000 L Water Tank + 1,000 L Foam Tank) and 02 Nos. Quick Response Vehicles (Water Mist Technology) fabricated on a Small Commercial Pickup Chassis with Minimum 1-Tonne Payload Capacity", is invited from interested Bidders up to 04.00 PM on 04.11.2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** & **http://sppp.raj.nic.in** of the state; and **https://bida.rajasthan.gov.in** departmental website. **UBN : BDA2627WSOB00067**
Raj.Samwad/C/26/12426 **प्रभारी अधिकारी (स्टोर), बीड़ा, भिवाड़ी**

कार्यालय सहायक आयुक्त (प्रथम) देवस्थान विभाग, जयपुर
क्रमांक लेखा/खुली बोली/2026-27/7193 दिनांक - 26/10/2026

Corrigendum

इस कार्यालय के नियन्त्रणाधीन विभागीय मंदिरों में फ्लावर सप्लाई एवं डेकोरेशन कार्य हेतु ई-खुली सूचना क्रमांक लेखा/खुली बोली/2026-27/7115 दिनांक 21.10.2026 से जारी की गई थी। ई-निविदा में बिड आवेदन प्रस्तुत करने की अंतिम तिथि व तकनीकी बोली खोलने की तिथि तथा निविदा बोली की सामान्य शर्त के बिन्दु संख्या 5 (iii) में संशोधन किया गया है, जिसका विवरण https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in व https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पोर्टल पर देखा जा सकता है। निविदा की शेष शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी।

हस्ता./-
सहायक आयुक्त (प्रथम)
देवस्थान विभाग, जयपुर
DIPR/C/17993/2026

Dakshin Gujarat Vij Company Limited
CIN U40102GJ2003SGC042909
Regd. & Corp. Office : 'Urja Sadan',
N. V. Road, Kapodara Char Rasta, Surat 395 006 GUJARAT
DGVCL Toll Free No. 19123 (or 1800 233 3003)

Tender Notice

Tender details are put up on www.dgvcl.com (for view & download tender documents) and https://tender.nprocure.com (for view, download and online tender submission).

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Estimated Cost (Crore)
1	DGVCL/ SP / 2701 / CPP / 27-28 /11 KV XLPE Cable	620.50
2	DGVCL/ SP / 2702 / CPP / 2027-28 / 11 KV MVCC	440.04
3	DGVCL/ SP / 2703 / CPP / 2027-28 / 11 KV MVCC Accessories	85.77
4	DGVCL/ SP / 2705 / CPP / EHV Grade Transformer Oil	82.91

Note: Bidders may visit the above website/s for regular updates till opening of the tender. **ACE (P), DGVCL, Surat.**

ADVERTISEMENT OF TENDERING FOR REGIMENTAL SHOPS OF AIR FORCE STATION NEW DELHI

1. Air Officer Commanding, Air Force Station, New Delhi-110003 invites sealed tenders from **War Widows / Widows of Defence personnel killed while on duty, Disabled soldier/Ex-servicemen and Spouses / widow of Ex-serviceman etc.** operating the following shops located at places mentioned against each shop:-

Shops at (Tejas Camp), Air Force Station New Delhi-03.		
Sl No.	Shop Name	*MRP (in ₹)
1	Tailor Shop	2000
Shops at Air Force Station Naraina, Brar Square, Naraina, New Delhi-10		
2	Gift Shop	300

2. Air Officer Commanding, Air Force Station, New Delhi-110003 invites sealed tenders from War Widows / Widows of Defence personnel killed while on duty, Disabled soldier/Ex-servicemen and Spouses / widow of Ex-serviceman **including Govt. agencies & civilians** for shops as per details mentioned against each shop:-

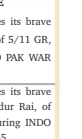
Shops at Air Force Station Naraina, Brar Square, Naraina, New Delhi-10.		
Sl No.	Shop Name	*MRP (in ₹)
3	Juice Corner	833
4	Vegetable Shop	300
5	Barber Shop	160
Shops at (Sekhon Vihar, Palam, Delhi Cantt-10)		
6	Cable TV	167

***Minimum Reserve Price**

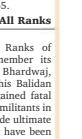
3. The amount quoted by tenderers should be equal to or more than the above stated Minimum Reserve Price.
4. **Details of tendering process is as follows: -**
(i) **Sale of Tender Forms** (along with T & C of Contract)
Start Date : **27 Oct 2026 (0830 hr)** Finish Date : **12 Nov 2026 (1030 hr)**
Forms will be available at **SI Office, Air Force Station New Delhi, Race Course, New Delhi-110003.**
(ii) **Cost of Tender Form: ₹ 1,000/-** to be paid in Cash/PoS Machine.
(iii) **Bid Security : ₹ 5,000/-** (in the form of DD/PoS Machine in the favour of OIC SI Funds, AFS New Delhi, payable at **Air Force Station, New Delhi,** to be submitted along with the Application and Tender Form at the time of submission).
(iv) **Last date of submission of Application and Tender Forms: 12 Nov 2026 (by 1030 hr)** (by Mail on address as per Para-4(i) above or depositing in the tender box available in Main Guard Room at the entry gate of Air Force Station, New Delhi-110003.
(v) **Opening of Tenders: 12 Nov 2026 (1130 hr)**
5. **Priority of allotment: -**
(i) War Widows of defence personnel killed while on duty
(ii) Disabled soldiers
(iii) Ex-Servicemen
(iv) Spouse/Widows of Ex-Servicemen.
(v) **Cat-II:** Govt Agencies, including public sector undertakings and civilian whose spouse or dependent family members do not own any shop in the Complex/Military Station/Cantonment.

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

11 GORKHA RIFLES REGIMENTAL CENTRE



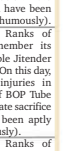
Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, IEC-5406X Late Capt Jagvir Singh, of 5/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during INDO PAK WAR (Operation Bison) on 27 Oct 1948.



Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No- 9404402 Late Rfn Uttar Bahadur Rai, of 5/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during INDO PAK WAR (Operation Bison) on 27 Oct 1965.

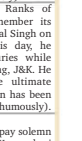
Colonel 11 GR & Sikkim Scouts and All Ranks

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



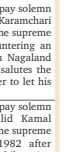
SH VIKAS BHARDWAJ, ASSISTANT COMMANDANT, PPMG 81 BN BSF 12.10.1973 – 27.10.2001

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Officer, Sh Vikas Bhardwaj, Assistant Commandant on his Baldian Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Handwara area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PPMG (Posthumously).



HEAD CONSTABLE JITENDER KUMAR, PMG 127 BN BSF 10.05.1971 – 27.10.2016

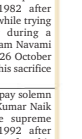
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Jitender Kumar on his Baldian Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in counter part firing in area of BOP Tube Well, Jammu and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PMG (Posthumously).



CONSTABLE IQBAL SINGH, PPMG 69 BN BSF 21.10.1966 – 27.10.1990

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Iqbal Singh on his Baldian Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Anantnag, J&K. He fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action has been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PPMG (Posthumously).

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani Constable/Safai Karamchari Bhoora 7 Bn 4-12-1935 To 27-10-1963

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable/Safai Karamchari Bhoora of 7 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while valiantly

Noida Power Company Limited

NPCL — NOIDA POWER COMPANY LIMITED

Electric Sub Station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida-201310
(CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506)

TENDER NOTICE

Date: 27-10-2026

E-Bid (Commercial & Technical) are invited for following job from all interested bidders:

NIT No.	Tender Description	EMD (Rs.)	Start and Due Date & Time of Submission
NPCL/FY26-27/RWH/34	Construction of Rain Water Harvesting System at Various Locations	0.50 Lac	27.10.2026 & 05.11.2026 (up to 15:00 hours)

Cost of Individual Tender Document (Incl. GST) Rs 1180/-
For other tender details and further amendment/corrigendum, please visit our website
www.noidapower.com-->Procurement-->Tenders

DGM (CMM)

कार्यालय अजमेर विकास प्राधिकरण, अजमेर

RPSC के सामने घूघरा घाटी जयपुर रोड अजमेर
Web Site - www.ada.rajasthan.gov.in | E-Mail - ajmerada@gmail.com Tel. No. - 0145-2627748, 2627749

ई–नीलामी में अमानत राशि जमा एवं बोली दिनांक 27.10.2026 से लगाई जा सकती है।
भूखण्डों की ई–नीलामी दिनांक 04.11.2026 से 04.02.2027

196 आवासीय, व्यावसायिक, फार्म हाउस एव रिसोर्ट भूखण्ड

- पूर्ण भुगतान के लिए 180 दिवस का समय
- 15 दिवस में पूर्ण राशि जमा कराने पर 2 प्रतिशत की छूट

31 दीन दयाल उपाध्याय पुरम आवासीय भूखण्ड	04 कोटडा आवासीय भूखण्ड	18 पृथ्वीराज नगर आवासीय भूखण्ड
04 अटल आवासीय योजना आवासीय एवं व्यावसायिक भूखण्ड (RERA REGN NO- RAJ/P/2025/3471)	14 बी के कॉल नगर आवासीय एवं व्यावसायिक भूखण्ड	03 हरिभाऊ उपाध्याय नगर विस्तार आवासीय भूखण्ड
02 इन्द्रा कॉम्प्लेक्स शॉप्स भूखण्ड	36 महाराणा प्रताप नगर आवासीय भूखण्ड	07 पंचशील नगर आवासीय भूखण्ड
12 चन्दनवरदाई नगर आवासीय भूखण्ड	02 ट्रांसपोर्ट नगर शॉप व शो रुम, रिपेयर शॉप एवं व्यावसायिक भूखण्ड	06 हरिभाऊ उपाध्याय नगर मुख्य आवासीय एवं व्यावसायिक भूखण्ड
20 विजयराजे सिंधिया नगर आवासीय एवं व्यावसायिक भूखण्ड (RERA REGN NO- RAJ/P/2017/373)	15 फार्म हाउस, ईकोलोजिकल हाउस एवं रिसोर्ट गोकला फेज–1 सूरज कुंड (RERA REGN NO- RAJ/P/2021/1690)	22 ब्रह्मा एक्सेव कानस दुधर रिसोर्ट एवं शॉप्स भूखण्ड (RERA REGN NO. RAJ/P/2025/4229)

RERA Web Site - www.rera.rajasthan.gov.in
भूखण्डों की अधिक जानकारी के लिए कॉल करें:– 9785545954/7976559227/8114469662/9166302778
ई–नीलामी की अधिक जानकारी के लिए कॉल करें:– 6378528215

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER & BASIN MANAGER, MAHANADI BASIN, BURLA-768017, DIST-SAMBALPUR (ODISHA)
E-mail Id- cebmumbburla@gmail.com

3201/1115/2627

Government of Odisha "e" Procurement Notice.
Bid Identification No-CE & BM-MB-13/2026-27 (Online)

Online tender is invited from prospective bidders for "Construction of Riverfront Development from Mandalia to Chaunrpur Bridge along the Mahanadi River (Phase-I) in Sambalpur District, Odisha on "EPC-Turnkey" basis including Power Connectivity system and Operation and Maintenance of complete commissioned project for five years

1	Name of Work	"Construction of Riverfront Development from Mandalia to Chaunrpur Bridge along the Mahanadi River (Phase-I) in Sambalpur District, Odisha on "EPC-Turnkey" basis including Power Connectivity system and Operation and Maintenance of complete commissioned project for five years"
2	Approximate Value of work put to Tender	**Rs. 133.05 Crore** (including O & M cost and excluding GST)
2	Period of completion	24 Calendar months including rainy season.
3	Date & time of availability of bid document in the portal	Dated-30.10.2026 from 11.30 A.M. to Dated-30.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.
4	Last date/Time for receipt of bids in the portal	Dated- 30.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.
5	Date and Time of Opening of Technical Bid	Dated-01.12.2026 at 11.30 A.M.
6	Name & address of the officer inviting Bid	Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Mahanadi Basin, Burla, At- Burla, District-Sambalpur, Odisha, Pin-768017, Odisha

Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal "https://tendersodisha.gov.in"

Sd/-
Chief Engineer & Basin Manager,
Mahanadi Basin, Burla

OIPR-32001/32508/1/26-27/0013

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER & BASIN MANAGER BAITARANI BASIN, KENDUJHAR

3200/1133/2627

E-mail: cebmbaitaranibasin16@gmail.com
e-PROCUREMENT NOTICE No. CEBBK-05/2026-27

The Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Baitarani Basin, Kendujhar, on behalf of the Hon'ble Governor of Odisha, invites online Percentage Rate bids in double cover system through e-Procurement from eligible contractors registered with the State Government and contractors of equivalent Grade/Class registered with Central Government/MES/Railways or other licensing authority.

1. **Type of Work** : Civil Work
2. **Total No. of Works** : 01 (One)
3. **Amount put to Tender (Excluding GST)** : 1. Rs. 8,27,17,751/-
4. **Period of Completion** : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months
5. **Class of Contractor** : 'A' & 'Special' Class

PROCUREMENT DETAILS

Sl. No.	Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Name of Work	Bid Amount	Availability & Submission of Bid On-line	Date & Place of Opening of Technical Bids
01	Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Baitarani Basin, Kendujhar.	CEBBK-SCD 06/2026-27	Improvement to Sabaranga Minor from RD- 0.00 Km to 6.00 Km of Salandi Irrigation Project.	Rs. 8,27,17,751/- EMD- Rs. 8,27,178/- Bid Doc.: Rs. 10,000/-	From 11:00 Hrs. of 23.10.2026 to 09.11.2026, 17:00 Hrs.	10.11.2026 at 11:30 Hrs. at the office of the Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Baitarani Basin, Kendujhar.

Bidders shall participate online bidding only. Further details can be seen from the Govt. of Odisha e-Procurement Website **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**. Any addendum/ corrigendum/ cancellation of the tender can be seen in the above website only.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer & Basin Manager
Baitarani Basin, Kendujhar

OIPR-32001/32495/1/26-27/0006

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE No. 53/2026-2027 Dated: 26/10/2026

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi - 110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items :-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	09272189	BRAKE WEAR PLATE	58151 NOS	16-11-26
02	09262418	SIDE FRAME FRICTION LINER (IN SET) FOR CAST STEEL BOGIE OF BLC WAGON	6499 NOS	23-11-26
03	09272463	BRAKE BEAM FOR CAST STEEL BOGIE	1693 NOS	25-11-26
04	09272181	BRAKE BEAM	1930 NOS	07-12-26

Note :
1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained. 3721/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Vikas**, **S/o** Sh. Pradeep **R/o:** Flat No. C-59 Khasra No. 102, Sushant Vihar, Ibrahimpur, North-West Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 83/2018, U/s: 379/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Vikas** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Vikas** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Vikas, FIR No.: 83/2018, U/s: 379/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
Court No.138, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/15203/N/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. JHS/Commercial/e-Auction/26/94-95 Date: 26.10.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President Of India, The Divisional Railway Manager, (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: Advertisement | **Catalogue No. :** JHS-NFR-MISC-94

Asset Details: E-AUCTION FOR CONTRACT UNDER

1. Operate and maintain of battery-operated vehicles (BOV) with advertisement at BANDA, MAHOBA & CHITRAKOOT DHAM KARWI railway station
2. E-auction is invited for a POOJA SAMAGRI KIOSK at DATIA Railway station.
3. Contract for implementation of waste management (collection of recyclables) at nominated railway station i.e vgjj, orai, mba, cktd, mcsc, lar, mra and its circulating area, railway colony areas & coaching depot
4. Provision for installation of Drinks Vending Machines in the circulating area of GWALIOR railway station under miscellaneous static policy.

Auction Start: 12.11.2026 at 11:00 hrs. **Auction End:** 12.11.2026 at 12:20 hrs.
Category: Advertisement **Catalogue No. :** JHS-NFR-ADV-95

Asset Details: E-AUCTION FOR CONTRACT UNDER

1. Advertisement right through RDN NON - DIGITAL media (flex board/glowsign board/ tran slight /led flange static advertisement)) inside HPP-KLAR-BTX railway station.
2. Display of commercial publicity at circulating area of CHITRAKUTDHAM KARWI Railway Station under OOH policy

Auction Start: 12.11.2026 at 12:30 hrs. **Auction End:** 12.11.2026 at 13:10 hrs.

Note: Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (**www.ireps.gov.in**). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **2429/26(K)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPROWCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Neeraj @Rohit** S/o Raghubir R/o C-110, J.J. Colony, Bawana, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 180/2021 U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Neeraj @Rohit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Neeraj @Rohit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Neeraj @Rohit** in **FIR No. 180/2021 U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.12.2026**.

By order
Ms. Bharti Baniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
North, Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15335/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Rishab Sharma S/o** Murari Lal **R/o** Vill. Choda Raghunathpur, near Sanjay Jewellers, PS Sector-22, Naida, UP, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 31/2023 U/s 283 IPC**., has been registered at **PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Rishab Sharma** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Rishab Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Rishab Sharma** of under **FIR No. 31/2023 U/s 283 IPC** Registred at: **PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Ld, JMFC, Room No. 138
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/15375/N/2026
(Court Notice)

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER MINOR IRRIGATION DIVISION, HUSSAINABAD
(eemidhus-cemr-jhr@nic.in)

LOCAL/NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING
(CIVIL WORKS)
e-Tender Reference no:-WRD/MID/HUSSAINABAD/ S.B.D./01/2026-27

Letter No:- 553 Date:-24/10/2026

1	Name of work	:	Renovation of Sukhnadia M. I. Scheme, Vill.- Sarma, Block:- Chhatarpur, Dist.-Palamu
2	Estimated cost (In Rs)	:	₹ 4,88,97,500=00
3	Time of completion	:	360 Days
4	Date of publication of tender on website (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)	:	10.11.2026
5	Period of ownloading/uploading of bid document on website (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)	:	From 10.11.2026 To 26.11.2026
6	Last Date and time for receipt of bid	:	Date -26.11.2026 Time - 3.00 PM
7	Time and date of opening Technical Bids	:	Date - 28.11.2026 Time - 4.00 PM
8	Time and date of opening Financial Bids	:	To be announced
9	Name & address of office inviting tender	:	Executive Engineer, Minor irrigation Division, Hussainabad
10	Contact no of e-procurement officer	:	9608234736, 9430385850
11	Helpline no of e-procurement cell	:	0651-2214784

Note: Detailed e-Tender notice and corrigendum, if any, will be available at https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in.
Estmated Cost may decrease or increase.

Executive engineer
Minor Irrigation Division Hussainabad.

PR.NO.392427 District(26-27):D

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

CHANGE IN TIMINGS & EXTENSION OF TRAINS

This is to inform all concerned that due to operational reasons, Railways have decided to change the timings/Extend the services of few trains. The details are given below:-

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12381 HOWRAH-NEW DELHI POORVA EXPRESS WITH EXTENSION UPTO SHAKUR BASTI

Train No. 12381 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
New Delhi	06:05	---	06:20	06:45
Shakur Basti	---	---	07:20	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12382 NEW DELHI-HOWRAH POORVA EXPRESS WITH EXTENSION UPTO SHAKUR BASTI

Train No. 12382 (w.e.f. 30.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Shakur Basti	---	---	---	16:35
New Delhi	---	17:40	17:15	17:40

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12303 HOWRAH-NEW DELHI POORVA EXPRESS WITH EXTENSION UPTO SHAKUR BASTI

Train No. 12303 (w.e.f. 30.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
New Delhi	06:05	---	06:20	06:45
Shakur Basti	---	---	07:20	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12304 NEW DELHI-HOWRAH POORVA EXPRESS WITH EXTENSION UPTO SHAKUR BASTI

Train No. 12304 (w.e.f. 29.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Shakur Basti	---	---	---	16:35
New Delhi	---	17:40	17:15	17:40

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 54085 DELHI JN.-SATROD PASSENGER

Train No. 54085 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Delhi Jn.	---	07:10	---	06:35
Delhi Sarai Rohilla	07:25	07:26	06:50	06:51
Patel Nagar	07:34	07:35	06:58	06:59
Delhi Cantt.	07:47	07:48	07:11	07:12
Palam	07:54	07:55	07:18	07:19
Shahabad Mohammad Pur	08:00	08:01	07:24	07:25
Bijwasan	08:06	08:07	07:30	07:31
Gurgaon	08:15	08:16	07:38	07:39
Basai Dhankot	08:22	08:23	07:44	07:45
Garhi Harsaru	08:28	08:29	07:50	07:51
Patli	08:37	08:38	07:57	07:58
Taj Nagar	08:43	08:44	08:03	08:04
Jataula Jauri Sampka	08:48	08:49	08:08	08:09
Pataudi Road	08:55	08:56	08:14	08:15
Inchhapuri	09:02	09:03	08:20	08:21
Khalilpur	09:10	09:11	08:27	08:28
Kumbhawas Mundalia Dabri	09:17	09:18	08:34	08:35
Rewari Jn.	09:40	10:10	09:25	10:20

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 64437 GHAZIABAD-DELHI JN. EMU

Train No. 64437 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Ghaziabad	---	06:10	---	05:45
Sahibabad	06:19	06:20	05:54	05:55
Chander Nagar Halt	06:24	06:25	06:02	06:03
Anand Vihar Halt	06:27	06:28	06:05	06:06
Tilak Bridge	06:33	06:34	06:15	06:16
Shivaji Bridge	06:37	06:38	06:19	06:20
New Delhi	06:53	06:55	06:33	06:35
Sadar Bazar	07:02	07:03	06:44	06:45
Delhi Jn.	07:50	---	07:35	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 22437 PRAYAGRAJ JN.-ANAND VIHAR(T.) HUMSAFAR EXP.

Train No. 22437 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Anand Vihar(T.)	06:10	---	06:25	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 15565 LALITGRAM-NEW DELHI VAISHALI EXP. (DAILY)

Train No. 15565 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Ghaziabad	05:43	05:45	05:58	06:00
New Delhi	06:30	---	06:45	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12281 BHUBANESWAR-NEW DELHI DURANTO EXPRESS

Train No. 12281 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
New Delhi	06:40	---	06:55	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 15734 BATHINDA JN.-BALURGHAT FARRAKA EXPRESS

Train No. 15734 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Bathinda Jn.	---	15:00	---	15:00
No Change Between Bathinda Jn.-Delhi Jn.				
Delhi Jn.	21:25	21:40	21:30	21:45
Ghaziabad	22:25	22:27	22:27	22:29
Khurja	23:10	23:12	23:23	23:25

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12427 REWA-ANAND VIHAR(T.) REWA EXPRESS

Train No. 12427 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Ghaziabad	06:03	06:05	06:18	06:20
Anand Vihar(T.)	06:40	---	06:55	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12417 PRAYAGRAJ JN.-NEW DELHI PRAYAGRAJ EXPRESS

Train No. 12417 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Ghaziabad	06:13	06:15	06:28	06:30
New Delhi	07:00	---	07:15	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12225 AZAMGARH-DELHI JN. KAIFIYAT EXPRESS

Train No. 12225 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Ghaziabad	06:23	06:25	06:38	06:40
Delhi Jn.	07:05	---	07:25	---

Note: Due to change in nature of trains from Superfast to Mail/Express, Train Number of 12226 will be change to 14026 w.e.f. 01.01.2027 Ex. Delhi Jn. & 12225 will be changed to 14025 w.e.f. 01.01.2027 Ex. Azamgarh.

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12367 BHAGALPUR JN.- ANAND VIHAR(T.) VIKRAMSHILA EX.

Train No. 12367 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Anand Vihar (T.).	07:20	---	07:35	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12556 BATHINDA JN.-GORAKHPUR GORAKHDHAM EXP.

Train No. 12556 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Kanpur Central	02:55	03:05	03:00	03:10

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 20802 NEW DELHI-ISLAMPUR MAGADH EXPRESS

Train No. 20802 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
New Delhi	---	21:05	---	21:05
No Change Between Aligarh Jn.-Kanpur Central				
Prayagraj Jn.	06:20	06:25	06:15	06:20

No Change between Vindhyachal-PT. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn.

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12309 RAJENDRA NAGAR TERMINAL-NEW DELHI TEJAS RAJDHANI EXPRESS

Train No. 12309 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
New Delhi	07:40	---	07:55	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12393 RAJENDRA NAGAR TERMINAL-NEW DELHI SAMPOORNA KRANTI EXPRESS

Train No. 12393 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
New Delhi	07:55	---	08:05	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12229 LUCKNOW-NEW DELHI LUCKNOW MAIL

Train No. 12229 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Ghaziabad	05:53	05:55	06:01	06:03
New Delhi	06:55	---	07:00	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 14218 CHANDIGARH-PRAYAGRAJ SANGAM UNCHAHAR EXP.

Train No. 14218 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Chandigarh	---	16:45	---	16:45
No Change Between Chandigarh-Delhi Jn.				
Delhi Jn.	21:05	21:20	21:15	21:30
Sahibabad	21:42	21:44	21:56	21:58
Ghaziabad	22:11	22:13	22:16	22:18
Aligarh Jn.	23:30	23:35	23:40	23:45
Hathras Jn.	23:57	23:59	00:07	00:09
Tundla Jn.	01:10	01:15	01:15	01:20
Firozabad	01:40	01:42	01:40	01:42
No Change between Shikohabad Jn.-Rura				
Kanpur Central	05:30	05:35	05:35	05:40
Unnao	06:06	06:08	06:12	06:14
Bighapur	06:37	06:39	06:40	06:42
Takia	06:51	06:52	06:51	06:53
NO CHANGE BEYOND TAKIA				

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 12418 NEW DELHI-PRAYAGRAJ JN. PRAYAGRAJ EXPRESS

Train No. 12418 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
New Delhi	---	22:10	---	22:15
Ghaziabad	22:42	22:44	22:50	22:52
Aligarh Jn.	23:55	23:57	00:02	00:04
Kanpur Central	03:50	03:55	03:55	04:00
Fatehpur	04:50	04:52	05:00	05:02

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 22438 ANAND VIHAR(T.)-PRAYAGRAJ JN. HUMSAFAR SF. EXP.

Train No. 22438 (w.e.f. 29.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Anand Vihar(T.)	---	22:35	---	23:15
Kanpur Central	03:25	03:30	04:10	04:15
Prayagraj Jn.	06:20	---	07:55	---

REVISED TIMINGS OF TRAIN NO. 54058 SHAMLI-DELHI JN. PASSENGER

Train No. 54058 (w.e.f. 28.10.2026)

STATIONS	Existing Timings ARR.	Existing Timings DEP.	Revised Timings ARR.	Revised Timings DEP.
Delhi Jn.	---	07:40	---	07:45

For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

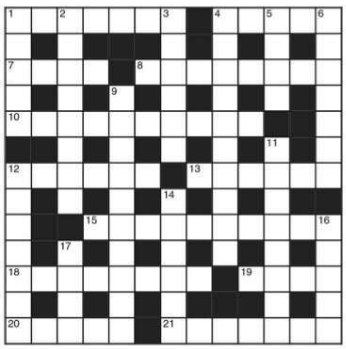
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CROSSWORD 6130



ACROSS

1 Find a means of escape (7)
4 Speakers in debate take it to flatten an opponent (5)
7 Change the course of a revolution (4)
8 As a guess maybe it soothes (8)
10 Get to grips but in friendly fashion (5,5)
12 Wine you make a mistake to be diffident about? (6)
13 Take cover when one is after a gangster (6)
15 Happiest time for those not attending night classes? (10)
18 Shared in a perfect round of golf (8)
19 The story is heard in the end (4)
20 Hope to find one well? (5)
21 Small article produced by an erratic knitter? (7)

DOWN

1 Arranged stage exits or entrances (5)
2 Changes in heat and rent are imminent (8)
3 Could be men say he's a sycophant (3-3)
4 Located the cause of the trouble and criticised (5,5)
5 Drunken revel leads to a gory mess (4)
6 Pause as the priest turns the key (7)
9 Disparage a new recipe in fruit (10)
11 Cat holds down a bird it may kill (8)
12 Raced round the edge and made a mistake (7)
14 He's not bent but on the level (6)
16 Bit of land is left in to be divided (5)
17 Illustrate how gunslingers react (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6129 ACROSS: 1 To the letter, 9 Opinion, 10 April, 11 Peer, 12 Riparian, 14 Render, 16 Starve, 18 Mainland, 19 Cast, 22 Noose, 23 Typhoon, 24 Fell through DOWN: 2 On ice, 3 Hail, 4 Lentil, 5 Tea party, 6 Earlier, 7 Compartment, 8 Clandestine, 13 Well well, 15 Noisome, 17 Snatch, 20 Along, 21 Up to

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Talent is God-given; be humble. Fame is man given; be thankful. ___ is self-given; be careful. - Harvey Mackay (7)

MNWEO

EEFRCN

ITHHC

COILED

SOLUTIONS: Women, Hitch, Fencer, Docile
ANSWER: Talent is God-given, be humble. Fame is man-given, be thankful. **Conceit** is self-given, be careful. - Harvey Mackay

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



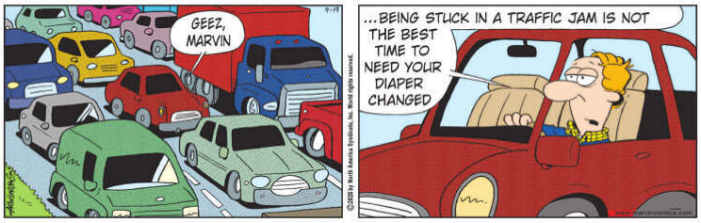
CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6484

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

		3	6		7	8		
6								1
	1		3		5		2	
		4	8	2	6	7		
	2						8	
		7	9	3	4	5		
	5		4		3		9	
8								6
		2	7		8	1		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6483

7	9	2	3	1	6	8	4	5
4	3	6	7	5	8	1	2	9
5	1	8	4	2	9	7	6	3
9	5	7	2	4	1	6	3	8
1	2	3	8	6	5	9	7	4
6	8	4	9	3	7	2	5	1
3	4	9	1	7	2	5	8	6
8	7	5	6	9	3	4	1	2
2	6	1	5	8	4	3	9	7

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Be aware of the limitations of the moon alert, because today it is taking place in your Money House. Guard against temptations to shop and buy things. Be wise and restrict your spending to food and gas. Tonight: Interesting discussions.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today might feel loosey-goosey and indecisive because the moon alert is in your sign. Although this promotes creativity and lightheartedness socialising with others, it's a poor time to make realistic, financial decisions. Tonight: Check your money.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Mostly, I believe in trusting your gut instincts. However, today, they might lead you astray because of the moon alert. Keep your wits about you. Postpone shopping and decisions. Tonight: You win.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is a lovely day to talk with friends and groups. You'll also enjoy fun outings with kids and sports events. Check the moon alert today. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): The moon alert is taking place at the top of your chart, which means your poor decisions and choices will be public, because you're noticed. Wait until the moon alert is over to act. Tonight: Be friendly.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is a fun day to explore your surroundings. Be a tourist in your own city. Reach out and talk to neighbours as well as people from other cultures. Avoid important decisions and shopping, because of the moon alert. Tonight: You're admired.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): This is a tricky day, because today's moon alert is taking place in the part of your chart that deals with shared property, taxes, debt, inheritances and insurance issues. Do your homework but take no action when it comes to financial negotiations. Tonight: Do something different.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Conversations with partners and close friends might feel like two ships passing in the night. Today's moon alert occurs directly opposite your sign, so mixed signals and misinterpretations will be classic. Above all, don't volunteer for anything or agree to anything important. Tonight: Check your finances.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You'll enjoy seeing old friends today. However, the moon alert will rob you of some of your efficiency when it comes to your job or your daily tasks. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): This is a creative day for you. Artists can be productive. Any of you will enjoy appreciating art as well as social engagement with others, including sporting events. Tonight: Get better organised.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): You will be best served relaxing at home and keeping a low profile, especially because most of this day is a moon alert. Don't volunteer for anything within the family or anything important. Tonight: Socialise with someone.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Today you want to get out and talk to others to share your ideas and possibly teach or persuade people to your way of thinking. However, most of this day is a moon alert. Don't end up making a commitment you later regret. Tonight: Relax at home.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Namely: **Rekha, W/o. Lt. Sh. Anil Kumar Jhajhria, R/o. H. No. 2216, Gali No. 13, L-1st , Sangam Vihar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.229/25 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act** registered at **P.S Neb Sarai, South Distt, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Rekha** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Rekha** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rekha**, accused **FIR No.229/25 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act** registered at **P.S Neb Sarai, South Distt, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.11.2026.**

DP/15412/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

By Order, Ms. Devanshi Janmeja
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, South Distt, Room No. 212, 2nd Floor, Saket Courts, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sonu,** S/o Brahm Pal, R/o RZQ-66, Gali No. 13, Nihal Vihar, Nangloi, (Near Delar Mehndi Farm House), Delhi, also at: Village & Post Dhulheda (Dholra), Tehsil Budhana, Distt. Muzaffarnagar, U.P. has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 116/2019 u/s 420/34 IPC at P.S. I.P. Estate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sonu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sonu** accused of **FIR No. 116/2019 u/s 420/34 IPC at P.S. I.P. Estate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.02.2027.**

DP/15381/CD/2026

By Order: Ms. Preeti,
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-03 (Central), Central Distt., Room No. 150, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Varun @Deepak** S/o Vinod, R/o E-6 Jhuggi No. 124, Sultan Puri, Delhi also at 68/14 Sultan Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 80020067/2026 U/s 305/331(4)/317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Raj Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Varun @Deepak** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Varun @Deepak** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Varun @Deepak** in **E-FIR No. 80020067/2026 U/s 305/331(4)/317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Raj Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.11.2026**.

DP/15287/OD/2026

By order
Ms. Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Namely: **Sajid Prop. of Ansari Aluminium Fab., R/o. H. No. 292, Gali No. 4, Old Seemapuri, New Delhi-110095** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **CC No.2991/2021 U/S 138 NI Act** registered at **P.S Paschim Vihar West, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Sajid** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Sajid** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sajid**, accused **CC No.2991/2021 U/S 138 NI Act** registered at **P.S Paschim Vihar West, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.11.2026.**

DP/15432/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

By Order, Ms. Nandini Sharma
JMFC-06 West Delhi, Room No. 355, Tis Hazari courts, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Suraj Kumar S/o:** Sh. Dalbir Singh **R/o:** H.No. 194/15 Arya Nagar Near Malik Service Center Gohana Sonipat Haryana has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 000627/2016, U/S: 411 IPC, PS: Rani Bagh, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Suraj Kumar,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Suraj Kumar,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Suraj Kumar,** of **E-FIR No. 000627/2016, U/S: 411 IPC, PS: Rani Bagh, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.12.2026.**

DP/15065/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

By Order
Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North West Court No. 101 1st Floor Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Aklim S/o Shafeek R/o B-124, Jawahar Mohalla, Shashi Garden, Pandav Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 759/2021 U/S 33D EX. ACT PS: Pandav Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Aklim** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Aklim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Aklim** accused of **FIR No. 759/2021 U/S 33D EX. ACT PS: Pandav Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.12.2026.**

DP/15320/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

By Order
Sh. Amit Rana
JMFC-06, CJM, Room No. 12 Karkardooma Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Rakesh Kumar** (Prop. M/s Guruji Traders) R/o B-238, Mohan Garden, 2nd Floor, Dwarka Mor, Delhi-59 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Ct Case NI ACT 8295/2017 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Rakesh Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rakesh Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Rakesh Kumar** in **Ct Case NI ACT 8295/2017 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.11.2026.**

DP/15367/WD/2026

By order
Sh. Gaurav Singhal
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI ACT)-04
West, Room No. 04, Annex-1
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunil @ Danny, S/o. Man Singh, R/o.: H. No. D-45, Ganesh Nagar Colony, Pandav Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No. 43/2020 U/S 392/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Kalyan Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Sunil @ Danny** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Sunil @ Danny** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sunil @ Danny**, accused of **FIR No. 43/2020 U/S 392/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Kalyan Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.11.2026.**

DP/15419/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

By Order, Ms. Prigya Gupta,
Chief Judicial Magistrate (East), Court No. 29 Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Pradeep @ Babu S/o:** Mohan Singh **R/o:** Kh. No. 40/16 Gali No. 36 C-Block Indraprastha Colony Burari, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 67/18, U/S: 380/411 IPC, PS: Rani Bagh, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Pradeep @ Babu,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Pradeep @ Babu,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Pradeep @ Babu,** of **FIR No. 67/18, U/S: 380/411 IPC, PS: Rani Bagh, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.12.2026.**

DP/15081/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

By Order
Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North West Court No. 101 1st Floor Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Deva S/o Pira R/o Juggi No. 1240, Transit Camp, Baba Faridpuri, Anand Parbat, Delhi also at H. No. F-242, Gaytri Colony, Baljeet Nagar, Anand Parbat, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 452/2024 U/s 305/317(2)/3(5) Bharitya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Anand Parbat, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Deva** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deva** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Deva** of case **FIR No. 452/2024 U/s 305/317(2)/3(5) Bharitya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Anand Parbat, Delhi** is required to appear before thisCourt to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026.**

DP/15371/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

By Order
Sh. Ankur Panghal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 West, Room No. 336A, 3rd Floor Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Mohit Mishra** S/o Mahinder Mishra R/o H. No. N-3/E-149 Shahid Sukhdev Nagar, Wazirpur, Ashok Vihar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 277/2017 U/s 33/38/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS Jahangir Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Mohit Mishra** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohit Mishra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Mohit Mishra** in **FIR No. 277/2017 U/s 33/38/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS Jahangir Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.12.2026**.

DP/15111/NW/2026

By order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 06
Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Manoj S/o Layak Ram R/o Village Kherpur, PO. Kanonda, Teh. Bahadurgarh, Dist. Jhajjar, Haryana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT Case No. 9952/2019, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Kanjhawala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Manoj** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Manoj** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Manoj** of **CT Case No. 9952/2019, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Kanjhawala, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **30.11.2026.**

DP/15185/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

By Order
Apoorv Bhardwaj
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Room No. 113, First Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

NEW ZEALAND VS INDIA: T20I SERIES

Tilak, Nitish & a brotherly bond

Hyderabad duo's match-winning stand was shaped by friendship, sacrifice and two fathers' pride

Tanishq Vaddi
Hyderabad, October 26



Tilak Varma (L) and Nitish Reddy recorded a 69-run partnership from 30 balls to help India win the second T20I vs New Zealand. CREIMAS

RUNNING BETWEEN the wickets in Christchurch, Tilak Varma and Nitish Kumar Reddy were speaking Telugu.

At home, their fathers send each other a good-morning message on WhatsApp every day. Mutyala Reddy does it from Visakhapatnam, Namboori Nagaraju from Hyderabad. Their sons gave them something to write about. Tilak and Nitish put on 69 runs from 30 deliveries to win the second T20I against New Zealand, 11,650 km from Hyderabad. "The Hyderabadi boys are in play today, Nitish Reddy and I, and we are really happy that we finished the game," Tilak said.

The Telugu was not lost on Mutyala. "Both of them speaking in Telugu out there somewhere in New Zealand made me extremely happy," he told *The Indian Express*. "Many times in my experience, Telugu people who have gained stature, even those who know Telugu, deliberately speak in English, showing off their status, instead of speaking the language. For them, speaking in Telugu is like lowering their dignity. What made me and Tilak's father proud was them speaking only in Telugu while playing. Because of them, journalists and anchors in New Zealand and elsewhere were talking about the language."

His prayers were different this time. "Usually, as a father, I pray to God, wishing for my son to do very well; that is my self-interest," Mutyala said. "But this time I wished for both of them to do well and finish the game, and that is what happened in the end."

He called Nagaraju after the match. "Usually, whenever they played together for India, if Nitish did well, Tilak wouldn't get an opportunity or wouldn't do well, or vice versa. This time both performed well. While I was congratulating him about Tilak, he stopped me in the middle and said Nitish also played extremely well."

Tilak and Nitish first met in 2018 at the BCCI awards, when both were teenagers and both won the Jagmohan Dalmiya Trophy. They said a casual hello. Eight years later, in Christchurch, they won a match for India. "After that, both played for India A together," said Salam Bayash, Tilak's coach. "They met during the IPL. And when it was Tilak's Ranji Trophy debut match, Nitish was there on the opposite side. They had a very good friendship over the years."

> **"What made me and Tilak's father proud was them speaking only in Telugu while playing. Because of them, journalists and anchors in New Zealand and elsewhere were talking about the language"**
> MUTYALA REDDY, NITISH'S FATHER

It was not the first time they had a chance to finish a game for India. In the fourth T20I against West Indies in Hyderabad this month, they put on 70 in 32 balls before a miscue from Tilak ended the chase. "We could have finished the match in Hyderabad," Bayash said. "I told him, 'Try karna beta next time'... And two Telugu boys have now won the match."

Both fathers had hard years. Mutyala left a stable job at Hindustan Zinc Limited to support Nitish's practice in Visakhapatnam. Nagaraju, an electrician, spent sleepless nights making ends meet so that Tilak could concentrate on cricket, near the banks of the Musi River in Hyderabad's old city.

The families know each other now. "There was a game here in Visakhapatnam once which I attended, and Tilak met me and told me Nitish is a very good person; he mingles with everyone pretty easily," Mutyala said. Tilak is the same, says Bayash. "There is no one who is not a friend of Tilak once he meets them. Uska nature hi aisa hai, dil se milta hai, dil se rehta hai." It is his nature, the coach said: he meets people from the heart, and stays there.

Nitish speaks well of Tilak's family at home. "It is not like they go overboard and start boasting," Mutyala said, "but one can sense a genuineness in the way they speak."

Fame has not changed Nitish, Mutyala says. "You hear from some coaches and players that your son has become arrogant. With Nitish, the coaches call me up and tell me he is the same Nitish they saw at U-16 and U-14 levels. They say, 'We never thought that the boy who has reached this stage would remain like this.' As a father, I don't need anything more than this," Mutyala said.

3rd T20I: 12.30 pm, Live on Sony Sports Network

FIDE survey: 3 in 4 female chess players face bias or harassment

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, October 26

THE FIRST-EVER international chess federation (FIDE) survey about women in the sport has thrown up startling numbers about sexual harassment and gender bias that players, arbiters, coaches and federation officials said they experienced.

According to the survey, 76% of respondents — three out of four — reported at least one form of discrimination or harassment, while 38% conveyed that they had experienced online abuse or harassment.

It also showed that 63% of women and girls experienced gender bias in chess settings, with 16% saying it happens often, and 38% reported sexual harassment or inappropriate behaviour.

A total of 672 female respondents linked to chess from 127 national federations took the survey from August 3 to September 14 this year, with the findings published this month. India was the largest contributing federation with 69 respondents, or over 10%.

The survey covered 133 FIDE-titled players, including 10 Women Grand Masters, 27 Women International Masters, 49 Women FIDE Masters and 43 Women Candidate Masters, among others.

The numbers among women over 18 years old: 70% experienced gender bias in chess settings, while 46% reported sexual harassment or inappropriate behaviour. Among respondents under 18, 47% said they had experienced gender bias, while 17% said they had faced sexual harassment. When the sample was narrowed to just females with FIDE titles, these figures increased to 81% and 55%, respectively.

On gender bias, the survey found it was highest among respondents competing in North America (83%), South America (78%), Europe (74%) and Central America (73%), and lowest in Asia (53%) and Africa (50%).

The scope of the survey, which had a questionnaire with 28 items, was much wider than just gender bias and sexual harassment. The other key findings:

- 44% considered stepping away from chess. Among those who experienced gender bias, 56% thought about walking away from the sport. Among women who experienced sexual harassment, 58% thought of quitting.
- 54% never had a female role model or mentor in chess, and only a third (33%) feel adequately represented in their regional chess community. Respondents with children were less likely to have considered stepping away (35%) than those without (49%).
- Asked to pick the main barriers that most affected their development, financial cost (travel, coaching and entry fees) was chosen by two-thirds (66%), while time constraints from school, work or family by nearly half (48%).

Commissioned by the FIDE Women in Chess Commission, the "FIDE Women in Chess Representation, Participation and Development Survey" is the first-ever global survey of women and girls in chess. It marks a rare instance of such a study being conducted by a global governing sports body.

The 18-page report was compiled by Arhan Boyd, Avika Shukla and Tris Ann Richards, who is the chair of the FIDE Commission for Women's Chess. The survey's aim was to understand how women "came into the game, what has helped and hindered them, what they have experienced in chess settings, and what they think would improve women's participation".

The authors also noted that the actual numbers in the sport could be higher than the sample size. "The sample is self-selected and was reached through chess networks, so it over-represents active players, titled players and federations that circulated the survey energetically, and it says nothing about women who have already left the game," they said.

"Responses for under-18s girls (which constituted about 31% of responses) were completed under guardian consent and may in some cases reflect a parent's view rather than the girl's," they said.

Over the last three years, prominent women players have spoken out about facing sexual harassment and assault. Susan Polgar said in 2023 that in her playing days she was a "victim many times over of sexual harassment, attack and abuse". Polgar's comments had come after Woman Grandmaster Jennifer Shahade and multiple other women accused American grandmaster Alejandro Ramirez of sexual misconduct. Ramirez was later banned by the US Chess Federation.

Among the report's recommendations were to adopt and publicise a clear code of conduct covering tournament halls, coaching relationships and online spaces; establish confidential reporting channels with independent handling; and, train arbiters and organisers in recognising and responding to harassment.

FIDE'S GLOBAL SURVEY



672
Total responses from 127 national federations

69
Number of respondents from India — the largest contributing federation to the study.

38%
women reported sexual harassment or inappropriate behavior in the survey, with 7% saying it happens often

17%
girls under the age of 18 who said they had faced sexual harassment

133
Number of FIDE-titled players who responded to the survey, including 10 Women Grand Masters, 27 Women International Masters, 49 Women FIDE Masters, 43 Women Candidate Masters, among others.

Padikkal falls one short of 200 as India A take 284-run lead

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 26

IT WAS a day of left-handers as Devdutt Padikkal (199), Sai Sudharsan (91), Yash Rathod (66) and Washington Sundar (51 not out) piled on the runs for India A against New Zealand A in Lincoln. The visitors finished Day 3 on 488/8 in 119 overs, a lead of 284 runs.

There were two disappointments: Padikkal missing a double hundred by one run and Sudharsan falling in his 90s. Padikkal was visibly unhappy at being given out caught behind on 199 off Zak Gibson. He had tried flicking a leg-side delivery and stood frozen for a while before trudging off, turning around to spread his arms at the umpire. Replays, however, did not confirm any contact between bat and ball.

Sudharsan fell for 91 to the short-ball tactic after unfurling a few crisp pulls. With a fielder stationed at deep backward square-leg, he tried to help the ball along rather than pull hard, only to top-edge Kristian Clarke to Dean Foxcroft.

Dhruv Jurel, whose place in the Test team could come under scrutiny, also fell cheaply for 2, miscuing a pull off a short ball from outside off stump to a fielder positioned behind square. Rathod made 66 off 72 balls, with eight fours, playing crisp punches through the off-side. But the day belonged to Padikkal, who made 199 off 248 balls, with 24 fours and three sixes. Dropped on 19 on Sunday, he batted fluently on a pitch that had eased up, using his back foot well and reacting to the length rather than committing early. He reached his hundred by charging down the track against left-arm spinner Jayden Lennox.

> ***Padikkal was visibly unhappy at being given out caught behind on 199 off Zak Gibson***

The innings comes ahead of the Test series, in which Padikkal is slated to bat at No. 3. After his second hundred in Sri Lanka last month, he had said: "Obviously, there have been great players who have played at number three for India over the years, and I'm sure there'll be a lot more scrutiny on me and a lot more comparisons made."

New Zealand's seam-friendly conditions will test him, with his performances likely to be closely watched.

At stumps, Sundar was unbeaten on 51 off 75 balls, while Auqib Nabi's 38, including two sixes, added to the lead.

BRIEF SCORES: India A 113 & 488/8 (Padikkal 199, Sudharsan 91, Yash Rathod 66, Washington 51 batting) lead **New Zealand A** 317 by 284 runs.

Ranji Trophy: Chepauk changes its mind on Day One with green pitch, dry surface

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, October 26



Railways' Zubair Ali plays a pull shot during his 75-run knock. PTI

HEAVY RAIN over the past few days has kept the Chepauk pitch under covers. A green tinge suggested that it could help the seamers in overcast conditions. What lay beneath it was a matter of curiosity for both teams, when it came to choosing the XI and to deciding what to do on winning the toss.

For the second match in a row, Tamil Nadu captain R Sai Kishore won it and put the opposition in. On a pitch with plenty of moisture, the seamers did the early damage, Sonu Yadav in particular, and Railways were 7 for 3. The spinners, led by Sai Kishore, had them at 123 for 9. It was much the script of the game against Uttarakhand last week.

If Gurjapneet Singh broke Uttarakhand's back then, on Monday it was the turn of Sonu, a medium-pacer who relies extensively on swing. Overcast skies are a rarity in Chennai. The pitches in the First Division here tend to favour spinners, so seamers have had little to do, and the local conditions have often held back the development of fast bowlers. Playing his first first-class match at Chepauk, Sonu used the help. He took three wickets with the new ball, two of them lbw, and finished with 3 for 46.

After that opening, Railways were never going to get away from the Tamil Nadu spinners. The turn was not sharp, but the moisture let the ball rush on and test the edges. Sai Kishore took three wickets for 53, and J Hemchudeshan two in five overs.

Tamil Nadu have struggled for some years to finish the job, and did not finish it here. Once the moisture went and the ball softened, Zubair Ali counter-attacked, making 75 off 121 balls, with Himanshu Sangwan alongside him. He took Railways to 184, which looked too few at first. The stand kept Railways in a game that Tamil Nadu seemed to have in hand.

What followed was a twist Tamil Nadu had not expected so soon. They had thought the pitch would show its dry side once the moisture went. With the rain, the groundstaff had been wary of watering it much, and the black soil began to break up. The Railways spinners were in the game earlier than they themselves had expected.

Sangwan made the first breakthrough, removing Vimal Kumar, out for a nought for the second innings running. The Tamil Nadu batters had no trouble with the Railways seamers. Then the spinners came on, off-spinner Toufik Uddin Mondal in particular. Tamil Nadu, who had expected to close the day on top, were soon battling to stay in the game.

The moisture had gone, but the surface was dry enough that the odd ball stopped. With sharp turn and bounce in play, the conditions set Tamil Nadu a different problem.

> ***Zubair Ali counter-attacked, making 75 off 121 balls, with Himanshu Sangwan alongside him. He took Railways to 184, which looked too few at first***

N Jagadeesan was bowled by an off-spinner for the second innings running. Against Uttarakhand he played the wrong line to a ball from round the wicket and lost his off-stump. On Monday Mondal bowled him through the gate.

Mondal was not done. After testing Pradosh Ranjan Paul's edges, he saw the left-hander go for a drive. The slowness of the surface made the shot risky, and Paul gave a simple return catch, which Mondal took.

Baba Indrajith and Andre Siddarth saw Tamil Nadu to stumps at 71 for 3. If the conditions stay the same on Tuesday, Indrajith's game against spin could count for a lot. All eyes will be on the strip.

BRIEF SCORES: Railways 184 (Zubair Ali 75; Sonu Yadav 3/46, Sai Kishore 3/53) vs **TN** 71/3

Mumbai's Angkrish, Musheer slam tons to erase red-ball blues

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, October 26



Angkrish Raghuvanshi scored 114 for Mumbai. PTI

LIKE ANY upcoming cricketer on the circuit, Mumbai opener Angkrish Raghuvanshi was going through a period where he had begun doubting himself. He made his debut three seasons ago, but had struggled to get a longer run. He had been performing decently for Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) in the IPL, but back in the Mumbai Ranji Trophy team, a waiting list ticket awaited him.

He had two fifties in his last five first class games and despite showing some promise, the 22-year-old kept missing the bus. On Monday, however, Angkrish along with Musheer Khan helped Mumbai ride easy on Day 1 of the Ranji Trophy match against Haryana. They both struck centuries that helped cleared their muddled minds from form struggles of recent times.

Their 208-run first wicket partnership (114 for Angkrish) put Mumbai on a firm footing as their day ended on 290 for 3. Haryana's decision to bowl first looked to have backfired as the Mumbai batsmen held the upper hand throughout the three sessions.

Meanwhile for Angkrish, a perception was slowly threatening to build, around his capability to handle red ball cricket. "My debut was three years back, I fell for 92 and eventually lost my place in the side. I know how tough it is to play for Mumbai; all India players play here. So those thoughts started creeping in over whether I would ever make it (a maiden ton) or not. I don't know what was perception of the rest of the people was, but I did have some doubts of my own. I mean, it is a very natural thing that if you don't prove yourself, then you feel inside, that you can't do it," Angkrish said after the game.

Reaching out to Nayar

The KKR star likes to keep it simple and he concentrated on areas where he could get runs. Before being picked again this season, Angkrish had scored two double hundreds in under 23 cricket. He reached out to his coach Abhishek Nayar about how to overcome the middle caused by too many thoughts running through his mind.

"I had a conversation with my coach, Abhishek sir, and I realised I was making it a huge thing in my head that maybe I don't have the skills to play red-ball. I asked him what I was doing wrong and if I was not disciplined enough," he recalled. "The only thing Nayar told him was that 'at the end of the day, it's cricket. "Whether I am playing white-ball or red-ball, my job is to score runs. He asked me to just go out there and not worry about what is going to happen, just think about how you can hit that ball for a boundary, and if it's not there to hit, then defend it."

Against Haryana, Angkrish scored 114 runs before departing while trying a leg glance, while Musheer scored 109 before being adjudged leg before wicket. Till the time the duo batted, they kept the fielders busy. Angkrish and Musheer have been playing cricket together since U16 days and they acknowledges each other's support in getting to their coveted milestones in Ranji trophy, offering a glimpse into how the Mumbai side will shape up in coming years.

BRIEF SCORES: Mumbai 290/3 in 82 overs (A Raghuvanshi 114, M Khan 109, S Lad 29*, Sarfaraz Khan 21 not out) vs **Haryana**

RANJI ROUND-UP

GROUP A

At Nagpur: Goa 204/8 in 86 overs (Yash Kasvankar 51*, Darshan Misal 51; Nachiket Bhute 4/40) vs Vidarbha

At Baroda: Baroda 259/6 in 86 overs (Priyanshu Moliya 113*; Umar Hazir Mir 2/28) vs J&K

GROUP B

At Mysuru: Tripura 194 all out in 82 overs (Bikramkumar Das 51; Abhilash Shetty 5/54) vs Karnataka 10/1 in 6 overs

At Rajkot: Assam 235/6 in 93 overs (Denish Das 90, Sibsankar Roy 59 batting; Jaydev Unadkat 3/27) vs Saurashtra

GROUP C

At Pune: Gujarat 223 in 75.5 overs (Abhishek Desai 79, Jaymeet Patel 58, Siddhesh Veer 4/20, Vicky Ostwal 3/75, Rajvardhan Hangargekar 3/64)

At Ranchi: Delhi 309 for 5 in 90 overs (Ayush Badoni 106 batting, Sumit Mathur 50 batting)

GROUP D

In Dehradun: Rajasthan 272 in 81.2 overs (Kartik Sharma 73; Devendra Bora 6/72) lead Uttarakhand 18/0 (Tejasvi Jaiswal 9*, Dega Nischal 9*) by 254 runs

In Chandigarh: Chandigarh 363/2 in 87 overs (Nehal Pajni 126*, Arjun Azad 146) vs HP



Craig Fulton will juggle with experience and youth in the build-up to the 2028 LA Olympics. HOCKEY INDIA

EXPRESS interview | CRAIG FULTON MEN'S TEAM COACH

Fulton offers a roadmap, not a retirement list

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, October 26

IN THE climactic scene of a big ensemble film, the characters from different storylines often converge at a symbolic place. For Indian hockey, that place is Jalandhar, home to almost half-a-dozen players from the current team.

As the Asian Champions Trophy brings international hockey back to Punjab for the first time since January 2009, it comes with a subplot of its own: could the meaningless tournament be the swansong for some of the senior players?

Coach Craig Fulton isn't commenting on that. But his plans for the months ahead suggest that the composition of the team is up for review, with a younger group set to travel to New Zealand after the tournament, and a new training squad to be finalised ahead of the Pro League in February.

The timing is significant. India's contrasting performances at the World Cup and Asian Games have left questions about the team's personnel, even as the latter offered evidence that the existing group can still deliver. At the World Cup in August, India failed to make the semi-finals as Germany, Argentina and Spain broke into the last four. Belgium and England missed out too — underlining how little separates the leading teams. "We had our chances and we didn't take them," Fulton told *The Indian Express*. "The competition in the men's tournament is really, really tight at the moment, which is exciting."

> **"It's not easy to just remove your experience in key positions and expect the next group of players to pick it up exactly where you left off. You're looking at experience and youth together."**
> **CRAIG FULTON,** ON INTEGRATING YOUNGER PLAYERS INTO THE SQUAD

Asian Games gold

India responded at the Asian Games, finding a way through the difficult knockout games to win gold. "I think we played a really good tournament at the Asian Games. We were quite consistent, and the semifinals are always difficult games. I'm glad we found a way to get through it, and that's all credit to the guys," Fulton said.

The two results offer different readings of the same group. The World Cup exposed India's inability to convert opportunities against the best; the Asian Games showed the value of its experience. The question now is how to retain that experience heading into the LA Olympics while making room for the next generation.

Senior players such as Sumit, Mandeep Singh, Amit Rohidas and Jarmanpreet Singh are part of that conversation. Their futures cannot be read going by the coach's comments in isolation, but the World Cup has sharpened the scrutiny of India's established personnel.

Fulton pointed to the unusual scheduling as one complication."It was a very unique situation, having the World Cup and then, three weeks later, your biggest tournament," he said. "In hindsight, you might select the Asian Games team on the back of the World Cup performance, but that wasn't possible because we had to name the team 60 days before the Asian Games."

Preparing for the next generation

The next phase will not be a simple changing of the guard. "It's not easy to just remove your experience in key positions and expect the next group of players to pick it up exactly where you left off," Fulton said.

After the ACT, India will select a younger group for New Zealand. The squad will then come together for the Hockey India League, with the group for the Pro League in India in February — facing Argentina and Germany — to be finalised afterwards. "A lot of the senior guys will be given a rest, and we'll choose a younger squad to go through to New Zealand," Fulton said. "Then everyone comes together for the Hockey India League, we choose our squad, and we play the Pro League in India in February with the new squad."

That is a roadmap, not a retirement list. But it creates an opportunity for younger players to press their claims. With no major tournament apart from the Pro League in 2027, Fulton also wants to use the year to give the team more match practice.

"My main objective is to get a lot more games in 2027. There are no tournaments except for the Pro League, so we need to fill that gap with training games," he said. "We need to get back to doing the basics well, reinforce the way we want to play, give opportunities to different players and see if we can put the right combinations together."

In Jalandhar, the immediate business is to win the ACT. But with the next phase of selection already taking shape, the tournament also brings India's present and future into the same frame.

ASIAN CHAMPIONS TROPHY

For Punjab's Olympic stars, a homecoming

Paris, Tokyo medallists missed out on playing for India in their home state as no international hockey was held for 17 years

Nitin Sharma
Jalandhar, October 26

AS THE Asian Champions Trophy rolls into town, Indian captain Harmanpreet Singh standing under the new canopy at the Olympian Surjit Singh Hockey Stadium, points towards one of the goal-posts on the left side. Over 15 years ago, Harmanpreet had just joined the academy, and would train for hours on the small astro-turf patch behind the goal post, under coaches Avtar Singh Pinka and Gurdev Singh Debi.

"I still remember the day when my father dropped me off and I began practicing on the small astro-turf patch," the double Olympic bronze medallist recalls. "We would spray water on the turf and just knew that we had to hit the ball with a flick after taking a step. Later I watched Jugraj *paji* playing at the stadium for Punjab Police teams. So as I stand here playing for the first time at this ground in an Indian jersey, I can only say, 'I have played in London, Paris and other big cities in the world but to play here is like returning to the lap of one's mother'."

Harmanpreet is on the verge of surpassing Balbir Singh Sr's count of 246 goals for the second spot on the all-time list, behind Dhyan Chand's 570 goals. "If I am able to surpass Balbir Singh Sr's record here, it will be special for me," shares Singh to *The Indian Express*.

First since 2009

With centres like Ranchi, Bhubaneswar and Delhi hosting international matches in recent memory, the Indian national team is playing in Punjab for the first time since 2009. The Asian Champions Trophy sees eight players from Punjab with five including Harmanpreet Singh, Mandeep Singh, Dilpreet Singh, Jarmanpreet Singh and goal-keeper Krishan Pathak belonging to the Surjit Hockey Academy.



Harmanpreet Singh (C) with academy trainees. NITIN SHARMA

Forward Mandeep Singh, who too hails from the nearby village of Mithapur, had started hockey at his village academy, before he moved to Surjit's in 2008 living at the hostel there for a couple of seasons. He is the eighth highest goal-scorer for India currently with his tally of 128 goals in 301 matches. "Initially I stayed in the hostel. My brother would drop me to the academy on motorbike and during the journey, I would dream about playing for India. I became a fan of Sardar and Sandeep Singh *paji* after watching them play here," he said.

In the first season of HIL in 2013, he turned out for Ranchi Rhinos debuting at Jalandhar with 2008 Olympic winning German captain Moritz Furtse. The German had explained to him that playing at home implied biggest support.

Vice-captain Hardik Singh, who had also trained at Surjit's apart from being a trainee at Mohali Hockey Academy, remembers his time as a ball boy during the HIL in Mohali in 2013. "I can sense how big it will be for the trainees of the academies across Punjab to watch us play. When I was a ball boy in HIL at Mohali, I would note down the moves of Sardar Singh *paji* in my mind as well as playing like the Indian stars one day. I too am excited to play there.," says Hardik.

At Village Attari near the India-Pakistan border, hockey trainees are also preparing to watch the village's poster boy drag-flicker Jugraj Singh in action. "The trainees are excited about watching their hero Jugraj Singh and other Indian stars play at Jalandhar," says coach Navjit Singh.

> ***The ACT sees eight players from Punjab with five including Harmanpreet Singh, Mandeep Singh, Dilpreet Singh, Jarmanpreet Singh and Krishan Pathak belonging to the Surjit Hockey Academy.***

Coach Craig Fulton sees similarities to South Africa. "When I first came, I wanted to find out where the players came from and we did a map of India. And it was incredible to see pockets from where most players came and stories of how these players came through the academy system and how Punjab has a rich Olympic history too. And now to come to Jalandhar, it's the completion of the visual circle. Back home in South Africa too, a rich pool comes from Gauteng or Western Province," says Fulton.

Manpreet Singh, who is the most capped Indian player at present, was ruled out due to a calf injury on Monday but he too is a Surjit Academy product.

Manpreet spoke about how he missed a chance with the injury. "It's unfortunate that I suffered the injury but I am sure there will be many such youngsters from Punjab who will go home taking inspiration from this Indian hockey team," added Manpreet, who has been replaced by Vivek Sagar Prasad.

INDIA VS BANGLADESH: Live from 7:00 PM on Star Sports Network and JioHotstar.

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- **Every police station empowered:** Mission Shakti Centres established statewide; **80,000+ police personnel trained.**
- **Faster, coordinated action:** All women-related crime units integrated under Mission Shakti Centres, with scooters provided for swift grievance redressal.
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Mission Shakti
Women Security
Women Dignity
Women Empowerment
6th edition







Anti-Romeo Squads: Zero Tolerance for Harassment

- **5.95 crore+ individuals checked, 2.20 crore+ warned** and legal action taken against **42,226.**
- Anti-Romeo Squads operational across districts; **3 Women PAC battalions established,** with 5 more planned.

Women Power Line 1090: Help at Hand

- Women Power Line **1090**, Women's Helpline **181**, GRP and Fire Services integrated for coordinated assistance.
- Women and Child Security Organisation established seven special operations launched to strengthen women's and children's safety.

Stronger Policing, Safer Communities

- **134 new police stations, 7 women's police stations and 86 police outposts** established.
- **75 Cyber Crime Police Stations, 6 Narcotics Police Stations and 78 Women's Police Counselling Centres** established.
- **2.25 Lakh+ police personnel recruited** and **1,60,846 promoted** between April 2017 and June 2026.

Emergency & Helpline Expansion

1090 Women Power Line	181 Women Helpline
1930 Cyber Helpline	1076 CM Helpline

Vikas ki Gati Apaar-Double Engine Sarkar

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